Cashu Book of NUTs

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Abstract

A thematically organized reading of the Cashu NUTs (Notation, Usage, and Terminology).

The protocol specifications themselves are written by the Cashu community. This book groups them so wallets, mints, and curious humans can follow the story of Chaumian ecash on Bitcoin.

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Introduction

Welcome to the Cashu Book of NUTs. This book is nuts.

It is a streamlined guide to the Cashu Notation, Usage, and Terminology (NUTs). Instead of reading the specs in numerical order, I have grouped similar NUTs together so the protocol is easier to follow. Whether you are writing a wallet, running a mint, or just curious about Chaumian ecash, this layout should help you see how the pieces fit.

I want to be clear: I did not write the NUTs. All the credit goes to the original authors and contributors of these specifications. My contribution has been to sort them into a flow that makes the connections clearer.

Each chapter starts with a short introduction, then the NUTs themselves, unchanged. The goal is to make the technical details a bit friendlier without rewriting anyone else's work.

Thanks for picking up this book. I hope it helps you navigate Cashu more easily and encourages you to dive deeper. Let's explore and build the future of private digital cash together.

How to read this book

The NUTs were written as numbered documents. That numbering is still how implementations refer to them — NUT-04, NUT-11, and so on — but it is not the best order for a first read.

I start with the core protocol: what a token is, how keys work, and how a mint describes itself. Then I walk through the three operations every wallet cares about: mint, melt, and swap. A shared error table sits at the end of that chapter; later NUTs keep linking to it. After that come wallet state, spending conditions, Lightning and other payment methods, payment requests, realtime and auth, and a small Nostr chapter.

A note on mandatory versus optional: wallets and mints `MUST` implement NUT-00 through NUT-06. Those specs are split across the first two chapters, because mint, melt, and swap sit more naturally with the later payment NUTs than with cryptography. Everything from NUT-07 onward is optional. You can skip a later chapter if you are not implementing that feature.

I have not edited the NUT text. If a spec looks wrong, the fix belongs in cashubtc/nuts, not here.

Read front to back if you are new. Jump by chapter if you already know the protocol and need one topic.

Source snapshot

This book was built from the following commit of cashubtc/nuts. If something here disagrees with upstream, upstream wins.

```
commit 1363de413294e2ef3a57b16950f9506af38fffc2
Author: Rob Woodgate <robwoodgate@users.noreply.github.com>
Date:   Fri Oct 23 19:03:23 2026 +0100

    Merge pull request #402 from robwoodgate/nut28-htlc-example
```

```
tests: add NUT-28 HTLC example proof
```

Core protocol

This is the foundation. NUT-00 defines the cryptography and the models: proofs, blinded messages, and the rest of the vocabulary. NUT-01 and NUT-02 cover how a mint publishes keys and how keysets and fees work. NUT-06 is the mint's info endpoint, so a wallet can discover what a mint supports.

Wallets and mints `MUST` implement NUT-00 through NUT-06. The remaining mandatory specs — swap, mint, and melt — are in the next chapter, next to the optional payment features that extend them.

Later chapters in this book are optional.

In this chapter

- NUT-00 — Cryptography and models
- NUT-01 — Mint public keys
- NUT-02 — Keysets and fees
- NUT-06 — Mint info

NUT-00: Notation, Utilization, and Terminology

`mandatory`

This document details the notation and models used throughout the specification and lays the groundwork for understanding the basic cryptography used in the Cashu protocol.

- Sending user: `Alice`
- Receiving user: `Carol`
- Mint: `Bob`

Blind Diffie-Hellmann key exchange (BDHKE)

Variables

- `G` elliptic curve generator point

Bob (mint)

- `k` private key of mint (one for each amount)
- `K` public key corresponding to `k`
- `C_` blind signature (on `B_`)

Alice (user)

- `x` UTF-8-encoded random string (secret message), corresponds to point `Y = hash_to_curve(x)` on curve
- `r` blinding factor (scalar)

- `B_` blinded message (curve point)
- `C` unblinded signature (curve point)

`hash_to_curve(x: bytes) -> curve point Y`

Deterministically maps a message to a public key point on the secp256k1 curve, utilizing a domain separator to ensure uniqueness.

`Y = PublicKey('02' || SHA256(msg_hash || counter))` where `msg_hash` is `SHA256(DOMAIN_SEPARATOR || x)`

- `Y` derived public key
- `DOMAIN_SEPARATOR` constant byte string `b"Secp256k1_HashToCurve_Cashu_"`
- `x` message to hash
- `counter` uint32 counter (byte order little endian) incremented from 0 until a point is found that lies on the curve

Protocol

- Mint `Bob` publishes public key `K = kG`
- `Alice` picks secret `x` and computes `Y = hash_to_curve(x)`
- `Alice` sends to `Bob`: `B_ = Y + rG` with `r` being a random blinding factor (**blinding**)
- `Bob` sends back to `Alice` blinded key: `C_ = kB_` (these two steps are the DH key exchange) (**signing**)
- `Alice` can calculate the unblinded key as `C_ - rK = kY + krG - krG = kY = C` (**unblinding**)
- Alice can take the pair `(x, C)` as a token and can send it to `Carol`.
- `Carol` can send `(x, C)` to `Bob` who then checks that `k*hash_to_curve(x) == C` (**verification**), and if so treats it as a valid spend of a token, adding `x` to the list of spent secrets.

Notation And Conventions

These specifications use elliptic curve public key cryptography over the field and curve parameters defined by secp256k1.

Types

Values in these specifications are one of:

- Scalars: integers modulo the curve order `n`
- Curve points: elements of the elliptic curve group (including the identity point at infinity)
- Byte sequences

Byte Operations And Encodings

- Concatenation `||` appends one byte sequence to another.
- All operations such as point addition, scalar multiplication, hashing, are performed on the underlying mathematical values, not on their serialized byte encodings.
- When a curve point is serialized as `hex_str`, it is the hex encoding of the SEC1 compressed public key bytes, unless a NUT specifies a different encoding.
- Integer byte order and fixed widths are defined by each NUT where relevant, if a NUT is silent, it must not be assumed.

Hashing

- `SHA256(m)` denotes the SHA 256 hash of byte sequence `m`.
- Any hash to curve function must specify its domain separator and exact procedure, including how counters are encoded and incremented.

0.1 - Models

`BlindedMessage`

An encrypted ("blinded") secret and an amount are sent from `Alice` to `Bob` for minting tokens or for swapping tokens. A `BlindedMessage` is also called an *output*.

```
{
  "amount": int,
  "id": hex_str,
  "B_": hex_str
}
```

`amount` is the value for the requested `BlindSignature`, `id` is the requested keyset ID from which we expect a signature, and `B_` is the blinded secret message generated by `Alice`. An array `[BlindedMessage]` is also referred to as `BlindedMessages`.

`BlindSignature`

A `BlindSignature` is sent from `Bob` to `Alice` after minting tokens or after swapping tokens. A `BlindSignature` is also called a *promise*.

```
{
  "amount": int,
  "id": hex_str,
  "C_": hex_str
}
```

`amount` is the value of the blinded token, `id` is the keyset id of the mint keys that signed the token, and `C_` is the blinded signature on the secret message `B_` sent in the previous step.

`Proof`

A `Proof` is also called an *input* and is generated by `Alice` from a `BlindSignature` it received. An array `[Proof]` is called `Proofs`. `Alice` sends `Proofs` to `Bob` for melting tokens. Serialized `Proofs` can also be sent from `Alice` to `Carol`. Upon receiving the token, `Carol` deserializes it and requests a swap from `Bob` to receive new `Proofs`.

```
{
  "amount": int,
  "id": hex_str,
  "secret": str,
  "C": hex_str
}
```

`amount` is the amount of the `Proof`, `secret` is the secret message and is a UTF-8-encoded string (the use of a 64 character hex string generated from 32 random bytes is recommended to prevent fingerprinting), `C` is the

unblinded signature on `secret` (hex string), `id` is the keyset id of the mint public keys that signed the token (hex string).

0.2 - Protocol

Errors

In case of an error, mints respond with the HTTP status code `400` and include the following data in their response:

```
{
  "detail": "oops",
  "code": 1337
}
```

Here, `detail` is the error message, and `code` is the error code. Error codes are to be defined in the documents concerning the use of a certain API endpoint.

0.3 - Methods

Serialization of tokens

Tokens can be serialized to send them between users `Alice` and `Carol`. Serialized tokens have a Cashu token prefix, a versioning flag, and the token. Optionally, a URI prefix for making tokens clickable on the web.

We use the following format for token serialization:

```
cashu[version][token]
```

`cashu` is the Cashu token prefix. `[version]` is a single `base64_urlsafe` character to denote the token format version.

URI tags

To make Cashu tokens clickable on the web, we use the URI scheme `cashu:`. An example of a serialized token with URI tag is

```
cashu:cashuAeyJwcm9vZn...
```

V3 tokens

> *V3 tokens are deprecated and the use of the more space-efficient V4 tokens is encouraged.*

Version

This token format has the `[version]` value `A`.

Format

V3 tokens are base64-encoded JSON objects. The token format supports tokens from multiple mints. The JSON is serialized with a `base64_urlsafe` (base64 encoding with `/` replaced by `_` and `+` by `-`). `base64_urlsafe` strings

may have padding characters (usually =) at the end which can be omitted. Clients need to be able to decode both cases.

`cashuA[base64_token_json]`

`[base64_token_json]` is the token JSON serialized in `base64_urlsafe`. `[base64_token_json]` should be cleared of any whitespace before serializing.

Token format

The deserialized `base64_token_json` is

```
{
  "token": [
    {
      "mint": str,
      "proofs": Proofs
    },
    ...
  ],
  "unit": str <optional>,
  "memo": str <optional>
}
```

`mint` is the mint URL. The mint URL must be stripped of any trailing slashes (`/`). `Proofs` is an array of `Proof` objects. The next two elements are only for displaying the receiving user appropriate information: `unit` is the currency unit of the token keysets (see Keysets for supported units), and `memo` is an optional text memo from the sender.

Example

Below is a TokenV3 JSON before `base64_urlsafe` serialization.

```
{
  "token": [
    {
      "mint": "https://8333.space:3338",
      "proofs": [
        {
          "amount": 2,
          "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
          "secret": "407915bc212be61a77e3e6d2aeb4c727980bda51cd06a6afc29e2861768a7837",
          "C": "02bc9097997d81afb2cc7346b5e4345a9346bd2a506eb7958598a72f0cf85163ea"
        },
        {
          "amount": 8,
          "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
          "secret": "fe15109314e61d7756b0f8ee0f23a624acaa3f4e042f61433c728c7057b931be",
          "C": "029e8e5050b890a7d6c0968db16bc1d5d5fa040ea1de284f6ec69d61299f671059"
        }
      ]
    }
  ],
  "unit": "sat",
```

```
  "memo": "Thank you."
}
```

When serialized, this becomes:

```
cashuAeyJ0b2tlbiI6W3sibWludCI6Imh0dHBzOi8vODMzMy5zcGFjZTozMzM4IiwicHJvb2ZzIjpbeyJhbW91bnQiOjIsIm
lkIjoiMDA5YTFmMjkzMjUzZTQxZSIsInNlY3JldCI6IjQwNzkxNWJjMjEyYmU2MWE3N2UzZTZkMmFlYjRjNzI3OTgwYmRhNT
FjZDA2YTZhZmMyOWUyODYxNzY4YTc4MzciLCJDIjoiMDJiYzkwOTc5OTdkODFhZmIyY2M3MzQ2YjVlNDM0NWE5MzQ2YmQyYT
UwNmViNzk1ODU5OGE3MmYwY2Y4NTE2M2VhIn0seyJhbW91bnQiOjgsImlkIjoiMDA5YTFmMjkzMjUzZTQxZSIsInNlY3JldC
I6ImZlMTUxMDkzMTRlNjFkNzc1NmIwZjhlZTBmMjNhNjI0YWNhYTNmNGUwNDJmNjE0MzNjNzI4YzcwNTdiOTMxYmUiLCJDIj
oiMDI5ZThlNTA1MGI4OTBhN2Q2YzA5NjhkYjE2YmMxZDVkNWZhMDQwZWExZGUyODRmNmVjNjlkNjEyOTlmNjcxMDU5In1dfV
0sInVuaXQiOiJzYXQiLCJtZW1vIjoiVGhhbmsgeW91LiJ9
```

V4 tokens

V4 tokens are a space-efficient way of serializing tokens using the CBOR binary format. All keys are single characters and hex strings are encoded in binary. V4 tokens can only hold proofs from a single mint.

Version

This token format has the `[version]` value `B`.

Format

Wallets serialize tokens in a `base64_urlsafe` format (base64 encoding with `/` replaced by `_` and `+` by `-`). `base64_urlsafe` strings may have padding characters (usually `=`) at the end which can be omitted. Clients need to be able to decode both cases.

```
cashuB[base64_token_cbor]
```

Token format

For readability, the structure of a TokenV4 object is shown below in its equivalent JSON form.

```
{
  "m": str, // mint URL
  "u": str, // currency unit
  "d": str <optional>, // optional memo
  "t": [
    {
      "i": bytes, // keyset ID (short or long form)
      "p": [ // proofs with this keyset ID
        {
          "a": int, // amount
          "s": str, // secret
          "c": bytes, // signature
          "d": { <optional> // optional DLEQ proof
            "e": bytes,
            "s": bytes,
            "r": bytes
          },
          "w": str <optional> // optional witness
        },
```

```
        ...
      ]
    },
    ...
  ]
}
```

`m` is the mint URL. The mint URL **MUST** be normalized by stripping any trailing slashes (`/`). `u` is the currency unit of the token keysets. Supported units are defined in Keysets. `d` is an optional, human-readable memo provided by the sender.

Within the `t` (token) array, `i` denotes the keyset ID associated with the proofs contained in `p` which are grouped by `i`. `p` is an array of `Proof` objects with the original keyset ID field `id` omitted. All proofs in the corresponding `p` array MUST belong to the same keyset ID.

Unless otherwise stated, fields of type `bytes` represent byte strings in the CBOR encoding. In the original JSON representation of `Proof` objects, these values are encoded as hexadecimal strings. Implementations MUST convert between hex strings and raw byte arrays when translating between JSON and CBOR representations.

Optional fields **MAY** be omitted if not present. Receivers **MUST** ignore unknown fields to preserve forward compatibility. Map key order is not significant: encoders **MAY** emit keys in any order and receivers **MUST** accept any order, so encoded tokens are not byte-comparable across implementations.

Short keyset ID

To reduce the size of the `i` field and the overall Token encoding, wallets **MAY** use the short keyset ID representation (`s_id`).

The short keyset ID is defined as the first 8 bytes of the full 33-byte keyset ID:

- Byte form: `s_id = id_bytes[:8]`
- Hex form: `s_id = id_hex_str[:16]`

Wallets receiving a Token **MUST** support both short and full keyset ID representations. When a short keyset ID is encountered, the wallet **MUST** resolve it to the corresponding full keyset ID before processing the contained `Proof` objects.

If a short keyset ID resolves to more than one known full keyset ID, the identifier is considered ambiguous. In this case, the wallet **MUST** fail token parsing and return an error.

The mint is unaware of the `s_id`. All API endpoints exposed by the mint use the full keyset ID.

Example

Below is a TokenV4 JSON before CBOR and `base64_urlsafe` serialization.

```
{
    "t": [
        {
            "i": h'00ffd48b8f5ecf80',
            "p": [
                {
```

```
                    "a": 1,
                    "s": "acc12435e7b8484c3cf1850149218af90f716a52bf4a5ed347e48ecc13f77388",
                    "c": h'0244538319de485d55bed3b29a642bee5879375ab9e7a620e11e48ba482421f3cf',
                },
            ],
        },
        {
            "i": h'00ad268c4d1f5826',
            "p": [
                {
                    "a": 2,
                    "s": "1323d3d4707a58ad2e23ada4e9f1f49f5a5b4ac7b708eb0d61f738f48307e8ee",
                    "c": h'023456aa110d84b4ac747aebd82c3b005aca50bf457ebd5737a4414fac3ae7d94d',
                },
                {
                    "a": 1,
                    "s": "56bcbcbb7cc6406b3fa5d57d2174f4eff8b4402b176926d3a57d3c3dcbb59d57",
                    "c": h'0273129c5719e599379a974a626363c333c56cafc0e6d01abe46d5808280789c63',
                },
            ],
        },
    ],
    "m": "http://localhost:3338",
    "u": "sat",
}
```

The `h''` values are `bytes` but displayed as hex strings here.

We serialize this JSON using CBOR which can be seen here. The resulting bytes are then serialized to a string using `base64_urlsafe` and the prefix `cashuB` is added. This leaves us with the following serialized TokenV4:

```
cashuBo2F0gqJhaUgA_9SLj17PgGFwgaNhYQFhc3hAYWNjMTI0MzVlN2I4NDg0YzNjZjE4NTAxNDkyMThhZjkwZjcxNmE1Mm
JmNGE1ZWQzNDdlNDhlY2MxM2Y3NzM4OGFjWCECERFODGd5IXVW-07KaZCvuWHk3WrnnpiDhHki6SCQh88-
iYWlIAK0mjE0fWCZhcIKjYWECYXN4QDEzMjNkM2Q0NzA3YTU4YWQyZTIzYWRhNGU5ZjFmNDlmNWE1YjRhYzdiNzA4ZWIwZDY
xZjczOGY0ODMwN2U4ZWVhY1ghAjRWqhENhLSsdHrr2Cw7AFrKUL9Ffr1XN6RBT6w659lNo2FhAWFzeEA1NmJjYmNiYjdjYzY
0MDZiM2ZhNWQ1N2QyMTc0ZjRlZmY4YjQ0MDJiMTc2OTI2ZDNhNTdkM2MzZGNiYjU5ZDU3YWNYIQJzEpxXGeWZN5qXSmJjY8M
zxWyvwObQGr5G1YCCgHicY2FtdWh0dHA6Ly9sb2NhbGhvc3Q6MzMzOGF1Y3NhdA
```

Binary Token

Tokens can be transmitted in a binary format when applicable (for example when transmitting via NFC). For this the serialized token is prepended with a prefix and a version byte.

`utf8("craw") || utf8(<token_version>) || <serialized_token>`

- Binary Encoding V4: `utf8("craw") || utf8("B") || cbor(token_v4_object)`

NUT-01: Mint public key exchange

`mandatory`

This document outlines the exchange of the public keys of the mint `Bob` with the wallet user `Alice`. `Alice` uses the keys to unblind `Bob`'s blind signatures (see NUT-00).

Description

Wallet user `Alice` receives public keys from mint `Bob` via `GET /v1/keys`. The set of all public keys for a set of amounts is called a *keyset*.

The mint responds only with its `active` keysets. Keysets are `active` if the mint will sign outputs with it. The mint will accept tokens from inactive keysets as inputs but will not sign with them for new outputs. The `active` keysets can change over time, for example due to key rotation. A list of all keysets, active and inactive, can be requested separately (see NUT-02).

Note that a mint can support multiple keysets at the same time but will only respond with the active keysets on the endpoint `GET /v1/keys`. A wallet can ask for the keys of a specific (active or inactive) keyset via the endpoint `GET /v1/keys/{keyset_id}` (see NUT-02).

Supported Currency Units

A mint may support any currency unit(s) they can mint (NUT-04) and melt (NUT-05), either directly or indirectly, including:

- `btc`: Bitcoin (Minor Unit: 8) - though use of the `sat` unit is generally preferred
- `sat`: Bitcoin's Minor Unit (ie: `100,000,000 sat = 1 bitcoin`)
- `msat`: defined as 1/1000th of a `sat` (ie: `1,000 msat = 1 sat`)
- `auth`: reserved for Blind Authentication (see NUT-22).
- ISO 4217 currency codes (eg: `usd`, `eur`, `gbp`)
- Stablecoin currency codes (eg: `usdt`, `usdc`, `eurc`, `gyen`)

  [!IMPORTANT] For Bitcoin, ISO 4217 currencies (and stablecoins pegged to those currencies), Keyset amount values **MUST** represent an amount in the Minor Unit of that currency. Where the Minor Unit of a currency is "`0`", amounts represent whole units. For example:

  - `usd` (Minor Unit: 2) `<amount_1> = 1 cent (0.01 USD)`
  - `jpy` (Minor Unit: 0) `<amount_1> = 1 JPY`
  - `bhd` (Minor Unit: 3) `<amount_1> = 1 fils (0.001 BHD)`
  - `btc` (Minor Unit: 8) `<amount_1> = 1 sat (0.00000001 BTC)`
  - `eurc` (Pegged to EUR, so Minor Unit: 2) `<amount_1> = 1 cent (0.01 EURC)`
  - `gyen` (Pegged to JPY, so Minor Unit: 0) `<amount_1> = 1 GYEN`

Keyset generation

Keysets are generated by the mint. The mint is free to use any key generation method they like. Each keyset is identified by its keyset `id` which can be computed by anyone from its public keys (see NUT-02).

Keys in Keysets are maps of the form `{<amount_1> : <mint_pubkey_1>, <amount_2> : <mint_pubkey_2>, ...}` for each `<amount_i>` of the amounts the mint `Bob` supports and the corresponding public key `<mint_pubkey_i>`, that is `K_i` (see NUT-00). The mint **MUST** use the compressed Secp256k1 public key format to represent its public keys.

Example

Request of `Alice`:

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keys
```

With curl:

```
curl -X GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keys
```

Response `GetKeysResponse` of `Bob`:

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": <keyset_id_hex_str>,
      "unit": <currency_unit_str>,
      "active": <bool>,
      "input_fee_ppk": <int|null>,
      "final_expiry": <unix_timestamp_int|null>,
      "keys": {
        <amount_int>: <public_key_str>,
        ...
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Here, `active` indicates whether the mint will sign new outputs with this keyset, and `input_fee_ppk` is the fee in parts per thousand (ppk) per input spent from this keyset (see NUT-02).

Example response

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "unit": "sat",
      "active": true,
      "input_fee_ppk": 100,
      "final_expiry": 1896187313,
      "keys": {
          "1": "02194603ffa36356f4a56b7df9371fc3192472351453ec7398b8da8117e7c3e104",
          "2": "03b0f36d6d47ce14df8a7be9137712c42bcdd960b19dd02f1d4a9703b1f31d7513",
          "4": "0366be6e026e42852498efb82014ca91e89da2e7a5bd3761bdad699fa2aec9fe09",
          "8": "0253de5237f189606f29d8a690ea719f74d65f617bb1cb6fbea34f2bc4f930016d",
          ...
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Note that for a keyset in an ISO 4217 currency, the key amounts represent values in the Minor Unit of that currency (keys truncated and comments added for clarity):

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": "00a2f293253e41f9",
      "unit": "usd",
      "active": true,
      "input_fee_ppk": 100,
      "final_expiry": 1896187313,
      "keys": {
          "1": "0229...e101", // 1 cent (0.01 USD)
          "2": "03c0...7512", // 2 cents (0.02 USD)
          "4": "0376...fe00", // 4 cents (0.04 USD)
          "8": "0263...016e", // 8 cents (0.08 USD)
          ...
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

NUT-02: Keysets and fees

`mandatory`

A keyset is a set of public keys that the mint `Bob` generates and shares with its users. It refers to the set of public keys that each correspond to the amount values that the mint supports (e.g. `1, 2, 4, 8, ...`) respectively.

Each keyset indicates its keyset `id`, the currency `unit`, whether the keyset is `active`, and an `input_fee_ppk` that determines the fees for spending ecash from this keyset.

A mint can have multiple keysets at the same time. For example, it could have one keyset for each currency `unit` that it supports. Wallets should support multiple keysets. They must respect the `active` and the `input_fee_ppk` properties of the keysets they use.

Keyset properties

Keyset ID

The keyset `id` is the identifier for a specific keyset and can be derived from the public keys and the metadata of a keyset. Wallets **SHOULD** compute the keyset `id` for a given keyset themselves to verify that the mint is using the correct keyset in its responses.

The keyset `id` is part of each `Proof` object which allows wallets to identify which mint and keyset it was generated from. The keyset field `id` is also contained in the `BlindedMessages` sent to the mint and in the `BlindSignatures` returned from it. It is also included in a serialized Cashu `Token` (see NUT-00).

Active keysets

Mints can have multiple keysets at the same time but **MUST** have at least one `active` keyset (see NUT-01). The `active` property determines whether the mint allows generating new ecash from this keyset. `Proofs` from

inactive keysets with `active=false` are still accepted as inputs but new outputs (`BlindedMessages` and `BlindSignatures`) **MUST** be from `active` keysets only.

To rotate keysets, a mint can generate a new active keyset and inactivate an old one. If the `active` flag of an old keyset is set to `false`, no new ecash from this keyset can be generated and the outstanding ecash supply of that keyset can be taken out of circulation as wallets rotate their ecash to active keysets.

Wallets **SHOULD** prioritize swaps with `Proofs` from inactive keysets (see NUT-03) so they can quickly get rid of them. Wallets **CAN** swap their entire balance from an inactive keyset to an active one as soon as they detect that the keyset was inactivated. When constructing outputs for a transaction, wallets **MUST** choose only `active` keysets (see NUT-00).

Fees

Keysets indicate the fee `input_fee_ppk` that is charged when a `Proof` of that keyset is spent as an input to a transaction. The fee is given in parts per thousand (ppk) per input measured in the `unit` of the keyset. The total fee for a transaction is the sum of all fees per input rounded up to the next larger integer (that can be represented with the keyset).

As an example, we construct a transaction spending 3 inputs (`Proofs`) from a keyset with unit `sat` and `input_fee_ppk` of `100`. A fee of `100 ppk` means `0.1 sat` per input. The sum of the individual fees is 300 ppk for this transaction. Rounded up to the next smallest denomination, the mint charges `1 sat` in total fees, i.e. `fees = ceil(0.3) == 1`. In this case, the fees for spending 1-10 inputs is 1 sat, 11-20 inputs is 2 sat and so on.

Wallet transaction construction

When constructing a transaction with ecash `inputs` (example: `/v1/swap` or `/v1/melt/{method}`), wallets **MUST** add fees to the inputs or, vice versa, subtract from the outputs. The mint checks the following equation:

```
sum(inputs) - fees == sum(outputs)
```

Here, `sum(inputs)` and `sum(outputs)` mean the sum of the amounts of the inputs and outputs respectively. `fees` is calculated from the sum of each input's fee and rounded up to the next larger integer:

```
def fees(inputs: List[Proof]) -> int:
  sum_fees = 0
  for proof in inputs:
    sum_fees += keysets[proof.id].input_fee_ppk
  return (sum_fees + 999) // 1000
```

Here, the `//` operator in `(sum_fees + 999) // 1000` denotes an integer division operator (aka floor division operator) that rounds down `sum_fees + 999` to the next lower integer. Alternatively, we could round up the sum using a floating point division with `ceil(sum_fees / 1000)` although it is not recommended to do so due to the non-deterministic behavior of floating point division.

Notice that since transactions can spend inputs from different keysets, the sum considers the fee for each `Proof` indexed by the keyset ID individually.

Deriving the keyset ID

Keyset ID V2

Keyset IDs are 33 byte hex strings with a version byte (two hexadecimal characters). The currently used version byte is `01`.

Keyset IDs are derived from public data. To derive the keyset ID of a keyset, execute the following steps:

```
1 - sort public keys by their amount in ascending numerical order
2 - concatenate each amount and its corresponding lowercase public key hex string (as
"amount:publickey_hex") to a single byte array, separating each pair with a comma (",")
3 - add the lowercase UTF8-encoded unit string prefixed with "|unit:" to the byte array (e.g. "|
unit:sat")
4 - If input_fee_ppk is specified and non-zero, add the UTF8-encoded string prefixed with "|
input_fee_ppk:" (e.g. "|input_fee_ppk:100"). If input_fee_ppk is omitted, null, or 0, it MUST be
omitted from the preimage.
5 - If a final expiration is specified, add the UTF8-encoded string prefixed with "|
final_expiry:" (e.g. "|final_expiry:1896187313")
6 - HASH_SHA256 the concatenated byte array
7 - prefix it with a keyset ID version byte "01"
```

An example implementation in Python:

```python
def derive_keyset_id_v2(keys: Dict[int, PublicKey], unit: str, input_fee_ppk: Optional[int],
        final_expiry: Optional[int]) -> str:
    sorted_keys = dict(sorted(keys.items()))
    keyset_id_bytes = b",".join(
        [f"{k}:{v.serialize()}".encode("utf-8") for k, v in sorted_keys.items()]
    )
    keyset_id_bytes += f"|unit:{unit}".encode("utf-8")
    if input_fee_ppk is not None and input_fee_ppk != 0:
        keyset_id_bytes += f"|input_fee_ppk:{input_fee_ppk}".encode("utf-8")
    if final_expiry is not None and final_expiry != 0:
        keyset_id_bytes += f"|final_expiry:{final_expiry}".encode("utf-8")
    return "01" + hashlib.sha256(keyset_id_bytes).hexdigest()
```

V1 Keysets (deprecated)

V1 keysets are 8 bytes long, including a version byte prefix `00`.

```
1 - sort public keys by their amount in ascending order
2 - concatenate all public keys to one byte array
3 - HASH_SHA256 the concatenated public keys
4 - take the first 14 characters of the hex-encoded hash
5 - prefix it with a keyset ID version byte
```

An example implementation in Python:

```python
def derive_keyset_id_v1(keys: Dict[int, PublicKey]) -> str:
    sorted_keys = dict(sorted(keys.items()))
    pubkeys_concat = b"".join([p.serialize() for p in sorted_keys.values()])
    return "00" + hashlib.sha256(pubkeys_concat).hexdigest()[:14]
```

> [!CAUTION] Wallet implementations should reject any attempt at importing new keysets whose IDs collide with any of the previously added keysets.

Keyset Final Expiry

A unix epoch number for a future point in time that represents the final expiry of the keyset. After the keyset's final expiry, the Mint is no longer obliged to fulfill promises signed with the keys from that keyset.

This effectively implies that the Mint can irrevocably remove all of the nullifiers (`Y` values/spent ecash) associated with the expired keyset.

The final expiry is optional and **MAY** be omitted or `null` if the keyset has no final-expiry.

Example: Get mint keysets

A wallet can ask the mint for a list of all keysets via the `GET /v1/keysets` endpoint.

Request of `Alice`:

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keysets
```

With curl:

```
curl -X GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keysets
```

Response `GetKeysetsResponse` of `Bob`:

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": <hex_str>,
      "unit": <str>,
      "active": <bool>,
      "input_fee_ppk": <int|null>,
      "final_expiry": <int|null>
    },
    ...
  ]
}
```

Here, `id` is the keyset ID, `unit` is the unit string (e.g. "sat") of the keyset, `active` indicates whether new ecash can be minted with this keyset, and `input_fee_ppk` is the fee (per thousand units) to spend one input spent from this keyset. If `input_fee_ppk` is not given, we assume it to be `0`.

Example response

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": "015ba18a8adcd02e715a58358eb618da4a4b3791151a4bee5e968bb88406ccf76a",
      "unit": "sat",
      "active": true,
      "input_fee_ppk": 100,
```

```
      "final_expiry": 2059210353
    },
    {
      "id": "012fbb01a4e200c76df911eeba3b8fe1831202914b24664f4bccbd25852a6708f8",
      "unit": "sat",
      "active": false,
      "input_fee_ppk": 0,
      "final_expiry": null
    }
  ]
}
```

Requesting public keys for a specific keyset

To receive the public keys of a specific keyset, a wallet can call the `GET /v1/keys/{keyset_id}` endpoint where `keyset_id` is the keyset ID.

Example

Request of `Alice`:

We request the keys for the keyset `015ba18a8adcd02e715a58358eb618da4a4b3791151a4bee5e968bb88406ccf76a`.

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keys/
015ba18a8adcd02e715a58358eb618da4a4b3791151a4bee5e968bb88406ccf76a
```

With curl:

```
curl -X GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/keys/
        015ba18a8adcd02e715a58358eb618da4a4b3791151a4bee5e968bb88406ccf76a
```

Response of `Bob` (same as NUT-01):

```
{
  "keysets": [{
    "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
    "unit": "sat",
    "active": true,
    "input_fee_ppk": 100,
    "keys": {
        "1": "02194603ffa36356f4a56b7df9371fc3192472351453ec7398b8da8117e7c3e104",
        "2": "03b0f36d6d47ce14df8a7be9137712c42bcdd960b19dd02f1d4a9703b1f31d7513",
        "4": "0366be6e026e42852498efb82014ca91e89da2e7a5bd3761bdad699fa2aec9fe09",
        "8": "0253de5237f189606f29d8a690ea719f74d65f617bb1cb6fbea34f2bc4f930016d",
        ...
    },
  }, ...
  ]
}
```

Wallet implementation notes

Wallets can request the list of keyset IDs from the mint upon startup and load only tokens from its database that have a keyset ID supported by the mint it interacts with. This also helps wallets to determine whether the mint has added a new current keyset or whether it has changed the `active` flag of an existing one.

A useful flow is:

- If we don't have any keys from this mint yet, get all keys: `GET /v1/keys` and store them
- Get all keysets with `GET /v1/keysets`
- For each new keyset returned here which we don't have yet, get it using `GET /v1/keys/{keyset_id}` and store it
- If any of the keysets has changed its `active` flag, update it in the db and use the keyset accordingly

NUT-06: Mint information

`mandatory`

This endpoint returns information about the mint that a wallet can show to the user and use to make decisions on how to interact with the mint.

Example

Request of `Alice`:

`GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/info`

With the mint's response being of the form `GetInfoResponse`:

```
{
  "name": "Bob's Cashu mint",
  "pubkey": "0283bf290884eed3a7ca2663fc0260de2e2064d6b355ea13f98dec004b7a7ead99",
  "version": "Nutshell/0.15.0",
  "description": "The short mint description",
  "description_long": "A description that can be a long piece of text.",
  "contact": [
    {
      "method": "email",
      "info": "contact@me.com"
    },
    {
      "method": "twitter",
      "info": "@me"
    },
    {
      "method": "nostr",
      "info": "npub..."
    }
  ],
  "motd": "Message to display to users.",
  "icon_url": "https://mint.host/icon.jpg",
```

```
  "urls": [
    "https://mint.host",
    "http://mint8gv0sq5ul602uxt2fe0t80e3c2bi9fy0cxedp69v1vat6ruj81wv.onion"
  ],
  "time": 1725304480,
  "tos_url": "https://mint.host/tos",
  "max_array_length": 1000,
  "nuts": {
    "4": {
      "methods": [
        {
          "method": "bolt11",
          "unit": "sat",
          "min_amount": 0,
          "max_amount": 10000
        }
      ],
      "disabled": false
    },
    "5": {
      "methods": [
        {
          "method": "bolt11",
          "unit": "sat",
          "min_amount": 100,
          "max_amount": 10000
        }
      ],
      "disabled": false
    },
    "7": {
      "supported": true
    },
    "8": {
      "supported": true
    },
    "9": {
      "supported": true
    },
    "10": {
      "supported": true
    },
    "12": {
      "supported": true
    }
  }
}
```


- (optional) `name` is the name of the mint and should be recognizable.
- (optional) `pubkey` is the hex pubkey of the mint.
- (optional) `version` is the implementation name and the version of the software running on this mint separated with a slash "/".
- (optional) `description` is a short description of the mint that can be shown in the wallet next to the mint's name.

- (optional) `description_long` is a long description that can be shown in an additional field.
- (optional) `contact` is an array of contact objects to reach the mint operator. A contact object consists of two fields. The `method` field denotes the contact method (like "email"), the `info` field denotes the identifier (like "contact@me.com").
- (optional) `motd` is the message of the day that the wallet must display to the user. It should only be used to display important announcements to users, such as scheduled maintenances.
- (optional) `icon_url` is the URL pointing to an image to be used as an icon for the mint. Recommended to be squared in shape.
- (optional) `urls` is the list of endpoint URLs where the mint is reachable from.
- (optional) `time` is the current time set on the server. The value is passed as a Unix timestamp integer.
- (optional) `tos_url` is the URL pointing to the Terms of Service of the mint.
- (optional) `max_array_length` is the maximum length the mint accepts for any array in a request, such as `inputs`, `outputs` or `Ys`. Wallets **SHOULD** split larger requests into batches no bigger than this.
- (optional) `nuts` indicates each NUT specification that the mint supports and its settings. The settings are defined in each NUT separately.

With curl:

```
curl -X GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/info
```

Minting, melting, and swapping

These are the three verbs of Cashu.

You mint to turn a payment (usually Lightning) into ecash proofs. You melt to turn proofs back into a payment. You swap to split, combine, or hand proofs to someone else without going out to Lightning at all.

NUT-03, NUT-04, and NUT-05 are mandatory. The rest of this chapter is optional: returning overpaid Lightning fees, paying an invoice from several proofs at once, signing mint quotes so a mint cannot be griefed, and batching mint operations.

The error table at the end is not a numbered NUT. It is the shared list of numeric codes mints return from mint, melt, swap, and a few later specs. Those documents link here; this is the lookup.

In this chapter

- NUT-03 — Swapping tokens
- NUT-04 — Minting tokens
- NUT-05 — Melting tokens
- NUT-08 — Overpaid Lightning fees
- NUT-15 — Partial multi-path payments
- NUT-20 — Signature on mint quote
- NUT-29 — Batched mint
- NUT Errors — shared mint error codes

NUT-03: Swap tokens

`mandatory`

The swap operation is the most important component of the Cashu system. A swap operation consists of multiple inputs (`Proofs`) and outputs (`BlindedMessages`). Mints verify and invalidate the inputs and issue new promises (`BlindSignatures`). These are then used by the wallet to generate new `Proofs` (see NUT-00).

The swap operation can serve multiple use cases. The first use case is that `Alice` can use it to split her tokens to a target amount she needs to send to `Carol`, if she does not have the necessary amounts to compose the target amount in her wallet already. The second one is that `Carol`'s wallet can use it to receive tokens from `Alice` by sending them as inputs to the mint and receive new outputs in return.

Swap to send

To make this more clear, we present an example of a typical case of sending tokens from `Alice` to `Carol`.

`Alice` has 64 sat in her wallet, composed of three `Proofs`, one worth 32 sat and another two worth 16 sat. She wants to send `Carol` 40 sat but does not have the necessary `Proofs` to compose the target amount of 40 sat. For that, `Alice` requests a swap from the mint and uses `Proofs` worth `[16, 16, 32]` as inputs and asks for new outputs worth `[8, 32, 8, 16]` totaling 64 sat. Notice that the first two tokens can now be combined to 40 sat. The `Proofs` that `Alice` sent `Bob` as inputs of the swap operation are now invalidated.

Note: In order to preserve privacy around the amount that a client might want to send to another user and keep the rest as change, the client **SHOULD** ensure that the list of requested outputs is ordered by amount in ascending order. As an example of what to avoid, a request for outputs expressed like so: `[16, 8, 2, 64, 8]` might imply the client is preparing a payment for 26 sat; the client should instead order the list like so: `[2, 8, 8, 16, 64]` to mitigate this privacy leak to the mint.

Swap to receive

Another useful case for the swap operation follows up the example above where `Alice` has swapped her `Proofs` ready to be sent to `Carol`. `Carol` can receive these `Proofs` using the same operation by using them as inputs to invalidate them and request new outputs from `Bob`. Only if `Carol` has redeemed new outputs, `Alice` can't double-spend the `Proofs` anymore and the transaction is settled. To continue our example, `Carol` requests a swap with input `Proofs` worth `[32, 8]` to receive new outputs (of an arbitrary distribution) with the same total amount.

Example

Request of `Alice`:

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/swap
```

With the data being of the form `PostSwapRequest`:

```
{
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>
}
```

All `inputs` and `outputs` of a swap **MUST** be of the same currency unit. The mint **MUST** reject a swap that mixes units (see Error Codes `11009` and `11010`).

With curl:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/swap -d \
{
  "inputs":
    [
      {
        "amount": 2,
        "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
        "secret": "407915bc212be61a77e3e6d2aeb4c727980bda51cd06a6afc29e2861768a7837",
        "C": "02bc9097997d81afb2cc7346b5e4345a9346bd2a506eb7958598a72f0cf85163ea"
      },
      {
      ...
      }
    ],
  "outputs":
    [
      {
        "amount": 2,
        "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
        "B_": "02634a2c2b34bec9e8a4aba4361f6bf202d7fa2365379b0840afe249a7a9d71239"
      },
      {
      ...
      }
    ],
}
```

If successful, `Bob` will respond with a `PostSwapResponse`

```
{
  "signatures": <Array[BlindSignature]>
}
```

NUT-04: Mint tokens

`mandatory`

`used in: NUT-20, NUT-23`

Minting tokens is a two-step process: requesting a mint quote and minting new tokens. This document describes the general flow that applies to all payment methods, with specifics for each supported payment method provided in dedicated NUTs.

Supported methods

Method-specific NUTs describe how to handle different payment methods. The currently specified methods are:

- NUT-23 for bolt11 Lightning invoices
- NUT-25 for bolt12 Lightning offers

- NUT-30 for onchain Bitcoin transactions

General Flow

The minting process follows these steps for all payment methods:

1. The wallet requests a mint quote for the `unit` to mint, specifying the payment `method`.
2. The mint responds with a quote that includes a `quote` id and a payment `request`.
3. The user pays the `request` using the specified payment method.
4. The wallet then requests minting of new tokens with the mint, including the `quote` id and new `outputs`.
5. The mint verifies payment and returns blind signatures.

Common Request and Response Formats

Requesting a Mint Quote

To request a mint quote, the wallet of `Alice` makes a `POST /v1/mint/quote/{method}` request where `method` is the payment method requested (e.g., `bolt11`, `bolt12`, etc.). `method` **MUST** match `[a-z0-9_-]+`.

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/quote/{method}
```

Depending on the payment method, the request structure may vary, but all methods will include at minimum:

```
{
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "amount": <int>,        // Optional
  "description": <str>,   // Optional
  "pubkey": <str>         // Optional, NUT-20
  // Additional method-specific fields may be required
}
```

`amount`, `description` and `pubkey` are common optional fields; method-specific NUTs make them required or ignore them as needed (e.g. NUT-23 requires `amount`, NUT-20 defines `pubkey`).

The mint `Bob` responds with a quote that includes some common fields for all methods:

```
{
  "quote": <str>, // UUID v7
  "request": <str>,
  "unit":  <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "expiry": <int|null>,
  "pubkey": <str>,            // Optional
  "method": <str>,
  "amount_paid": <int>,
  "amount_issued": <int>,
  "updated_at": <int>,
  // Additional method-specific fields will be included
}
```

Where:

- `quote` is the quote ID in UUIDv7 format
- `request` is the payment request for the quote

- `unit` corresponds to the value provided in the request
- `expiry` is the Unix timestamp until which the `request` can be paid (`null` if it does not expire)
- `method` is the payment method of the quote
- `amount_paid` is the total amount that has been paid to the mint for this quote, denominated in `unit`
- `amount_issued` is the total amount of ecash that has been issued for this quote, denominated in `unit`
- `updated_at` is a Unix timestamp integer indicating when the quote was last updated

Mints **MUST** include `amount_paid`, `amount_issued`, and `updated_at` in all mint quote responses. `amount_paid` and `amount_issued` **MUST** be non-negative integers, and `amount_issued` **MUST NOT** exceed `amount_paid`.

The amount currently mintable for a quote is `amount_paid - amount_issued`. Mints **MUST NOT** issue ecash whose total output amount exceeds `amount_paid - amount_issued`. If a wallet mints less than the currently mintable amount, `amount_issued` only increases by the amount that was issued.

`expiry` is a deadline for payment, not for issuance. Mints **MUST NOT** refuse to issue a quote's currently mintable amount solely because `expiry` has passed. Mints **MAY** credit payments received after `expiry` (for example, a late on-chain payment).

Mints **MUST** update `updated_at` whenever `amount_paid` or `amount_issued` changes. Mints **MUST** ensure that `updated_at` monotonically increases for each quote, even if multiple updates occur within the same timestamp resolution. Wallets that receive multiple responses for the same quote **MUST NOT** replace locally stored quote data with a response whose `updated_at` is lower than the latest processed value for that quote. Wallets **MUST NOT** decrease locally stored `amount_paid` or `amount_issued` values based on stale responses.

> [!CAUTION]
>
> `quote` is a **unique and random** id generated by the mint to internally look up the payment state. `quote` **SHOULD** be UUID v7 with all 74 variable bits generated by a CSPRNG and **MUST** remain a secret between user and mint and **MUST NOT** be derivable from the payment request. A third party who knows the `quote` ID can front-run and steal the tokens that this operation mints. To prevent this, use NUT-20 locks to enforce public key authentication during minting.

Check Mint Quote

To check the current accounting data of a mint quote, the wallet makes a `GET /v1/mint/quote/{method}/{quote_id}`.

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/quote/{method}/{quote_id}
```

The mint responds with the same structure as the initial quote response.

Executing a Mint Quote

After requesting a mint quote and paying the request, the wallet proceeds with minting new tokens by calling the `POST /v1/mint/{method}` endpoint.

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/{method}
```

The wallet includes the following common data in its request:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>
}
```

with the `quote` being the quote ID from the previous step and `outputs` being `BlindedMessages` (see NUT-00) that the wallet requests signatures on. The total output amount **MUST NOT** exceed the quote's currently mintable amount, `amount_paid - amount_issued`.

The mint then responds with:

```
{
  "signatures": <Array[BlindSignature]>
}
```

where `signatures` is an array of blind signatures on the outputs.

Custom Payment Methods

Payment methods not specified in a dedicated NUT can be supported as custom payment methods. A custom payment method is identified by a lowercase string `{method}` (e.g., `paypal`, `stripe`, `onchain-payment-processor`). The `{method}` string **MUST** contain only ASCII alphanumeric characters, hyphens (`-`), and underscores (`_`), and **MUST** be non-empty.

Mint Quote

For a custom `{method}`, the wallet sends a request following the common mint quote request format (see General Flow). Method-specific fields (e.g., an `amount` of tokens to mint, a `description`, or a `pubkey` for NUT-20 locks) are defined by the method-specific NUT.

The mint responds with the common mint quote response format and **MUST** include the `amount_paid`, `amount_issued` and `updated_at` accounting fields. The `request` field contains the method-specific payment request (e.g., a payment URL, an on-chain address, an account identifier). Additional method-specific fields are defined by the method-specific NUT.

Method-Specific Fields

Custom payment methods **MAY** include additional fields in requests and responses. Implementations **MUST** ignore unrecognized fields to preserve forward compatibility. When a custom method gains widespread adoption, its fields **MAY** be formalized in a dedicated NUT.

Custom payment methods **MAY** include extra fields that the mint forwards to a third party payment processor without validation.

Adding New Payment Methods

To add a new payment method (e.g., BOLT12), implement the following:

1. Define the method-specific request and response structures following the pattern above
2. Implement the three required endpoints: quote request, quote check, and mint execution
3. Update the settings to include the new method

Settings

The settings for this NUT indicate the supported method-unit pairs for minting. They are part of the info response of the mint (NUT-06) which reads:

```
{
  "4": {
    "methods": [
      <MintMethodSetting>,
      ...
    ],
    "disabled": <bool>
  }
}
```

`MintMethodSetting` indicates supported `method` and `unit` pairs and additional settings of the mint. `disabled` indicates whether minting is disabled.

`MintMethodSetting` is of the form:

```
{
  "method": <str>,
  "unit": <str>,
  "method_name": <str|null>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>,
  "options": <Object|null>
}
```

`min_amount` and `max_amount` indicate the minimum and maximum amount for an operation of this method-unit pair. `options` are method-specific and can be defined in method-specific NUTs.

`method_name` is a human-readable name for the payment method. If `null` or omitted, wallets **SHOULD** derive it from `method` by replacing `_` and `-` with spaces and title-casing each word (e.g. `bolt11` -> `Bolt11`, `apple-pay` -> `Apple Pay`).

Unblinding Signatures

Upon receiving the `BlindSignatures` from the mint, the wallet unblinds them to generate `Proofs` (using the blinding factor `r` and the mint's public key `K`, see BDHKE NUT-00). The wallet then stores these `Proofs` in its database.

NUT-05: Melting tokens

`mandatory`

`used in: NUT-08, NUT-15, NUT-23`

Melting tokens is the opposite of minting tokens (see NUT-04). Like minting tokens, melting is a two-step process: requesting a melt quote and melting tokens. This document describes the general flow that applies to

all payment methods, with specifics for each supported payment method provided in dedicated method-specific NUTs.

Supported methods

Method-specific NUTs describe how to handle different payment methods. The currently specified methods are:

- NUT-23 for bolt11 Lightning invoices
- NUT-25 for bolt12 Lightning offers
- NUT-30 for onchain Bitcoin transactions

General Flow

The melting process follows these steps for all payment methods:

1. The wallet requests a melt quote for a `request` it wants paid by the mint, specifying the payment `method` and the `unit` the wallet would like to spend
2. The mint responds with a quote that includes a `quote` id and an `amount` demanded in the requested unit
3. The wallet sends a melting request including the `quote` id and provides `inputs` of the required amount
4. The mint executes the payment and responds with the payment `state` and any method-specific proof of payment

Synchronous vs Asynchronous Processing

Synchronous (Default): Unless the payment method requires asynchronous execution, the melt request blocks until payment completion. This ensures immediate finality but may result in long request times for slow payment methods.

Asynchronous: A method-specific NUT can require asynchronous execution for a payment method. For other methods, the wallet can request asynchronous execution with `prefer_async: true` in the melt request body if it is supported by the mint. In both cases, the request returns immediately after validation with a `"PENDING"` state. The wallet must then monitor the payment progress through polling or websocket notifications.

Common Request and Response Formats

Requesting a Melt Quote

To request a melt quote, the wallet of `Alice` makes a `POST /v1/melt/quote/{method}` request where `method` is the payment method requested (e.g., `bolt11`, `bolt12`, etc.). `method` **MUST** match `[a-z0-9_-]+`.

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/{method}
```

Depending on the payment method, the request structure may vary, but all methods will include at minimum:

```
{
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "amount": <int>   // Optional
```

```
  // Additional method-specific fields will be required
}
```

`amount` is a common optional field; method-specific NUTs make it required or ignore it as needed (e.g. NUT-30 requires `amount` for onchain melts).

The mint `Bob` responds with a quote that includes some common fields for all methods:

```
{
  "quote": <str>, // UUID v7
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "fee_reserve": <int>,     // Optional
  "method": <str>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>
  // Additional method-specific fields will be included
}
```

Where

- `quote` is the quote ID string in UUID v7 format with all 74 variable bits generated by a CSPRNG
- `request` is the method-specific payment routing target
- `amount` and `unit` are the amount and unit that need to be provided
- `fee_reserve` is the additional fee reserve for using the method (the wallet provides proofs covering at least `amount + fee_reserve + fee`, where `fee` is the keyset input fee per NUT-02)
- `method` is the payment method of the quote
- `expiry` is the Unix timestamp until which the melt quote is valid.

`state` is an enum string field with possible values `"UNPAID"`, `"PENDING"`, `"PAID"`:

- `"UNPAID"` means that the request has not been paid yet.
- `"PENDING"` means that the request is currently being paid.
- `"PAID"` means that the request has been paid successfully.

Check Melt Quote State

To check whether a melt quote has been paid, the wallet makes a `GET /v1/melt/quote/{method}/{quote_id}`.

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/{method}/{quote_id}
```

The mint responds with the same structure as the initial quote response.

Executing a Melt Quote

To execute the melting process, the wallet calls the `POST /v1/melt/{method}` endpoint.

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/{method}
```

The wallet includes the following common data in its request:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "prefer_async": <bool> // optional: false if omitted
  // Additional method-specific fields may be required
}
```

where `quote` is the melt quote ID, `inputs` are the proofs with a total amount sufficient to cover the requested amount plus any fees, and `prefer_async` requests asynchronous processing when set to `true`.

The `inputs`, and any NUT-08 change `outputs`, **MUST** be of the unit of the melt quote. The mint **MUST** reject a melt that mixes units (see Error Codes `11009` and `11010`).

Synchronous Processing

> [!IMPORTANT] For methods that involve external payments (like Lightning), a synchronous call will block until the payment either succeeds or fails. This can take a long time. Make sure to **use no (or a very long) timeout when making this call**!

Asynchronous Processing

If the method-specific NUT requires asynchronous execution, the mint **MUST** process melt requests for that method asynchronously. The wallet does not need to set `prefer_async`.

For other methods, the wallet can set `prefer_async` to `true` in the melt request body to request asynchronous processing.

When asynchronous processing is used:

1. The mint will verify the request (including proof validation)
2. If valid, the mint responds immediately with a `200 OK` status and the quote state set to `"PENDING"`
3. The payment processing begins in the background
4. The wallet can poll the quote state endpoint or subscribe to websocket notifications to monitor payment progress

If the method-specific NUT does not require asynchronous execution and the mint does not support asynchronous processing for the method, the mint ignores `prefer_async` and processes the request synchronously. The response follows the standard synchronous flow with final payment state.

Synchronous Response

For synchronous processing, the mint responds with a structure that indicates the final payment state and includes any method-specific proof of payment when successful.

Asynchronous Response

For asynchronous processing, the mint responds with:

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Content-Type: application/json
```

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "state": "PENDING",
  "expiry": <int>
  // Additional method-specific fields may be included
}
```

The wallet should then either:

- Poll the quote state using `GET /v1/melt/quote/{method}/{quote_id}`
- Subscribe to websocket notifications for real-time updates (if supported by the mint)

Example Asynchronous Flow

1. **Request asynchronous melt:**

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/bolt11
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-89e2-35fe79f92c0e",
  "inputs": [...],
  "prefer_async": true
}
```

1. **Immediate response (200 OK):**

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-89e2-35fe79f92c0e",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt11",
  "state": "PENDING",
  "expiry": 1701704757
}
```

1. **Poll for status:**

```
GET https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt11/019e6d5a-2347-7000-89e2-35fe79f92c0e
```

1. **Final status response:**

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-89e2-35fe79f92c0e",
  "request": "lnbc100n1p3kdrv5sp5...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "fee_reserve": 2,
  "state": "PAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
```

```
  "payment_preimage": "c5a1ae1f639e1f4a3872e81500fd028bece7bedc1152f740cba5c3417b748c1b"
}
```

Custom Payment Methods

Payment methods not specified in a dedicated NUT can be supported as custom payment methods. See NUT-04 for the custom method identifier definition and general conventions.

Melt Quote

For a custom `{method}`, the wallet sends a request following the common melt quote request format (see General Flow). The `request` field is the method-specific payment target (e.g., a bank account identifier, an on-chain address, a payment processor reference). `unit` is the unit the wallet would like to pay with.

The mint responds with the common melt quote response format, using the standard `state` values (`"UNPAID"`, `"PENDING"`, `"PAID"`). Method-specific fields are defined by the method-specific NUT.

Adding New Payment Methods

To add a new payment method (e.g., BOLT12), implement the following:

1. Define the method-specific request and response structures following the pattern above
2. Implement the three required endpoints: quote request, quote check, and melt execution
3. Update the settings to include the new method
4. Document any method-specific fields or behaviors that differ from the general flow

Settings

The mint's settings for this NUT indicate the supported method-unit pairs for melting. They are part of the info response of the mint (NUT-06):

```
{
  "5": {
    "methods": [
      <MeltMethodSetting>,
      ...
    ],
    "disabled": <bool>
  }
}
```

`MeltMethodSetting` indicates supported `method` and `unit` pairs and additional settings of the mint. `disabled` indicates whether melting is disabled.

`MeltMethodSetting` is of the form:

```
{
  "method": <str>,
  "unit": <str>,
  "method_name": <str|null>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>,
```

```
  "options": <Object|null>
}
```

`min_amount` and `max_amount` indicate the minimum and maximum amount for an operation of this method-unit pair. `options` are method-specific and can be defined in method-specific NUTs.

`method_name` is a human-readable name for the payment method. If `null` or omitted, wallets **SHOULD** derive it from `method` by replacing _ and – with spaces and title-casing each word (e.g. `bolt11` -> `Bolt11`, `apple-pay` -> `Apple Pay`).

NUT-08: Lightning fee return

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-05`

This document describes how the overpaid Lightning fees are handled and extends NUT-05 which describes melting tokens (i.e. paying a Lightning invoice). In short, a wallet includes *blank outputs* when paying a Lightning invoice which can be assigned a value by the mint if the user has overpaid Lightning fees. This can be the case due to the unpredictability of Lightning network fees. To solve this issue, we introduce so-called *blank outputs* which are blinded messages with an undetermined value.

The problem is also described in this gist.

Description

Before requesting a Lightning payment as described in NUT-05, `Alice` produces a number of `BlindedMessages` which are similar to ordinary blinded messages but their value is yet to be determined by the mint `Bob` and are thus called *blank outputs*. The number of necessary blank outputs is `max(ceil(log2(fee_reserve)), 1)` which ensures that there is at least one output if there is any fee. If the `fee_reserve` is `0`, then the number of blank outputs is `0` as well. The blank outputs will contain the overpaid fees that will be returned by the mint to the wallet.

This code calculates the number of necessary blank outputs in Python:

```python
def calculate_number_of_blank_outputs(fee_reserve_sat: int) -> int:
    assert fee_reserve_sat >= 0, "Fee reserve can't be negative."
    if fee_reserve_sat == 0:
        return 0
    return max(math.ceil(math.log2(fee_reserve_sat)), 1)
```

Example

The wallet wants to pay an invoice with `amount := 100 000 sat` and determines by asking the mint that `fee_reserve` is `1000 sats`. The wallet then provides `101 000 sat` worth of proofs and 10 blank `outputs` to make the payment (since `ceil(log2(1000))=ceil(9.96..)=10`). The mint pays the invoice and determines that the actual fee was `100 sat`, i.e., the overpaid fee to return is `fee_return = 900 sat`. The mint splits the amount `900` into summands of `2^n` which is `4, 128, 256, 512`. The mint inserts these amounts into the blank `outputs`

it received from the wallet and generates 4 new promises. The mint then returns these `BlindSignatures` to the wallet together with the successful payment status.

Wallet flow

The wallet asks the mint for the `fee_reserve` for paying a specific bolt11 invoice of value `amount` by calling `POST /v1/melt/quote/bolt11` as described in NUT-05. The wallet then provides a `PostMeltBolt11Request` to `POST /v1/melt/bolt11` that has (1) proofs of the value `amount+fee+fee_reserve`, (2) the bolt11 invoice to be paid, and finally, as a new entry, (3) a field `outputs` that has `n_blank_outputs` blinded messages that are generated before the payment attempt to receive potential overpaid fees back to her.

Mint flow

Here we describe how the mint generates `BlindSignatures` for the overpaid fees. The mint `Bob` returns in `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Response` the field `change` **ONLY IF** `Alice` has previously provided `outputs` for the change **AND** if the `inputs` provided were greater than the `total_amount_paid - fees`.

If the `overpaid_fees = input_amount - fees - total_paid` is positive, `Bob` decomposes it to amounts supported by the keyset, typically `2^n`, and imprints them into the `blank_outputs` provided by `Alice`.

`Bob` then signs these blank outputs (now with the imprinted amounts) and thus generates `BlindSignatures`. `Bob` then returns a payment status to the wallet, and, in addition, all blind signatures it generated for the overpaid fees.

Importantly, while `Bob` does not necessarily return the same number of blind signatures as it received blank outputs from `Alice` (since some of them may be of value 0), `Bob` **MUST** return all blind signatures with a value greater than 0 in the same order as the blank outputs were received and should omit all blind signatures with value 0. For example, if `Bob` receives 10 blank outputs but the overpaid fees only occupy 4 blind signatures, `Bob` will only return these 4 blind signatures with the appropriate imprinted amounts and omit the remaining 6 blind signatures with value 0. Due to the well-defined order of the returned blind signatures, `Alice` can map the blind signatures returned from `Bob` to the blank outputs it provided so that she can further apply the correct unblinding operations on them.

Example

Request of `Alice`:

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/bolt11
```

With the data being of the form `PostMeltBolt11Request`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]> <-- New
}
```

where the new `outputs` field carries the `BlindedMessages`.

The mint `Bob` then responds with a `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "fee_reserve": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "payment_preimage": <str|null>,
  "change": <Array[BlindSignature]> <-- New
}
```

where the new `change` field carries the returned `BlindSignatures` due to overpaid fees.

Example

Request of `Alice` with curl:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/bolt11 -d \
'{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-813e-a11ea6e419e7",
  "inputs": [
    {
      "amount": 4,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "secret": "429700b812a58436be2629af8731a31a37fce54dbf8cbbe90b3f8553179d23f5",
      "C": "03b01869f528337e161a6768b480fcf9f75fd248b649c382f5e352489fd84fd011"
    },
    {
      "amount": 8,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "secret": "4f3155acef6481108fcf354f6d06e504ce8b441e617d30c88924991298cdbcad",
      "C": "0278ab1c1af35487a5ea903b693e96447b2034d0fd6bac529e753097743bf73ca9"
    }
  ],
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 0,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "03327fc4fa333909b70f08759e217ce5c94e6bf1fc2382562f3c560c5580fa69f4"
    }
  ]
}'
```

Everything here is the same as in NUT-05 except for `outputs`. `Alice` **MUST** set the `amount` of each blank output to `0`, and `Bob` **MUST** ignore it, imprinting the amount himself.

If the mint has made a successful payment, it will respond the following.

Response `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Response` from `Bob`:

```
{
  "state": "PAID",
  "payment_preimage": "c5a1ae1f639e1f4a3872e81500fd028bece7bedc1152f740cba5c3417b748c1b",
  "change": [
```

```
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 2,
      "C_": "03c668f551855ddc792e22ea61d32ddfa6a45b1eb659ce66e915bf5127a8657be0"
    }
  ]
}
```

The field `change` is an array of `BlindSignatures` that account for the overpaid fees. Notice that the amount has been changed by the mint. `Alice` must take these and generate `Proofs` by unblinding them as described in NUT-00 and as she does in NUT-04 when minting new tokens. After generating the `Proofs`, `Alice` stores them in her database.

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "8": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-15: Partial multi-path payments

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-05`

In this document, we describe how wallets can instruct multiple mints to each pay a partial amount of a bolt11 Lightning invoice. The full payment is composed of partial payments (MPP) from multiple multi-path payments from different Lightning nodes. This way, wallets can pay a larger Lightning invoice combined from multiple smaller balances on different mints. Due to the atomic nature of MPP, either all payments will be successful or all of them will fail.

The Lightning backend of the mint must support paying a partial amount of an Invoice and multi-path payments (MPP, see BOLT 4). For example, the mint's Lightning node must be able to pay 50 sats of a 100 sat bolt11 invoice. The receiving Lightning node must support receiving multi-path payments as well.

Multimint payment execution

`Alice`'s wallet coordinates multiple MPPs on different mints that support the feature (see below for the indicated setting). For a given Lightning invoice of `amount_total`, `Alice` splits the total amount into several partial amounts `amount_total = amount_1 + amount_2 + ...` that each must be covered by her individual balances on the mints she wants to use for the payment. She constructs multiple `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Requests` that each include the corresponding partial amount in the payment option (see below) that she sends to all mints she wants to use for the payment. The mints then respond with a normal `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Response` (see NUT-05). `Alice` proceeds to pay the melt requests at each mint

simultaneously. When all mints have sent out the partial Lightning payment, she receives a successful response from all mints individually.

Melt quote

To request a melt quote with a partial `amount`, the wallet of `Alice` makes a `POST /v1/melt/quote/bolt11` similar to NUT-05.

`POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt11`

The wallet `Alice` includes the following `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Request` data in its request which includes an additional (and optional) `options` object compared to the standard request in NUT-05:

```
{
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum["sat"]>,
  "options": {
    "mpp": {
      "amount": <int>
    }
  }
}
```

Here, `request` is the bolt11 Lightning invoice to be paid, `unit` is the unit the wallet would like to pay with. `amount` is the partial amount for the requested payment in millisats (msat). The wallet then pays the returned melt quote the same way as in NUT-05.

Mint info setting

The settings returned in the info endpoint (NUT-06) indicate that a mint supports this NUT. The mint MUST indicate each `method` and `unit` that supports mpp. It can indicate this in an array of objects for multiple `method` and `unit` pairs.

`MultipathPaymentSetting` is of the form:

```
{
  "methods": [
    {
      "method": <str>,
      "unit": <str>
    },
    ...
  ]
}
```

Example `MultipathPaymentSetting`:

```
{
  "15": {
    "methods": [
      {
        "method": "bolt11",
        "unit": "sat"
```

```
      },
      {
        "method": "bolt11",
        "unit": "usd"
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

NUT-20: Signature on Mint Quote

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-04`

This NUT defines signature-based authentication for mint quote redemption. When requesting a mint quote, clients provide a public key. The mint will then require a valid signature from the corresponding secret key to process the mint operation.

> [!CAUTION]
>
> NUT-04 mint quotes without a public key can be minted by anyone who knows the mint quote id without providing a signature.

Mint quote

To request a mint quote, the wallet of `Alice` makes a `POST /v1/mint/quote/{method}` request where `method` is the payment method requested. We present an example with the `method` being `bolt11` here.

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt11
```

The wallet of `Alice` includes the following `PostMintQuoteBolt11Request` data in its request:

```
{
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum["sat"]>,
  "description": <str|null>, // Optional
  "pubkey": <str|null> // Optional <-- New
}
```

with the requested `amount`, `unit`, and `description` according to NUT-04.

`pubkey` is the compressed secp256k1 public key (33 bytes, hex-encoded) that will be required for signature verification during the minting operation. The mint will only mint ecash after receiving a valid signature from the corresponding private key in the subsequent `PostMintBolt11Request`.

> [!IMPORTANT]
>
> **Privacy:** To prevent the mint from being able to link multiple mint quotes, wallets **SHOULD** generate a unique public key for each mint quote request.

Deterministic quote locking key derivation

Wallets can deterministically generate private keys for NUT-20 quote locking from their wallet seed.

The following BIP32 derivation path is used to derive the private key:

`m/129373'/20'/0'/0'/{counter}`

Where:

- `129373'` is the Cashu wallet derivation namespace.
- `20'` is the wallet derivation index for NUT-20 quote locking keys.
- `{counter}` is an incrementing, non-hardened BIP32 child index.

The wallet **SHOULD** use a new counter value for each mint quote request. The NUT-20 quote locking counter is independent from NUT-13 keyset counters and other wallet derivation counters.

The wallet uses the compressed secp256k1 public key derived from the private key as the quote `pubkey`. This allows a wallet to restore the private key needed to sign for unpaid or paid NUT-20 locked mint quotes during a recovery process.

The mint `Bob` then responds with a `PostMintQuoteBolt11Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit":  <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt11",
  "amount_paid": <int>,
  "amount_issued": <int>,
  "updated_at": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>, // Deprecated, optional
  "expiry": <int|null>,
  "pubkey": <str|null> // Optional <-- New
}
```

The response is the same as the `bolt11` mint quote response in NUT-23 except for `pubkey` which has been provided by the wallet in the previous request.

Example

Request of `Alice` with curl:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt11 -d '{"amount": 10, "unit": "sat",
        "pubkey": "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac"}' -H
        "Content-Type: application/json"
```

Response of `Bob`:

```
{
  "quote": "9d745270-1405-46de-b5c5-e2762b4f5e00",
  "request": "lnbc100n1pj4apw9...",
  "amount": 10,
```

```
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt11",
  "amount_paid": 0,
  "amount_issued": 0,
  "updated_at": 1701704657,
  "state": "UNPAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "pubkey": "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac"
}
```


Signing the mint request

Message aggregation

To authenticate a mint request, the signer commits to the quote ID and all `BlindedMessages` (the outputs, see NUT-00) of the `PostMintBolt11Request`, in the order they appear in the request. The message is built over raw bytes:

```
msg_to_sign = b"Cashu_MintQuoteSig_v1"
              || len32(quote) || quote
              || for each output i (in request order):
                   len32(amount_i) || amount_i
                   || len32(B_i)   || B_i
```

Where:

- `b"Cashu_MintQuoteSig_v1"` is the domain-separation tag as raw ASCII bytes, not length-prefixed.
- `||` denotes byte concatenation and `len32(x)` is the 32-bit (4-byte) big-endian length of the byte array `x` in bytes.
- `quote` is the UTF-8 quote id from the `PostMintQuoteBolt11Response`.
- `amount_i` is the output amount as canonical minimal big-endian bytes (e.g. `0` → empty byte array, `1` → `0x01`, `256` → `0x0100`); thus `len32(amount_i)` is its length in bytes as a 32-bit integer (e.g. `0` for amount `0`, `1` for amount `1`, `2` for amount `256`).
- `B_i` is the raw byte representation of the blinded message (e.g. 33-byte compressed secp256k1 or 48-byte BLS12-381 point), decoded from the request's hex string.

Signature scheme

To mint a quote where a public key was provided, the wallet includes a signature on `msg_to_sign` in the `PostMintBolt11Request`. We use a BIP340 Schnorr signature on the SHA-256 hash of the message to sign as defined above.

Minting tokens

After requesting a mint quote and paying the request, the wallet proceeds with minting new tokens by calling the `POST /v1/mint/{method}` endpoint where `method` is the payment method requested (here `bolt11`).

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/bolt11
```

The wallet `Alice` includes the following `PostMintBolt11Request` data in its request

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>,
  "signature": <str|null> <-- New
}
```

with the `quote` being the quote ID from the previous step and `outputs` being `BlindedMessages` as in NUT-04.

`signature` is the signature on the `msg_to_sign` as defined above.

The mint responds with a `PostMintBolt11Response` as in NUT-04 if all validations are successful.

Example

Request of `Alice` with curl:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/bolt11 -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d \
'{
  "quote": "9d745270-1405-46de-b5c5-e2762b4f5e00",
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 8,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "035015e6d7ade60ba8426cefaf1832bbd27257636e44a76b922d78e79b47cb689d"
    },
    {
      "amount": 2,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "0288d7649652d0a83fc9c966c969fb217f15904431e61a44b14999fabc1b5d9ac6"
    }
  ],
  "signature":
        "d9be080b33179387e504bb6991ea41ae0dd715e28b01ce9f63d57198a095bccc776874914288e6989e97ac9d255ac667c20

}'
```

Response of `Bob`:

```
{
  "signatures": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 2,
      "C_": "0224f1c4c564230ad3d96c5033efdc425582397a5a7691d600202732edc6d4b1ec"
    },
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 8,
      "C_": "0277d1de806ed177007e5b94a8139343b6382e472c752a74e99949d511f7194f6c"
    }
  ]
}
```

Errors

If the wallet user `Alice` does not include a signature on the `PostMintBolt11Request` but did include a `pubkey` in the `PostMintQuoteBolt11Request` then `Bob` **MUST** respond with an error. `Alice` **CAN** repeat the request with a valid signature.

See Error Codes:

- `20008`: Mint quote with `pubkey` but no valid `signature` provided for mint request.
- `20009`: Mint quote requires `pubkey` but none given or invalid `pubkey`.

Settings

The settings for this NUT indicate the support for requiring a signature before minting. They are part of the info response of the mint (NUT-06) which in this case reads

```
{
  "20": {
    "supported": <bool>
  }
}
```

NUT-29: Batched Minting

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-04`

`uses: NUT-20`

This spec describes how a wallet can mint multiple quotes in one batched operation by requesting blind signatures for multiple quotes in a single atomic request.

1. Batch Checking Mint Quotes

Before minting, the wallet SHOULD verify each mint quote's current accounting state. It does this by sending:

`POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/quote/{method}/check`

The wallet includes the following body in its request:

```
{
  "quotes": <Array[str]>
}
```

where `quotes` is an array of *unique* mint quote IDs.

The mint returns a JSON array of mint quote objects as defined by the payment method's NUT specification. The quotes in this array MUST be in the same order as in the request.

Example

Below is an example for checking two bolt11 mint quotes.

Request

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt11/check
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "quotes": [ "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8037-b42dae20f1fe", "019e6d5a-2347-7000-868a-08e59a1c6716" ]
}
```

Response

```
[
  {
    "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8037-b42dae20f1fe",
    "request": "lnbc...",
    "amount_paid": 100,
    "amount_issued": 0,
    "updated_at": 1234567800,
    "state": "PAID",
    "unit": "sat",
    "amount": 100,
    "expiry": 1234567890
  },
  {
    "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-868a-08e59a1c6716",
    "request": "lnbc...",
    "amount_paid": 0,
    "amount_issued": 0,
    "updated_at": 1234567800,
    "state": "UNPAID",
    "unit": "sat",
    "amount": 50,
    "expiry": 1234567890
  }
]
```

Error Handling

This is a query endpoint that uses all-or-nothing error handling, matching the behavior of the batch mint endpoint:

- If any `quote_id` is not known by the mint, the mint MUST reject the entire request and return an appropriate error
- If any `quote_id` cannot be parsed (invalid format), the mint MUST reject the entire request and return an appropriate error

---

2. Executing the Batched Mint

Request by wallet

Once all quoted payments are confirmed, the wallet mints the proofs by calling:

`POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/{method}/batch`

The batch endpoint is method-specific: every quote in the batch **MUST** be for the same payment `method` as the `{method}` in the URL, and a batch that mixes payment methods **MUST** be rejected by the mint.

The wallet includes the following body in its request:

```
{
  "quotes": <Array[str]>,
  "quote_amounts": <Array[int]|null>, // Optional
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>,
  "signatures": <Array[string]|null> // Optional
}
```

- `quotes`: array of *unique* quote IDs.
- `quote_amounts`: array of expected amounts to mint per quote, in the same order as `quotes`.
    - Required for payment methods that demand an amount like bolt12; Optional for other methods like bolt11.
- `outputs`: array of blinded messages (see NUT-00).
- `signatures`: array of signatures for NUT-20 locked quotes. See NUT-20 Support

Response by mint

The mint responds with:

```
{
  "signatures": <Array[BlindSignature]>
}
```

- `signatures`: an array of blind signatures, one for each provided blinded message, in the same order as the `outputs` array.

Example

Below is an example for minting two NUT-20 locked bolt11 mint quotes.

Request

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/bolt11/batch
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "quotes": [
    "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8037-b42dae20f1fe",
    "019e6d5a-2347-7000-868a-08e59a1c6716"
  ],
```

```
  "quote_amounts": [
    100,
    50
  ],
  "signatures": [

"d9be080b33179387e504bb6991ea41ae0dd715e28b01ce9f63d57198a095bccc776874914288e6989e97ac9d255ac66
7c205fa8d90a211184b417b4ffdd24092",

"f2d97118390195cf5bef21d84c94e505dcdc2760154519536f74ba5e27f886f313b82296610df14db1d91d346e988ed
384070bad084aaf06d14ccd7686157f24"
  ],
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 128,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "035015e6d7ade60ba8426cefaf1832bbd27257636e44a76b922d78e79b47cb689d"
    },
    {
      "amount": 16,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "0288d7649652d0a83fc9c966c969fb217f15904431e61a44b14999fabc1b5d9ac6"
    },
    {
      "amount": 4,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "02c6047f9441ed7d6d3045406e95c07cd85c778e4b8cef3ca7abac09b95c709ee5"
    },
    {
      "amount": 2,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "02f9308a019258c31049344f85f89d5229b531c845836f99b08601f113bce036f9"
    }
  ]
}
```

Response

```
{
  "signatures": [
    "0208657b2917f469f275226cc931e5389451f6eed515d586ad16fa7a700eed4fb6",
    "037dc0b5e712a39ef22f5bba1d49bc65a323ab9e0b771f7281d8c33280e2e58dbc"
  ]
}
```

Request Validation

The mint MUST validate the following before processing a batch mint request:

1. **Non-empty batch**: The `quotes` array MUST NOT be empty
2. **Unique quotes**: All quote IDs in the `quotes` array MUST be unique (no duplicates) — error code `11016`
3. **Valid quote IDs**: All quote IDs MUST exist in the mint's database

4. **Payment method consistency**: All quotes MUST have the same payment method, matching `{method}` in the URL path
5. **Currency unit consistency**: All quotes MUST use the same currency unit
6. **Quote state**: All quotes MUST be in PAID state (or have a mintable amount for payment methods that allow multiple mint operations like bolt12)
7. **Amount balance**: The sum of amounts contained in the `outputs` MUST equal the sum of `quote_amounts` (bolt11) or MUST NOT exceed it (bolt12)
8. **Signature validation (NUT-20)**: The `signatures` array length MUST match the `quotes` array length; locked quotes MUST include a valid signature; unlocked quotes MUST NOT include one

Implementations MAY impose additional constraints such as maximum batch size based on their resource limitations. If any validation fails, the mint MUST reject the entire batch and return an appropriate error without minting any quotes.

NUT-20 support

Per NUT-20, quotes can require authentication via signatures. When using batch minting with NUT-20 locked quotes:

Signature Array Structure

Array structure:

- The `signatures` field is an array with length equal to `quotes.length` (one entry per quote)
- `signatures[i]` corresponds to `quotes[i]`

Per-quote signatures:

- **Locked quotes** (with `pubkey`): `signatures[i]` contains the signature string
- **Unlocked quotes**: `signatures[i]` is `null`

Field requirement:

- **Required**: If ANY quote is locked
- **Optional**: May be omitted entirely if all quotes are unlocked

Signature Message

Each locked quote is signed independently exactly as in NUT-20: `signatures[i]` is the NUT-20 signature over `quotes[i]` and the request's `outputs`. The batch `outputs` are a single consolidated set (not partitioned per quote), so each signature is computed over the full `outputs` array.

Following the NUT-20 message aggregation pattern, the signature message for `quotes[i]` is computed as:

```
msg_to_sign = b"Cashu_MintQuoteSig_v1"
              || len32(quotes[i]) || quotes[i]
              || for each output j (in request order):
                   len32(amount_j) || amount_j
                   || len32(B_j)   || B_j
```

Where:

- `b"Cashu_MintQuoteSig_v1"` is the domain-separation tag as raw ASCII bytes, not length-prefixed.
- `quotes[i]` is the UTF-8 encoded quote ID from the request's `quotes` array at index `i`
- `outputs` are **all blinded messages** from the request's `outputs` array (regardless of which quote they correspond to)
- `amount_j` is the output amount as canonical minimal big-endian bytes (e.g. `0` → empty byte array, `1` → `0x01`, `256` → `0x0100`); thus `len32(amount_j)` is its length in bytes as a 32-bit integer (e.g. `0` for amount `0`, `1` for amount `1`, `2` for amount `256`).
- `B_j` is the raw byte representation of the blinded message (e.g. 33-byte compressed secp256k1 or 48-byte BLS12-381 point), decoded from the request's hex string.
- `||` denotes byte concatenation and `len32(x)` is the 32-bit (4-byte) big-endian length of the following data `x`.

Signature Validation Failure

If **any signature in the batch is invalid**, the mint MUST reject the **entire batch** and return an error. This maintains atomicity: all quotes must be successfully authenticated and minted together, or none at all.

Example

```
{
  "quotes": [
    "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8005-9428c4fc5edb",
    "019e6d5a-2347-7000-841a-4d222fd00a33",
    "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8d60-d35c1a9e19b3"
  ],
  "outputs": [
    { "amount": 64, "id": "keyset_1", "B_": "..." },
    { "amount": 64, "id": "keyset_1", "B_": "..." },
    { "amount": 22, "id": "keyset_1", "B_": "..." }
  ],
  "signatures": [
    "d9be080b...", // Signature for quote[0], covers ALL 3 outputs
    null, // Quote[1] is unlocked
    "a1c5f7e2..." // Signature for quote[2], covers ALL 3 outputs
  ]
}
```

Implementation Notes

Batch Size Limits

Mints MAY advertise a maximum batch size through the NUT-06 mint info endpoint. The batch size limit is included in the `nuts` object under the `29` key:

```
{
  "nuts": {
    "29": {
      "max_batch_size": 100,
      "methods": ["bolt11", "bolt12"]
```

```
    }
  }
}
```

Fields:

- `max_batch_size` (optional): Maximum number of quotes allowed in a single batch request. If omitted, the batch size limit is implementation-defined and clients MUST handle error code `11017` gracefully.
- `methods` (optional): Array of payment methods supported for batch minting. If omitted, all methods supported by the mint (per NUT-04) are available for batching.

NUT Errors

Code	Description	Relevant nuts
10001	Proof verification failed	NUT-03, NUT-05
11001	Proofs already spent	NUT-03, NUT-05
11002	Proofs are pending	NUT-03, NUT-05
11003	Outputs already signed	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11004	Outputs are pending	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11005	Transaction is not balanced (inputs != outputs)	NUT-02, NUT-03, NUT-05
11006	Amount outside of limit range	NUT-04, NUT-05
11007	Duplicate inputs provided	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11008	Duplicate outputs provided	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11009	Inputs/Outputs of multiple units	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11010	Inputs and outputs not of same unit	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11011	Amountless invoice is not supported	NUT-05
11012	Amount in request does not equal invoice	NUT-05
11013	Unit in request is not supported	NUT-04, NUT-05
11014	Max inputs exceeded	NUT-03, NUT-05
11015	Max outputs exceeded	NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
11016	Duplicate quote IDs provided	NUT-29
11017	Max batch size exceeded	NUT-29
12001	Keyset is not known	NUT-02, NUT-04
12002	Keyset is inactive, cannot sign messages	NUT-02, NUT-03, NUT-04
12003	Keyset has expired	NUT-02, NUT-03, NUT-04, NUT-05
20001	Quote request is not paid	NUT-04
20002	Quote has already been issued	NUT-04
20003	Minting is disabled	NUT-04
20004	Lightning payment failed	NUT-05

Code	Description	Relevant nuts
20005	Quote is pending	NUT-04, NUT-05, NUT-29
20006	Invoice already paid	NUT-05
20007	Quote is expired	NUT-04, NUT-05
20008	Signature for mint request invalid	NUT-20
20009	Pubkey required for mint quote	NUT-20
30001	Endpoint requires clear auth	NUT-21
30002	Clear authentication failed	NUT-21
31001	Endpoint requires blind auth	NUT-22
31002	Blind authentication failed	NUT-22
31003	Maximum BAT mint amount exceeded	NUT-22
31004	BAT mint rate limit exceeded	NUT-22

Proofs, restore, and wallet state

Proofs are the tokens in your wallet. This chapter is about keeping them honest and recoverable.

NUT-07 lets a wallet ask a mint whether a proof is spent. NUT-09 restores signatures after you recover a seed. NUT-12 adds DLEQ proofs so you can check a mint's signatures offline. NUT-13 derives secrets deterministically from a seed phrase, which is what makes restore possible. NUT-19 caches mint responses so retries do not double-spend you.

In this chapter

- NUT-07 — Token state check
- NUT-09 — Signature restore
- NUT-12 — DLEQ proofs
- NUT-13 — Deterministic secrets
- NUT-19 — Cached responses

NUT-07: Token state check

`optional`

`used in: NUT-17, NUT-11, NUT-14`

With the token state check, wallets can ask the mint whether a specific proof is already spent and whether it is in-flight in a transaction. Wallets can also request the witness data that was used to spend a proof.

Token states

A proof can be in one of the following states

- A proof is `PENDING` if it is being processed in a transaction (in an ongoing payment). A `PENDING` proof cannot be used in another transaction until it is `UNSPENT` again.
- A proof is `SPENT` if it has been redeemed and its secret is in the list of spent secrets of the mint.
- A proof is `UNSPENT` if the mint has no record of it being pending or spent

Note: Before deleting spent proofs from their database, wallets can check if the proof is `SPENT` to make sure that they don't accidentally delete an unspent proof. Beware that this behavior can make it easier for the mint to correlate the sender to the receiver.

Important: Mints **MUST** remember which proofs are currently `PENDING` to avoid reuse of the same token in multiple concurrent transactions. This can be achieved with, for example, a mutex lock whose key is the `Proof`'s `Y`.

Use cases

Example 1: Ecash transaction

When `Alice` prepares a token to be sent to `Carol`, she can mark these tokens in her database as *pending*. She can then, periodically or upon user input, check with the mint if the token is `UNSPENT` or whether it has been redeemed by `Carol` already, i.e., is `SPENT`. If the proof is not spendable anymore (and, thus, has been redeemed by `Carol`), she can safely delete the proof from her database.

Example 2: Lightning payments

If `Alice`'s melt operation takes a long time to complete (for example if she requests a very slow Lightning payment) and she closes her wallet in the meantime, the next time she comes online, she can check all proofs marked as *pending* in her database to determine whether the payment is still in flight (mint returns `PENDING`), it has succeeded (mint returns `SPENT`), or it has failed (mint returns `UNSPENT`).

Example

Request of `Alice`:

```
POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/checkstate
```

With the data being of the form `PostCheckStateRequest`:

```
{
  "Ys": <Array[hex_str]>
}
```

Where the elements of the array in `Ys` are the hexadecimal representation of the compressed point `Y = hash_to_curve(secret)` of the `Proof` to check (see NUT-00).

Response of `Bob`:

`Bob` responds with a `PostCheckStateResponse`:

```
{
  "states": [
    {
      "Y": <hex_str>,
      "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
      "witness": <str|null>
    },
    ...
  ]
}
```

The elements of the `states` array MUST be returned in the same order as the corresponding `Ys` checked in the request.

- `Y` corresponds to the `Proof` checked in the request.
- `state` is an enum string field with possible values `"UNSPENT"`, `"PENDING"`, `"SPENT"`
- `witness` is the serialized witness data that was used to spend the `Proof` if the token has a NUT-10 spending condition that requires a witness such as in the case of P2PK (NUT-11) or HTLCs (NUT-14).

With curl:

Request of `Alice`:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/checkstate -H 'Content-Type: application/json' -d '{
  "Ys": [
    "02599b9ea0a1ad4143706c2a5a4a568ce442dd4313e1cf1f7f0b58a317c1a355ee"
  ]
}'
```

Response of `Bob`:

```
{
  "states": [
    {
      "Y": "02599b9ea0a1ad4143706c2a5a4a568ce442dd4313e1cf1f7f0b58a317c1a355ee",
      "state": "SPENT",
      "witness": "{\"signatures\":
        [\"b2cf120a49cb1ac3cb32e1bf5ccb6425e0a8372affdc1d41912ca35c13908062f269c0caa53607d4e1ac4c8563246c4c8

    }
  ]
}
```

Where `Y` belongs to the provided `Proof` to check in the request, `state` indicates its state, and `witness` is the witness data that was potentially provided in a previous spend operation (can be empty).

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "7": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-09: Restore signatures

`optional`

`used in: NUT-13`

In this document, we describe how wallets can recover blind signatures, and with that their corresponding `Proofs`, by requesting from the mint to reissue the blind signatures. This can be used for a backup recovery of a lost wallet (see NUT-13) or for recovering the response of an interrupted swap request (see NUT-03).

Mints must store the `BlindedMessage` and the corresponding `BlindSignature` in their database every time they issue a `BlindSignature`. Wallets provide the `BlindedMessage` for which they request the `BlindSignature`. Mints only respond with a `BlindSignature`, if they have previously signed the `BlindedMessage`. Each returned `BlindSignature` also contains the `amount` and the keyset `id` (see NUT-00) which is all the necessary information for a wallet to recover a `Proof`.

Request of `Alice`:

`POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/restore`

With the data being of the form `PostRestoreRequest`:

```
{
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>
}
```

Response of `Bob`:

The mint `Bob` then responds with a `PostRestoreResponse`.

```
{
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>,
  "signatures": <Array[BlindSignature]>
}
```

The returned arrays `outputs` and `signatures` are of the same length and for every entry `outputs[i]`, there is a corresponding entry `signatures[i]`.

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "9": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-12: Offline ecash signature validation

`optional`

In this document, we present an extension of Cashu's crypto system to allow a user `Alice` to verify the mint `Bob`'s signature using only `Bob`'s public keys. We explain how another user `Carol` who receives ecash from `Alice` can execute the DLEQ proof as well. This is achieved using a Discrete Log Equality (DLEQ) proof. Previously, `Bob`'s signature could only be checked by himself using his own private keys (NUT-00).

The DLEQ proof

The purpose of this DLEQ is to prove that the mint has used the same private key `a` for creating its public key `A` (NUT-01) and for signing the BlindedMessage `B'`. `Bob` returns the DLEQ proof in addition to the blind signature `C'` for a mint or swap operation.

The complete DLEQ proof reads

```
# DLEQ Proof

(These steps occur when Bob returns C')

Bob:
r = HMAC-SHA256(key=a, data="Cashu_DLEQ_R_v1" || A || B' || C' || ctr) # Deterministic nonce
R1 = r*G
R2 = r*B'
e = hash(R1,R2,A,C')
s = (r + e*a) mod n
return e, s

Alice:
R1 = s*G - e*A
R2 = s*B' - e*C'
e == hash(R1,R2,A,C')

If true, a in A = a*G must be equal to a in C' = a*B'

where:
  G, n = secp256k1 generator point, and curve order
  a = mint's amount-i private key, as 32-byte big-endian (HMAC key)
  A, B', C' = uncompressed (65 byte) SEC1 public points as raw bytes
  ctr = nonce counter byte; set to 0x00 initially, increment and retry if r == 0 or r >= n (max
256 tries)
```

> [!CAUTION]
>
> Mints **SHOULD** use a rejection-sampled deterministic nonce (`r`) to avoid RNG failures. See the test vectors.
>
> Reusing a nonce across different challenges leaks the private key immediately ($a = (s_1 - s_2) \cdot (e_1 - e_2)^{-1} \bmod n$). Mints that use random nonces **MUST** source them from a cryptographically secure RNG.

Hash function

The hash function `hash(x: Array[PublicKey]) -> bytes` generates a deterministic SHA256 hash for a given input list of `PublicKey`. The uncompressed (32+32+1)-byte hexadecimal representations (130 characters) of each `PublicKey` are concatenated before taking the SHA256 hash.

```
def hash_e(*publickeys: PublicKey) -> bytes:
    e_ = ""
    for p in publickeys:
        _p = p.serialize(compressed=False).hex()
        e_ += str(_p)
    e = hashlib.sha256(e_.encode("utf-8")).digest()
    return e
```

> [!NOTE] For examples of valid DLEQ proofs, see the test vectors.

Mint to user: DLEQ in `BlindSignature`

The mint produces these DLEQ proofs when returning `BlindSignatures` in the responses for minting (NUT-04) and swapping (NUT-03) tokens. The `BlindSignature` object is extended in the following way to include the DLEQ proof:

```
{
  "id": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "C_": <str>,
  "dleq": { <-- New: DLEQ proof
    "e": <str>,
    "s": <str>
  }
}
```

`e` and `s` are the DLEQ proof.

User to user: DLEQ in `Proof`

In order for `Alice` to communicate the DLEQ to another user `Carol`, we extend the `Proof` (see NUT-00) object and include the DLEQ proof. As explained below, `Alice` **MUST** also include the blinding factor `r` for the proof to be convincing to `Carol`.

```
{
  "id": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "secret": <str>,
  "C": <str>,
  "dleq": { <-- New: DLEQ proof
    "e": <str>,
    "s": <str>,
    "r": <str>
  }
}
```

`e` and `s` are the challenge and response of the DLEQ proof returned by `Bob`, `r` is the blinding factor of `Alice` that was used to generate the `Proof`. `Alice` serializes these proofs like any other in a token (see NUT-00) to send it to another user `Carol`.

> [!IMPORTANT]
>
> **Privacy:** The entire `dleq` field **SHOULD** be removed before sending a `Proof` to the mint as an input. The mint can associate the `BlindSignature` with the `Proof` given `e` and `s`, or using the blinding factor `r`.

Alice (minting user) verifies DLEQ proof

When minting or swapping tokens, `Alice` receives DLEQ proofs in the `BlindSignature` response from the mint `Bob`. `Alice` checks the validity of the DLEQ proofs for each ecash token she receives via the equations:

```
R1 = s*G - e*A
R2 = s*B' - e*C'
e == hash(R1,R2,A,C') # must be True
```

Here, the variables are

- `A` – the public key `Bob` used to sign this Proof
- `(e, s)` – the DLEQ proof returned by `Bob`
- `B'` – `Alice`'s `BlindedMessage`
- `C'` – `Bob`'s `BlindSignature` on `B'`

In order to execute the proof, `Alice` needs `e, s` that are returned in the `BlindSignature` by `Bob`. `Alice` further needs `B'` (the `BlindedMessage` `Alice` created and `Bob` signed) and `C'` (the blind signature in the `BlindSignature` response) from `Bob`, and `A` (the public key of `Bob` with which he signed the BlindedMessage). All these values are available to `Alice` during or after calling the mint and swap operations.

If a DLEQ proof is included in the mint's `BlindSignature` response, wallets **MUST** verify the DLEQ proof.

Carol (another user) verifies DLEQ proof

`Carol` is a user that receives `Proofs` in a token from another user Alice. When `Alice` sends `Proofs` with DLEQ proofs to `Carol` or when `Alice` posts the `Proofs` publicly, `Carol` can validate the DLEQ proof herself and verify `Bob`'s signature without having to talk to `Bob`. `Alice` includes the following information in the `Proof` (see above):

- `(x, C)` – the ecash `Proof`
- `(e, s)` – the DLEQ proof revealed by `Alice`
- `r` – `Alice`'s blinding factor

Here, `x` is the Proof's secret, and `C` is the mint's signature on it. To execute the DLEQ proof like `Alice` did above, `Carol` needs `(B', C')` which she can compute herself using the blinding factor `r` that she receives from `Alice`.

To verify the DLEQ proof of a received token, `Carol` needs to reconstruct `B'` and `C'` using the blinding factor `r` that `Alice` has included in the `Proof` she sent to `Carol`. Since `Carol` now has all the necessary information, she can execute the same equations to verify the DLEQ proof as `Alice` did:

```
Y = hash_to_curve(x)
C' = C + r*A
B' = Y + r*G

R1 = ... (same as Alice)
```

If a DLEQ proof is included in a received token, wallets **MUST** verify the proof.

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "12": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-13: Deterministic Secrets

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-09`

In this document, we describe the process that allows wallets to recover their ecash balance with the help of the mint using a familiar 12 word seed phrase (mnemonic). This allows us to restore the wallet's previous state in case of a device loss or other loss of access to the wallet. The basic idea is that wallets that generate the ecash deterministically can regenerate the same tokens during a recovery process. For this, they ask the mint to reissue previously generated signatures using NUT-09.

Deterministic secret derivation

An ecash token, or a `Proof`, consists of a `secret` generated by the wallet, and a signature `C` generated by the wallet and the mint in collaboration. Here, we describe how wallets can deterministically generate the `secrets` and blinding factors `r` necessary to generate the signatures `C`.

The wallet generates a `seed` derived from a 12-word BIP39 `mnemonic` seed phrase that the user stores in a secure place. The wallet uses the `seed` to derive deterministic values for the `secret` and the blinding factors `r` for every new ecash token that it generates.

In order to do this, the wallet keeps track of a `counter_k` for each `keyset_k` it uses. The index `k` indicates that the wallet **MUST** keep track of a separate counter for each keyset `k` it uses. The wallet **MUST** keep track of multiple keysets for every mint it interacts with.

Versioned Secret Derivation

The secret derivation method depends on the keyset ID version the wallet derives secrets and blinding factors for.

- **Keyset V2** (keyset IDs starting with `01`): Use HMAC-SHA256 Derivation

- **Keyset V1 (deprecated)** (keyset IDs starting with `00`): Use BIP32 Legacy Derivation

HMAC-SHA256 Derivation

For keysets with version byte `01`, the wallet uses `counter_k`, `seed` and `keyset_id` as inputs to a Key Derivation Function (KDF) whose output is used to derive `secret` and `r`.

The HMAC-SHA256 KDF is built as the following:

1. `message = b"Cashu_KDF_HMAC_SHA256" || keyset_id_bytes || counter_k_bytes || derivation_type_byte`, where:
    - `"Cashu_KDF_HMAC_SHA256"` is the domain separation or purpose string, encoded to bytes as UTF-8.
    - `keyset_id_bytes` are the raw bytes of `keyset_id` (hex decoded).
    - `counter_k_bytes` is the counter encoded as an unsigned 64-bit integer in big-endian format.
    - `derivation_type_byte` is exactly 1 byte specifying the type of derivation required:
        - `0x00` for secrets
        - `0x01` for blinded messages
2. `hmac_digest = HMAC_SHA256(seed, message)`, where `HMAC_SHA256` is the hash-based message authentication code using SHA-256 as the hashing algorithm.
3. `secret = hmac_digest` and `blinding_factor = hmac_digest % N`.

P2PK Derivation

Wallets are able to generate private keys in a deterministic way to have proofs locked to them.

The following BIP32 derivation path for derivation of the key: `m/129373'/10'/0'/0'/{counter}`:

- 129373′: Purpose picked for P2PK derivation.
- 10′: Account for generating private keys for usage in P2PK.
- `{counter}` is an incrementing, non-hardened BIP32 child index.

This will allow wallets to swap proofs that are still locked to a public key during a restore process.

Code Examples

Versioned Secret Derivation

Below are code examples with keyset version-dependent derivation.

Python:

```python
import hmac
import hashlib

def derive_secret_and_r(seed: bytes, keyset_id: str, counter_k: int):
    """
    Derive secret and blinding factor using appropriate method based on keyset version
    """
    # Determine keyset version from first two characters
    keyset_version = keyset_id[:2]
```

```python
    if keyset_version == "00":
        # Use legacy BIP32 derivation for version 00
        return derive_secret_and_r_bip32(seed, keyset_id, counter_k)
    elif keyset_version == "01":
        # Use HMAC-SHA256 derivation for version 01
        return derive_secret_and_r_hmac(seed, keyset_id, counter_k)
    else:
        raise ValueError(f"Unsupported keyset version: {keyset_version}")

def derive_secret_and_r_hmac(seed: bytes, keyset_id: str, counter_k: int):
    """
    HMAC-SHA256 derivation for keyset version 01

    Semantics:
      - secret = HMAC-SHA256(seed, msg || 0x00)
      - r      = OS2IP(HMAC-SHA256(seed, msg || 0x01)) mod N
      - reject r == 0 (astronomically unlikely)
    """
    # secp256k1 scalar field (group) order
    SECP256K1_N = int(
        "FFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFEBAAEDCE6AF48A03BBFD25E8CD0364141", 16
    )

    # Step 1: Create the message
    message = b"Cashu_KDF_HMAC_SHA256" + bytes.fromhex(keyset_id) + counter_k.to_bytes(8, 'big')

    # Step 2: Compute HMAC-SHA256
    secret = hmac.new(seed, message + b"\x00", hashlib.sha256).digest()
    blinding_factor_digest = hmac.new(seed, message + b"\x01", hashlib.sha256).digest()

    # Step 3: Interpret digest as integer and reduce mod N
    x = int.from_bytes(blinding_factor_digest, "big", signed=False)
    r = x % SECP256K1_N

    if r == 0:
        raise RuntimeError("Derived invalid blinding scalar r == 0")

    return secret, r

def derive_secret_and_r_bip32(seed: bytes, keyset_id: str, counter_k: int):
    """
    Legacy BIP32 derivation for keyset version 00
    """
    # Convert seed to mnemonic and derive master key
    bip32 = BIP32.from_seed(seed)

    # Calculate keyset_id_int for BIP32 derivation path
    keyset_id_int = int.from_bytes(bytes.fromhex(keyset_id), "big") % (2**31 - 1)

    # Derive secret and r using BIP32 paths
    secret_path = f"m/129372'/0'/{keyset_id_int}'/{counter_k}'/0"
    r_path = f"m/129372'/0'/{keyset_id_int}'/{counter_k}'/1"

    secret = bip32.get_privkey_from_path(secret_path)
```

```
    r = bip32.get_privkey_from_path(r_path)

    return secret, r
```

TypeScript:

```
import * as crypto from "crypto";
// secp256k1 scalar field (group) order
const SECP256K1_N = BigInt(
  "0xFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFEBAAEDCE6AF48A03BBFD25E8CD0364141",
);

function deriveSecretAndR(seed: Buffer, keysetId: string, counterK: number) {
  // Determine keyset version from first two characters
  const keysetVersion = keysetId.substring(0, 2);

  if (keysetVersion === "00") {
    // Use legacy BIP32 derivation for version 00
    return deriveSecretAndRBip32(seed, keysetId, counterK);
  } else if (keysetVersion === "01") {
    // Use HMAC-SHA256 derivation for version 01
    return deriveSecretAndRHmac(seed, keysetId, counterK);
  } else {
    throw new Error(`Unsupported keyset version: ${keysetVersion}`);
  }
}

function deriveSecretAndRHmac(
  seed: Buffer,
  keysetId: string,
  counterK: number,
) {
  // Step 1: Create message
  const counterBuffer = Buffer.alloc(8);
  counterBuffer.writeBigUInt64BE(BigInt(counterK));
  const message = Buffer.concat([
    Buffer.from("Cashu_KDF_HMAC_SHA256"),
    Buffer.from(keysetId, "hex"),
    counterBuffer,
  ]);

  const secretDerivation = Buffer.from([0]);
  const blindingFactorDerivation = Buffer.from([1]);

  // Step 2: Compute HMAC-SHA256
  const secret = crypto
    .createHmac("sha256", seed)
    .update(Buffer.concat([message, secretDerivation]))
    .digest();
  const blindingFactorDigest = crypto
    .createHmac("sha256", seed)
    .update(Buffer.concat([message, blindingFactorDerivation]))
    .digest();

  // Step 3: OS2IP + modulo reduction
```

```
  const x = BigInt("0x" + blindingFactorDigest.toString("hex"));
  const r = x % SECP256K1_N;

  if (r === 0n) {
    throw new Error("Derived invalid blinding scalar r == 0");
  }

  return { secret, r };
}

function deriveSecretAndRBip32(
  seed: Buffer,
  keysetId: string,
  counterK: number,
) {
  // Legacy BIP32 derivation for version 00
  // Implementation would use BIP32 library (e.g., bip32, bitcoinjs-lib)
  // Calculate keyset_id_int for BIP32 derivation path
  const keysetIdInt = BigInt(`0x${keysetId}`) % BigInt(2 ** 31 - 1);

  // This is pseudocode - actual implementation depends on BIP32 library
  const secretPath = `m/129372'/0'/${keysetIdInt}'/${counterK}'/0`;
  const rPath = `m/129372'/0'/${keysetIdInt}'/${counterK}'/1`;

  // const secret = bip32.derivePath(secretPath).privateKey;
  // const r = bip32.derivePath(rPath).privateKey;

  // Return placeholder for demonstration
  throw new Error(
    "BIP32 derivation requires additional library implementation",
  );
}
```

Note: See the test vectors.

Legacy Derivation (For Keyset Version `00`)

> [!NOTE] This derivation method is used for keysets with version `00` (legacy keysets). Wallets **MUST** use this method when working with keysets that have IDs starting with `00`.

BIP32 derivation paths are used. The derivation path depends on the keyset ID of `keyset_k`, and the `counter_k` of that keyset.

- Purpose' = `129372'` (UTF-8 for 🥜)
- Coin type' = Always `0'`
- Keyset id' = Keyset ID represented as an integer (`keyset_k_int`)
- Coin counter' = `counter'` (this value is incremented)
- `secret` or `r` = `0` or `1`

```
m / 129372' / 0' / keyset_k_int' / counter' / secret||r
```

This results in the following derivation paths:

```
secret_derivation_path = `m/129372'/0'/{keyset_k_int}'/{counter_k}'/0`
r_derivation_path = `m/129372'/0'/{keyset_k_int}'/{counter_k}'/1`
```

Here, `{keyset_k_int}` and `{counter_k}` are the only variables that can change. `keyset_k_int` is an integer representation (see below) of the keyset ID the token is generated with. This means that the derivation path is unique for each keyset. Note that the coin type is always `0'`, independent of the unit of the ecash.

> [!NOTE] For examples, see the test vectors.

Counter

The wallet starts with `counter_k := 0` upon encountering a new keyset and increments it by `1` every time it has successfully minted new ecash with this keyset. The wallet stores the latest `counter_k` in its database for all keysets it uses. Note that we have a `counter` (and therefore a derivation path) for each keyset `k`. We omit the keyset index `k` in the following of this document.

When encountering keysets with different versions, wallets **MUST** use the appropriate derivation method based on the keyset ID version and retain the existing `counter_k` value for each keyset to ensure consistent restore support across wallet implementations.

Keyset ID to Integer Mapping (deprecated)

> [!CAUTION] This mapping is deprecated and unsafe to use due to its small keyspace.

The integer representation `keyset_id_int` of a keyset is calculated from its hexadecimal ID which has a length of 8 bytes or 16 hex characters. First, we convert the hex string to a big-endian sequence of bytes. This value is then modulo reduced by `2^31 - 1` to arrive at an integer that is a unique identifier `keyset_id_int`. Keyset IDs with version prefix `01` **MUST** be shortened to the first 8 bytes before conversion.

Example in Python:

```python
keyset_id_int = int.from_bytes(bytes.fromhex(keyset_id_hex), "big") % (2**31 - 1)
```

Example in JavaScript:

```javascript
keysetIdInt = BigInt(`0x${keysetIdHex}`) % BigInt(2 ** 31 - 1);
```

Restore from seed phrase

Using deterministic secret derivation, a user's wallet can regenerate the same `BlindedMessages` in case of loss of a previous wallet state. To also restore the corresponding `BlindSignatures` to fully recover the ecash, the wallet can either request the mint to re-issue past `BlindSignatures` on the regenerated `BlindedMessages` (see NUT-09) or download the entire database of the mint (TBD).

The wallet takes the following steps during recovery:

1. Determine the keyset version from the keyset ID
2. Generate `secret` and `r` from `counter` and `keyset` using the appropriate derivation method:
    - For keyset version `00`: Use legacy BIP32 derivation
    - For keyset version `01`: Use HMAC-SHA256 derivation
3. Generate `BlindedMessage` from `secret`

4. Obtain `BlindSignature` for `secret` from the mint
5. Unblind `BlindSignature` to `C` using `r`
6. Restore `Proof = (secret, C)`
7. Check if `Proof` is already spent

Generate `BlindedMessages`

To generate the `BlindedMessages`, the wallet starts with a `counter := 0` and, for each increment of the `counter`, generates a `secret` and `r` using the appropriate derivation method based on the keyset version.

For keyset version `00` (legacy):

```
secret = bip32.get_privkey_from_path(secret_derivation_path).hex()
r = self.bip32.get_privkey_from_path(r_derivation_path)
```

For keyset version `01` (HMAC-SHA256):

```
secret, r = derive_secret_and_r_hmac(seed, keyset_id, counter)
```

> [!NOTE] For examples, see the test vectors.

Using the `secret` string and the private key `r`, the wallet generates a `BlindedMessage`. The wallet then increases the `counter` by `1` and repeats the same process for a given batch size. It is recommended to use a batch size of 100.

The user's wallet can now request the corresponding `BlindSignatures` for these `BlindedMessages` from the mint using the NUT-09 restore endpoint or by downloading the entire mint's database.

Generate `Proofs`

Using the restored `BlindSignatures` and the `r` generated in the previous step, the wallet can unblind the signature to `C`. The triple `(secret, C, amount)` is a restored `Proof`.

Check `Proofs` states

If the wallet used the restore endpoint NUT-09 for regenerating the `Proofs`, it additionally needs to check for the `Proofs` spent state using NUT-07. The wallet deletes all `Proofs` which are already spent and keeps the unspent ones in its database.

Restoring batches

Usually, the user won't remember the last state of `counter` when starting the recovery process. Therefore, wallets need to know how far they need to increment the `counter` during the restore process to be confident to have reached the most recent state.

The following approach is recommended:

- Set `counter = 0`
- Select key derivation function: legacy for `00` and HMAC-SHA256 for `01` keysets
- Restore `Proofs` in batches of 100, and increment `counter`
- Repeat restore until three consecutive batches are returned empty

- Reset `counter` to the value at the last successful restore + 1

Wallets restore `Proofs` in batches of 100. The wallet starts with a `counter=0` and increments it for every `Proof` it generated during one batch. When the wallet begins restoring the first `Proofs`, it is likely that the first few batches will only contain spent `Proofs`. Eventually, the wallet will reach a `counter` that will result in unspent `Proofs` which it stores in its database. The wallet then continues to restore until *three successive batches are returned empty by the mint*. This is to be confident that the restore process did not miss any `Proofs` that might have been generated with larger gaps in the `counter` by the previous wallet that we are restoring.

NUT-19: Cached Responses

`optional`

To minimize the risk of loss of funds due to network errors during critical operations such as minting, swapping, and melting, we introduce a caching mechanism for successful responses. This allows wallets to replay requests on cached endpoints and allows them to recover the desired state after a network interruption.

Requests & Responses

Any Mint implementation should elect a data structure `D` that maps request objects to their respective responses. `D` should be fit for fast insertion, look-up and deletion (eviction) operations. This could be an in-memory database or a dedicated caching service like Redis.

Derive & Repeat

Upon receiving a `request` on a cached endpoint, the mint derives a unique key `k` for it which should depend on the method, path, and the payload of `request`.

The mint uses `k` to look up a `response = D[k]` and discriminates execution based on the following checks:

- If no cached `response` is found: `request` has no matching `response`. The mint processes `request` as per usual.
- If a cached `response` is found: `request` has a matching `response`. The mint returns the cached `response`.

Store

For each successful response on a cached endpoint (`status_code == 200`), the mint stores the response in `D` under key `k` (`D[k] = response`).

Expiry

The mint decides the `ttl` (Time To Live) of cached response, after which it can evict the entry from `D`.

Settings

Support for NUT-19 is announced as an extension to the `nuts` field of the `GetInfoResponse` described in NUT-06.

The entry is structured as follows:

```
"nuts": {
    ...,
    "19": {
        "ttl": <int|null>,
        "cached_endpoints": [
            {
                "method": "POST",
                "path": "/v1/mint/bolt11"
            },
            {
                "method": "POST",
                "path": "/v1/swap"
            },
            ...
        ]
    }
}
```

Where:

- `ttl` is the number of seconds the responses are cached for
- `cached_endpoints` is a list of the methods and paths for which caching is enabled.
- `path` and `method` describe the cached route and its method respectively.

If `ttl` is `null`, the responses are expected to be cached *indefinitely*.

Spending conditions

Plain Cashu proofs are bearer tokens: anyone who has them can spend them. Spending conditions lock a proof so it can only be spent with extra knowledge.

NUT-10 is the generic envelope. NUT-11 is pay-to-public-key (P2PK). NUT-14 is hashed timelock contracts (HTLCs), useful for atomic swaps. NUT-28, pay-to-blinded-key (P2BK), blinds the P2PK receiver key so the mint cannot link multiple locks to the same person.

In this chapter

- NUT-10 — Spending conditions
- NUT-11 — Pay-to-public-key (P2PK)
- NUT-14 — Hashed timelock contracts (HTLCs)
- NUT-28 — Pay to blinded key (P2BK)

NUT-10: Spending conditions

`optional`

`used in: NUT-11, NUT-14`

An ordinary ecash token is a set of `Proofs` each with a random string `secret`. To spend such a token in a swap or a melt operation, wallets include `proofs` in their request each with a unique `secret`. To authorize a transaction, the mint requires that the `secret` has not been seen before. This is the most fundamental spending condition in Cashu, which ensures that a token can't be double-spent.

In this NUT, we define a well-known format of `secret` that can be used to express more complex spending conditions. These conditions need to be met before the mint authorizes a transaction. Note that the specific type of spending condition is not part of this document but will be explained in other documents. Here, we describe the structure of `secret` which is expressed as a JSON `Secret` with a specific format.

Spending conditions are enforced by the mint which means that, upon encountering a `Proof` where `Proof.secret` can be parsed into the well-known format, the mint can require additional conditions to be met.

Caution: If the mint does not support spending conditions or a specific `kind` of spending condition, proofs may be treated as regular anyone-can-spend tokens. Applications need to make sure to check whether the mint supports a specific `kind` of spending condition by checking the mint's info endpoint.

Basic components

An ecash transaction, i.e., a swap or a melt operation, with a spending condition consists of the following components:

- Inputs referring to the `Proofs` being spent
- `Secret` containing the rules for unlocking a `Proof`
- Additional witness data satisfying the unlock conditions such as signatures
- Outputs referring to the `BlindedMessages` with new unlock conditions to which the `Proofs` are spent

Spending conditions are defined for each individual `Proof` and not on a transaction level that can consist of multiple `Proofs`. Similarly, spending conditions must be satisfied by providing signatures or additional witness data for each `Proof` separately. For a transaction to be valid, all `Proofs` in that transaction must be unlocked successfully.

New `Secrets` of the outputs to which the inputs are spent are provided as `BlindedMessages` which means that they are blind-signed and not visible to the mint until they are actually spent.

Well-known Secret

Spending conditions are expressed in a well-known secret format that is revealed to the mint when spending (unlocking) a token, not when the token is minted (locked). The mint parses each `Proof`'s `secret`. If it can deserialize it into the following format it executes additional spending conditions that are further specified in additional NUTs.

The well-known `Secret` stored in `Proof.secret` is a JSON of the format:

```
[
kind <str>,
  {
    "nonce": <str>,
    "data": <str>,
    "tags": [[ "key", "value1", "value2", ...],  ... ] // (optional)
```

```
  }
]
```

- `kind` is the kind of the spending condition
- `nonce` is a unique random string
- `data` expresses the spending condition specific to each kind
- `tags` hold additional data committed to and can be used for feature extensions

Tag format

The optional `tags` field is an array of arrays of non-empty strings.

Each individual tag is an array of **ONE or more strings**. The first element of the tag array is known as the tag *name* or *key* and the subsequent string(s) are the *tag value(s)*.

Examples of valid tags:

`["pubkeys"]` - a tag with the key, `"pubkeys"` and no tag values.
`["pubkeys", "021..."]` - a tag with the key, `"pubkeys"` and ONE tag value.
`["pubkeys", "021...", "022..."]` - a tag with the key, `"pubkeys"` and TWO tag values.

Examples of invalid tags:

`[]` - a tag array must contain at least **ONE** or more strings
`["locktime", 1765300829]` - a tag must contain **strings** only
`["locktime", ""]` - a tag must contain **non-empty strings** only

Examples

Example use cases of this secret format are

- NUT-11: Pay-to-Public-Key (P2PK)
- NUT-14: Hashed Timelock Contracts (HTLCs)

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "10": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-11: Pay to Public Key (P2PK)

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-10, NUT-08`

`extended by: NUT-28`

This NUT describes Pay-to-Public-Key (P2PK) which is one kind of spending condition based on NUT-10's well-known `Secret`. Using P2PK, we can lock ecash Proofs (see NUT-00) to a receiver's ECC public key and require a Schnorr signature with the corresponding private key to unlock the ecash. The spending condition is enforced by the mint.

Caution: If the mint does not support this type of spending condition, Proofs may be treated as regular anyone-can-spend Proofs. Applications need to make sure to check whether the mint supports a specific kind of spending condition by checking the mint's NUT-06 info endpoint.

Basic Case

NUT-10 Secret `kind: P2PK`

If for a `Proof`, `Proof.secret` is a `Secret` of kind `P2PK`, the proof must be unlocked by providing a witness `Proof.witness` and one or more valid signatures in the array `Proof.witness.signatures`.

In the basic case, when spending a locked Proof, the mint requires one valid Schnorr signature in `Proof.witness.signatures` on `Proof.secret` by the public key in `Proof.secret.data`.

To give a concrete example of the basic case, to mint a locked Proof we first create a P2PK `Secret` that reads:

```
[
  "P2PK",
  {
    "nonce": "859d4935c4907062a6297cf4e663e2835d90d97ecdd510745d32f6816323a41f",
    "data": "0249098aa8b9d2fbec49ff8598feb17b592b986e62319a4fa488a3dc36387157a7",
    "tags": [["sigflag", "SIG_INPUTS"]]
  }
]
```

Here, `Secret.data` is the public key of the recipient of the locked ecash. We serialize this `Secret` to a string in `Proof.secret` and get a blind signature by the mint that is stored in `Proof.C` (see NUT-03).

The recipient who owns the private key of the public key `Secret.data` can spend this proof by providing a signature on the serialized `Proof.secret` string that is then added to `Proof.witness.signatures`:

```
{
  "amount": 1,
  "secret": "[\"P2PK\",{\"nonce\":\"859d4935c4907062a6297cf4e663e2835d90d97ecdd510745d32f6816323a41f\",\"dat
        \"0249098aa8b9d2fbec49ff8598feb17b592b986e62319a4fa488a3dc36387157a7\",\"tags\":[[\"sigflag\",\"SIG_

  "C": "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904",
  "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
  "witness": "{\"signatures\":
        [\"60f3c9b766770b46caac1d27e1ae6b77c8866ebaeba0b9489fe6a15a837eaa6fcd6eaa825499c72ac342983983fd3ba3a

}
```

Signature scheme

To spend Proofs locked with `P2PK`, the spender needs to include signatures in the Proofs used as "inputs" for the spending operation. We use `libsecp256k1`'s serialized 64 byte Schnorr signatures on the SHA256 hash of

the message to sign. The message to sign is the field `Proof.secret` in the inputs, unless otherwise indicated by the `Secret.tags.sigflag` in the inputs, as detailed below.

An ecash spending operation like swap and melt can have multiple inputs and outputs. If we have more than one locked input, we either provide signatures in each input individually (for `SIG_INPUTS`) or only in the first input for the entire transaction (for `SIG_ALL`). The inputs are the `Proofs` provided in the `inputs` field and the outputs are the `BlindedMessages` in the `outputs` field in the request body (see `PostMeltRequest` in NUT-05 and `PostSwapRequest` in NUT-03).

> [!NOTE]
>
> The field `Proof.secret` contains escaped JSON for transport. The message to sign MUST be constructed using the **unescaped** secret string, eg: ["P2PK",{"nonce":"c7f280eb55c1e856…

Witness format

Signatures are stored in `P2PKWitness` objects and are provided in either each `Proof.witness` of all inputs separately (for `SIG_INPUTS`) or only in the first input of the transaction (for `SIG_ALL`). `P2PKWitness` is a serialized JSON string of the form

```
{
  "signatures": <Array[<hex_str>]>
}
```

The `signatures` are an array of signatures in hex and correspond to the signatures by one or more signing public keys.

Tags

More complex spending conditions can be defined in the tags in `Secret.tags`. All tags are optional. Tags are arrays with two or more strings being `["key", "value1", "value2", ...]`. We denote a specific tag in a proof by its `key`.

Supported tags are:

- `sigflag: <str_enum[SIG_FLAG]>` sets the signature flag
- `pubkeys: <hex_str>` are additional public keys (together with the one in the `data` field of the secret) that can provide signatures (*allows multiple entries*)
- `n_sigs: <int>` specifies the minimum number of Locktime Multisig public keys providing valid signatures
- `locktime: <int>` is the Unix timestamp of when the lock expires
- `refund: <hex_str>` are additional public keys that can provide signatures after `locktime` (*allows multiple entries*)
- `n_sigs_refund: <int>` specifies the minimum number of Refund Multisig public keys providing valid signatures after `locktime` expires

Each of the above tags may appear exactly **ONCE** in a P2PK secret. If a tag appears more than once, the P2PK secret is malformed and the Proof **MUST** be rejected as unspendable.

If `n_sigs` or `n_sigs_refund` is not a positive integer, or exceeds the total number of keys in its pathway, the P2PK secret is malformed and the Proof **MUST** be rejected as unspendable.

> [!NOTE]
>
> The tag serialization type is `[<str>, <str>, ...]` but some tag values are `int`. Wallets and mints must cast types appropriately for de/serialization.

Signature flag

Signature flags are defined in the tag `Secret.tags['sigflag']`. Currently, there are two signature flags.

- `SIG_INPUTS` requires valid signatures on all inputs independently. It is the default signature flag and will be applied if the `sigflag` tag is absent.
- `SIG_ALL` requires valid signatures on all inputs and on all outputs of a transaction.

If any one input has the signature flag `SIG_ALL`, then all inputs are required to have the same kind, the flag `SIG_ALL` and the same `Secret.data` and `Secret.tags`, otherwise an error is returned.

`SIG_INPUTS` is only enforced if no input is `SIG_ALL`.

If a P2PK secret has any other signature flag value, the P2PK secret is malformed and the Proof **MUST** be rejected as unspendable.

Signature flag `SIG_INPUTS`

`SIG_INPUTS` means that each `Proof` (input) requires its own signature. The signature is provided in the `Proof.witness` field of each input separately. The format of the witness was defined earlier on.

Signed inputs

A `Proof` (an input) with a signature `P2PKWitness.signatures` on `secret` is the JSON (see NUT-00):

```
{
  "amount": <int>,
  "secret": <str>,
  "C": <hex_str>,
  "id": <str>,
  "witness": <P2PKWitness | str> // Signatures on "secret"
}
```

The `secret` field is **signed as a string**.

Signature flag `SIG_ALL`

`SIG_ALL` is enforced only if the following conditions are met:

- If one input has the signature flag `SIG_ALL`, all other inputs MUST have the same `Secret.data` and `Secret.tags`, and by extension, also be `SIG_ALL`.
- If one or more inputs differ from this, an error is returned.

If this condition is met, the `SIG_ALL` flag is enforced and only **the first input of a transaction requires a witness** that covers all other inputs and outputs of the transaction. All signatures by the signing public keys MUST be provided in the `Proof.witness` of the first input of the transaction.

Message aggregation for `SIG_ALL`

The message to be signed depends on the type of transaction containing an input with signature flag `SIG_ALL`.

Aggregation for `swap`

A swap contains `inputs` and `outputs` (see NUT-03). To provide a valid signature, the owner (or owners) of the signing public keys must concatenate the `secret` and `C` fields of all `Proofs` (inputs) with the `amount` and `B_` fields of all `BlindedMessages` (outputs, see NUT-00) to a single message string in the order they appear in the transaction. This concatenated string is then hashed and signed (see Signature scheme).

If a swap transaction has `n` inputs and `m` outputs, the message to sign becomes:

```
msg = secret_0 || C_0 || ... || secret_n || C_n || amount_0 || B_0 || ... || amount_m || B_m
```

Here, `||` denotes string concatenation. The `C` of each input and `B_` of each output are **hex strings** and `amount` is a UTF-8-encoded string.

Aggregation for `melt`

For a melt transaction, the message to sign is composed of all the inputs, the quote ID being paid, and the NUT-08 blank `outputs`.

If a melt transaction has `n` inputs, `m` blank outputs, and a quote ID `quote_id`, the message to sign becomes:

```
msg = secret_0 || C_0 || ... || secret_n || C_n || amount_0 || B_0 || ... || amount_m || B_m || quote_id
```

Here, `||` denotes string concatenation. The `C` of each input and `B_` of each output are **hex strings** and `amount` is a UTF-8-encoded string.

Locktime Tag

The `locktime` tag signals which set of locking rules the mint should apply. There are three possible states the `locktime` tag can represent:

Permanent Lock

If the `locktime` tag is not present, or is not a valid unix time, the lock is considered "permanent".

Locktime Multisig conditions apply if the `pubkeys` tag is present, Basic Case conditions if not.

Active Lock

If the `locktime` tag is a valid unix time and the mint's local clock is less than or equal to `locktime` (`now <= locktime`), the lock is "active".

Locktime Multisig conditions apply if the `pubkeys` tag is present, Basic Case conditions if not.

Expired Lock

If the `locktime` tag is a valid unix time and the mint's local clock is greater than `locktime` (`now > locktime`), the lock has "expired".

Both Locktime Multisig and Refund Multisig conditions apply if the `refund` tag is present, otherwise the proof is considered unlocked and spendable without a witness signature.

> [!NOTE] A `Proof` is considered spendable by anyone if it only requires a `secret` and a valid unblinded signature `C` to be spent (which is the default case in NUT-00).

Multisig

Cashu offers two multi-signature pathways: `Locktime MultiSig` and `Refund MultiSig`, which are activated depending on the status of the proof's `locktime` tag.

> [!NOTE] Each pathway has a self-contained set of conditions which must be satisfied for that pathway to be valid. You cannot mix/blend conditions between pathways.

Locktime MultiSig

Locktime Multisig extends the Basic Case by allowing proofs to be locked to multiple public keys. The additional locking public keys are stored in the `pubkeys` tag.

If the `pubkeys` tag is present, the `Proof` is spendable only if a valid signature is given by **at least ONE** of the public keys contained in the `Secret.data` field or the `pubkeys` tag.

If the `n_sigs` tag is a positive integer, the mint will require at least `n_sigs` of those public keys to provide a valid signature.

If the number of public keys with valid signatures is greater than or equal to the number specified in `n_sigs` (or `1` if `n_sigs` is not present), the transaction is valid. The signatures are provided in an array of strings in the `P2PKWitness` object.

Expressed as an "n-of-m" scheme, `n = n_sigs` is the number of required signatures and `m = 1 (data field) + count(pubkeys tag keys)` is the total number of public keys that *could* sign.

> [!CAUTION]
>
> Because Schnorr signatures are non-deterministic (due to auxiliary random data), we expect a minimum number of unique public keys with valid signatures instead of expecting a minimum number of signatures.

Refund MultiSig

Refund Multisig allows proofs to be *additionally spendable* by a separate set of public keys once the `locktime` has expired. These public keys are stored in the `refund` tag, and can include keys previously listed in `data` or `pubkeys`.

Locktime Multisig conditions continue to apply, and the proof can continue to be spent according to Locktime Multisig rules.

In addition, the `Proof` can be spent if a valid signature is given by **at least ONE** of the public keys contained in the `refund` tag.

If the `n_sigs_refund` tag is a positive integer, the mint will require at least `n_sigs_refund` of those `refund` public keys to provide a valid signature.

If the number of `refund` public keys with valid signatures is greater than or equal to the number specified in `n_sigs_refund` (or `1` if `n_sigs_refund` is not present), the transaction is valid. The signatures are provided in an array of strings in the `P2PKWitness` object.

Expressed as an "n-of-m" scheme, `n = n_sigs_refund` is the number of required signatures and `m = count(refund tag keys)` is the total number of `refund` keys that *could* sign.

> [!CAUTION]
>
> Because Schnorr signatures are non-deterministic (due to auxiliary random data), we expect a minimum number of unique public keys with valid signatures instead of expecting a minimum number of signatures.

Complex Example

This is an example `Secret` that locks a `Proof` with a Pay-to-Pubkey (P2PK) condition that requires 2-of-3 signatures from the public keys in the `data` field and the `pubkeys` tag.

If the `locktime` has passed, the `Proof` continues to be spendable with 2-of-3 signatures from the public keys in the `data` field and the `pubkeys` tag. But now it **ALSO** becomes spendable with a single signature from any ONE of the public keys in the `refund` tag.

The signature flag `sigflag` indicates that signatures are necessary on the `inputs` and the `outputs` of the transaction this `Proof` is spent by.


```
[
  "P2PK",
  {
    "nonce": "da62796403af76c80cd6ce9153ed3746",
    "data": "033281c37677ea273eb7183b783067f5244933ef78d8c3f15b1a77cb246099c26e",
    "tags": [
      ["sigflag", "SIG_ALL"],
      ["n_sigs", "2"],
      ["locktime", "1689418329"],
      [
        "refund",
        "033281c37677ea273eb7183b783067f5244933ef78d8c3f15b1a77cb246099c26e",
        "02e2aeb97f47690e3c418592a5bcda77282d1339a3017f5558928c2441b7731d50"
      ],
      [
        "pubkeys",
        "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904",
        "023192200a0cfd3867e48eb63b03ff599c7e46c8f4e41146b2d281173ca6c50c54"
```

```
      ]
    ]
  }
]
```

Public Key Canonicalisation

Public keys **MUST** use the compressed Secp256k1 public key format.

Each key **MUST** appear at most **ONCE** per multi-signature pathway. The same key **MAY** appear in both pathways.

Keys are compared using their lowercase x-coordinate (`02` or `03` y-parity prefix ignored).

Example: the following keys are considered equivalent because they all have the same lowercase x-coordinate, so can all be Schnorr signed using the same secret key:

```
02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904 // 02 lowercase
02698C4E2B5F9534CD0687D87513C759790CF829AA5739184A3E3735471FBDA904 // 02 uppercase
02698C4e2B5f9534cD0687d87513C759790cF829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904 // 02 mixed case
03698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904 // 03 lowercase
03698C4E2B5F9534CD0687D87513C759790CF829AA5739184A3E3735471FBDA904 // 03 uppercase
03698C4e2B5f9534cD0687d87513C759790cF829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904 // 03 mixed case
```

Example: key duplicated in main pathway (malformed):

```
"data": "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904",
"pubkeys": "03698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904"
```

Example: key allowed in both pathways:

```
"data": "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904",
"refund": "03698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904"
```

If a pathway contains a duplicate key, the P2PK secret is malformed and the Proof **MUST** be rejected as unspendable.

Use cases

The following use cases are unlocked using P2PK:

- Publicly post locked ecash that can only be redeemed by the intended receiver
- Final offline-receiver payments that can't be double-spent when combined with an offline signature check mechanism like DLEQ proofs
- Receiver of locked ecash can defer and batch multiple mint round trips for receiving proofs (requires DLEQ)
- Ecash that is owned by multiple people via the multisignature abilities
- Atomic swaps when used in combination with the locktime feature

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "11": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-14: Hashed Timelock Contracts (HTLCs)

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-10, NUT-11`

`extended by: NUT-28`

This NUT describes the use of Hashed Timelock Contracts (HTLCs) which defines a spending condition based on NUT-10's well-known `Secret` format. Using HTLCs, ecash proofs can be locked to the hash of a preimage and a timelock. This enables use cases such as atomic swaps of ecash between users, and atomic coupling of an ecash spending condition to a Lightning HTLC.

`HTLC` spending conditions can be thought of as an extension of `P2PK` locks (see NUT-11) but with a hash lock in `Secret.data` and a new `Proof.witness.preimage` witness in the locked inputs to be spent. The `preimage` used to spend a locked Proof can be retrieved using NUT-07.

Caution: applications that rely on being able to retrieve the witness independently of the spender must check, via the mint's info endpoint, that NUT-07 is supported.

Caution: if the mint does not support this type of spending condition, proofs may be treated as regular anyone-can-spend proofs. Applications must ensure that the mint supports a specific kind of spending condition by checking the mint's info endpoint.

HTLC Locked Proof

NUT-10 Secret `kind: HTLC`

If for a `Proof`, `Proof.secret` is a `Secret` of kind `HTLC`, the hash of the lock is in `Proof.secret.data`. The preimage for unlocking the HTLC is in the witness `Proof.witness.preimage`. All additional tags from P2PK locks can also be used here, allowing a locktime, signature flag, and multisig (see NUT-11).

Here is a concrete example of a `Secret` of kind `HTLC`:

```
[
  "HTLC",
  {
    "nonce": "da62796403af76c80cd6ce9153ed3746",
    "data": "023192200a0cfd3867e48eb63b03ff599c7e46c8f4e41146b2d281173ca6c50c",
    "tags": [
      [
        "pubkeys",
        "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904"
      ],
      ["locktime", "1689418329"],
```

```
      [
        "refund",
        "033281c37677ea273eb7183b783067f5244933ef78d8c3f15b1a77cb246099c26e"
      ]
    ]
  }
]
```

The hash lock in `Secret.data` and the preimage in `Proof.witness.preimage` are treated as 32-byte data, encoded as 64-character hexadecimal strings.

See NUT-11 for a description of the signature scheme, the additional use of signature flags, and how to require signatures from multiple public keys (Multisig).

Spending HTLC Proofs

A `Proof` with a `Secret` of kind `HTLC` can be spent in two ways.

Receiver Pathway (hash lock)

The receiver(s) listed in the `pubkeys` tag can spend the proof by providing **BOTH** of the following:

- The preimage to `Secret.data` in the `Proof.witness`
- Signature(s) as per the NUT-11 rules for **Locktime MultiSig**.

This pathway is **ALWAYS** available to the receivers, as possession of the preimage confirms performance of the Sender's wishes.

NOTE: If the `pubkeys` tag is absent, the preimage alone spends the proof; no signature is required.

Sender Pathway (timelocked refund)

The sender(s) listed in the `refund` tag can spend the proof once the `locktime` lock has "expired" by providing signature(s) as per the NUT-11 rules for **Refund MultiSig**.

NOTE: As per the NUT-11 rules, if the `refund` tag is not present, the HTLC proof would become "anyone can spend" after the `locktime` lock has "expired". Likewise, if the `locktime` is not present, or is not a valid unix timestamp, the HTLC proof will be permanently locked and can only be spent using the Receiver (hash lock) pathway.

Hash lock

Aligned with Bitcoin's HTLC construction, the hash lock in `Secret.data` represents the **SHA-256 hash** of a 32-byte preimage.

When an HTLC-locked proof is created, the `Secret.data` field must contain:

```
hash_hex = bytes_to_hex(SHA256(preimage_bytes))
```

where:

- `preimage_bytes` is exactly 32 bytes of arbitrary data, commonly random and uniformly distributed

- `hash_hex` is the 32-byte SHA-256 digest of preimage_bytes, encoded as a 64-character lowercase hexadecimal string

To successfully spend a Proof via the **Receiver Pathway**, the spender must present the matching `preimage_bytes`, encoded as a 64-character lowercase hexadecimal string in the `Proof.witness.preimage`.

Mints and wallets **must verify** this equality before accepting the spend as valid:

```
SHA256(hex_to_bytes(Proof.witness.preimage)) == hex_to_bytes(Proof.secret.data)
```

Here is an example of a matching hash / preimage pair:

```
Proof.secret.data = 'ec4916dd28fc4c10d78e287ca5d9cc51ee1ae73cbfde08c6b37324cbfaac8bc5'
Proof.witness.preimage = '0000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000001'
```

This hash-lock mechanism ensures that the Proof can only be spent once the secret preimage is revealed, allowing interoperability with external HTLC systems (such as Bitcoin or Lightning Network contracts).

Witness format

`HTLCWitness` is a serialized JSON string of the form

```
{
  "preimage": <hex_str>,
  "signatures": <Array[<hex_str>]>
}
```

The witness for a spent proof can be obtained with a `Proof` state check (see NUT-07).

Complex Example

This is an example `Secret` that locks a `Proof` with an HTLC condition that can be spent in either of the following ways:

Receiver Pathway - 2-of-3 signatures from the public keys in the `pubkeys` tag **PLUS** the preimage in `Proof.witness.preimage` of the hash in `Secret.data`.

Sender Pathway - One signature from the public keys in the `refund` tag, only available once the `locktime` has expired.

The signature flag `sigflag` indicates that signatures are necessary on the `inputs` and the `outputs` of the transaction this `Proof` is spent by.

```
[
  "HTLC",
  {
    "nonce": "da62796403af76c80cd6ce9153ed3746",
    "data": "023192200a0cfd3867e48eb63b03ff599c7e46c8f4e41146b2d281173ca6c50c",
    "tags": [
      ["sigflag", "SIG_ALL"],
      ["n_sigs", "2"],
      ["locktime", "1689418329"],
      [
        "refund",
```

```
        "033281c37677ea273eb7183b783067f5244933ef78d8c3f15b1a77cb246099c26e",
        "02e2aeb97f47690e3c418592a5bcda77282d1339a3017f5558928c2441b7731d50"
      ],
      [
        "pubkeys",
        "02698c4e2b5f9534cd0687d87513c759790cf829aa5739184a3e3735471fbda904",
        "0279be667ef9dcbbac55a06295ce870b07029bfcdb2dce28d959f2815b16f81798",
        "0249098aa8b9d2fbec49ff8598feb17b592b986e62319a4fa488a3dc36387157a7"
      ]
    ]
  }
]
```

Mint info setting

The NUT-06 `nuts` object indicates support for this feature:

```
{
  "14": {
    "supported": true
  }
}
```

NUT-28: Pay-to-Blinded-Key (P2BK)

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-11`

Summary

This NUT describes Pay-to-Blinded-Key (P2BK), which extends the NUT-11 (P2PK) spending conditions. By implication, it also extends NUT-14 (HTLC).

P2BK preserves privacy by blinding each NUT-11 receiver pubkey `P` with an ECDH-derived scalar r_i. Both sides can deterministically derive the same r_i from their own keys, but a third party cannot. This improves user privacy by preventing the mint from linking multiple P2PK spends by the same party.

ECDH Shared Secret (Zx)

Elliptic-curve Diffie–Hellman (ECDH) allows two parties to create an x-coordinate shared secret (`Zx`) by combining their private key with the public key of the other party: `Zx = x(epG) = x(eP) = x(pE)`.

For P2BK, the sender creates an ephemeral keypair (private key: `e`, public key: `E`), which protects the privacy of their usual long-lived public key. They then calculate the shared secret by combining the ephemeral private key (`e`) and the receiver's long-lived public key (`P`).

The receiver calculates the same shared secret `Zx` using their private key (`p`) and the ephemeral public key (`E`), which is supplied by the sender in the proof metadata.

The shared secret `Zx` is then used to derive the blinded public keys.

Deriving Blinded Public Keys

Per NUT-11, there are up to 11 locking 'slots' in the order: `[data, ...pubkeys, ...refund]`.

Slot 0 is the `data` tag. Slots 1-10 can be any combination of `pubkeys` and `refund` keys.

Each public key in the NUT-11 proof is permanently blinded using a deterministic blinding scalar (r_i), where `i` is the *slot index*.

The blinding scalar for each slot is calculated as:

r_i = SHA-256(DOMAIN_SEPARATOR || Zx || i_byte)

Where:

- `DOMAIN_SEPARATOR` constant byte string `b"Cashu_P2BK_v1"`
- `Zx` is the ECDH shared secret (`eP` for sender, `pE` for receiver).
- `i_byte` is the single unsigned byte representation of `i`: (`0x00` to `0x0A`)
- `||` denotes concatenation

If r_i is not in the range $1 \leq r_i \leq n-1$, retry once with an extra `0xff` byte appended to the hash input as follows:

r_i = SHA-256(b"Cashu_P2BK_v1" || Zx || i_byte || 0xff)

If r_i is still not in the range $1 \leq r_i \leq n-1$, abort and discard the ephemeral keypair.

Finally, the public key (`P`) for slot `i` is blinded (`P'`) as follows:

$P' = P + r_iG$

Example

Below is an example implementation in TypeScript.

```ts
function deriveP2BKBlindingTweakFromECDH(
  point: WeierstrassPoint<bigint>, // E or P
  scalar: bigint, // p or e
  slotIndex: number, // i
): bigint {
  // Calculate x-only ECDH shared point (Zx)
  const Zx = point.multiply(scalar).toBytes(true).slice(1);
  const iByte = new Uint8Array([slotIndex & 0xff]);
  // Derive deterministic blinding factor (r):
  // Note: bytesToNumber does NOT reduce modulo n
  let r: bigint = bytesToNumber(sha256(Bytes.concat(P2BK_DST, Zx, iByte)));
  if (r === 0n || r >= secp256k1.Point.CURVE().n) {
    // Very unlikely to get here!
    r = bytesToNumber(
      sha256(Bytes.concat(P2BK_DST, Zx, iByte, new Uint8Array([0xff]))),
    );
    if (r === 0n || r >= secp256k1.Point.CURVE().n) {
      // Astronomically unlikely to get here!
      throw new Error("P2BK: tweak derivation failed");
```

```
    }
  }
  return r;
}
```

For detailed examples of slot blinding, see the test vectors.

> [!IMPORTANT] All receiver keys **MUST** be in compressed SEC1 format (33 bytes) before ECDH and blinding.
> The sender **MUST add an '02' prefix** to BIP-340 x-only pubkeys (eg Nostr).

Proof Object Extension

Each proof adds a single new metadata field:

```
{
  "amount": int,
  "id": hex_str,
  "secret": str,          // still ["P2PK", {...}]
  "C": hex_str,
  "p2pk_e": hex_str       // NEW: 33-byte SEC1 compressed ephemeral public key E
}
```

- `p2pk_e` contains the sender's ephemeral pubkey (`E`) used for blinding
- All pubkeys inside the `"P2PK"` secret are the blinded forms `P'`
- The mint sees standard P2PK data and remains unaware of the blinding
- For Token V4 encoding, the `p2pk_e` field is named `pe`, and `E` is encoded as a 33 byte CBOR bstr

Deriving Private Keys

With P2BK, the NUT-11 public locking keys are permanently blinded. The mint sees only the blinded public keys, and expects signatures from the corresponding private key.

The receiver must therefore derive the correct blinded private key (`k`). Because BIP-340 lifts public keys to even-Y parity, there are two possible derivation paths:

- Standard derivation: $k = (p + r_i) \bmod n$
- Negated derivation: $k = (-p + r_i) \bmod n$

Where `p` is the receiver's long lived private key.

To decide which derivation to use, the receiver calculates their natural pubkey (`pG`) and compares the parity to their actual pubkey (`P`).

If the parity matches, use standard derivation, otherwise use negated derivation.

The fastest way to do this in a wallet is to unblind, verify the key is a match, then select derivation by parity:

1. compute $R_i = r_iG$
2. unblind $P = P' - R_i$
3. verify $x(P) == x(pG)$
4. use standard derivation if $parity(P) == parity(pG)$, otherwise use negated derivation

Sender Workflow

1. Generate a fresh random scalar `e` and compute `E = eG`
2. For **each receiver key** `P`, compute:
    1. Unique shared secret for this key: `Zx = x(eP)`
    2. Slot index `i` in `[data, ...pubkeys, ...refund]`
    3. Blinding scalar: r_i `= SHA-256(b"Cashu_P2BK_v1" || Zx || i_byte)`
    4. Blinded Public Key: `P' = P +` r_i`G`
3. Build the canonical P2PK secret with the blinded `P'` keys in their slots.
4. Interact with the mint normally; the mint never learns `P` or r_i
5. Include `p2pk_e = E` in the final proof

> [!IMPORTANT] Use a fresh ephemeral keypair (`e` / `E`) for each new output, so that every proof has unique blinded keys and a unique `E` in the `Proof.p2pk_e` field.
>
> In the case of `SIG_ALL`, the **SAME** ephemeral keypair **MUST** be used for all outputs, as all `SIG_ALL` proof secrets must have IDENTICAL `data` and `tags` fields.

Receiver Workflow

1. Read `E` from `proof.p2pk_e` and the key slot order index `i` from `[data, ...pubkeys, ...refund]`
2. Calculate your unique shared secret: `Zx = x(pE)`
3. For each slot `i`, compute:
    1. Blinding scalar: r_i `= SHA-256(b"Cashu_P2BK_v1" || Zx || i_byte)`
    2. Compute R_i `=` r_i`G`
    3. Unblind `P = P' -` R_i
    4. Verify `x(P) == x(pG)`. If it does not match, this `P'` is not for this private key, skip it.
    5. Derive the secret key using:
        - standard derivation if `parity(P) == parity(pG)`
        - negative derivation otherwise
4. Remove the `p2pk_e` field from the proof
5. Sign with the derived private keys and spend as an ordinary P2PK proof

> [!NOTE] Each receiver can only calculate their OWN shared secret (`pE`), because a shared secret requires either the receiver's private key (`pE`) or the sender's ephemeral private key (`eP`).

Lightning and other payment methods

Mint and melt need a payment method. Most Cashu mints use Lightning.

NUT-23 is BOLT11 invoices. NUT-25 is BOLT12 offers. NUT-24 is HTTP 402, so a website can demand Cashu for a resource. NUT-30 mints and melts over on-chain bitcoin.

These specs plug into NUT-04 and NUT-05. Read those first if this chapter feels like it is missing the beginning of the story.

In this chapter

- NUT-23 — Payment method: BOLT11
- NUT-25 — Payment method: BOLT12
- NUT-24 — HTTP 402 Payment Required
- NUT-30 — Payment method: on-chain

NUT-23: BOLT11

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-04, NUT-05`

This document describes minting and melting ecash with the `bolt11` payment method, which uses Lightning Network invoices. It is an extension of NUT-04 and NUT-05 which cover the protocol steps of minting and melting ecash shared by any supported payment method.

Mint Quote

For the `bolt11` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMintQuoteBolt11Request` data:

```
{
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "description": <str> // Optional
}
```

The mint responds with a `PostMintQuoteBolt11Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>, // The bolt11 invoice to pay
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit":  <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt11",
  "amount_paid": <int>,
  "amount_issued": <int>,
  "updated_at": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>, // Deprecated, optional
  "expiry": <int|null>
}
```

`amount_paid`, `amount_issued`, and `updated_at` are defined in NUT-04.

`state` is a deprecated enum string field with possible values `"UNPAID"`, `"PAID"`, `"ISSUED"`:

- `"UNPAID"` means that the quote's request has not been paid yet.
- `"PAID"` means that the quote's request has been paid but the ecash is not issued yet.
- `"ISSUED"` means that the quote has been paid and the ecash has been issued.

Wallets **SHOULD** use `amount_paid` and `amount_issued` instead of `state` whenever these fields are present.

`expiry` is the Unix timestamp until which the `request` can be paid (i.e. the bolt11 invoice expiry).

Example

Request with curl:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt11 -d '{"amount": 10, "unit": "sat"}' -H
        "Content-Type: application/json"
```

Response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8322-05d51d498303",
  "request": "lnbc100n1pj4apw9...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt11",
  "amount_paid": 0,
  "amount_issued": 0,
  "updated_at": 1701704657,
  "state": "UNPAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757
}
```

Check mint quote:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt11/019e6d5a-2347-7000-8322-05d51d498303
```

Minting tokens:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/bolt11 -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d \
'{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8322-05d51d498303",
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 8,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "035015e6d7ade60ba8426cefaf1832bbd27257636e44a76b922d78e79b47cb689d"
    },
    {
      "amount": 2,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "0288d7649652d0a83fc9c966c969fb217f15904431e61a44b14999fabc1b5d9ac6"
    }
  ]
}'
```

Response:

```
{
  "signatures": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 2,
      "C_": "0224f1c4c564230ad3d96c5033efdc425582397a5a7691d600202732edc6d4b1ec"
    },
```

```
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 8,
      "C_": "0277d1de806ed177007e5b94a8139343b6382e472c752a74e99949d511f7194f6c"
    }
  ]
}
```

Mint Settings

A `description` option **MUST** be set to indicate whether the `bolt11` payment method backend supports providing an invoice description.

Example `MintMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "bolt11",
  "unit": "sat",
  "min_amount": 0,
  "max_amount": 10000,
  "options": {
    "description": true
  }
}
```

Melt Quote

For the `bolt11` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Request` data:

```
{
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "options": { // Optional
    "amountless": {
      "amount_msat": <int>
    }
  }
}
```

Here, `request` is the bolt11 Lightning invoice to be paid and `unit` is the unit the wallet would like to pay with. The `options` field can include support for amountless invoices if supported by the mint.

The mint responds with a `PostMeltQuoteBolt11Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt11",
  "fee_reserve": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
```

```
  "payment_preimage": <str|null>
}
```

Where `fee_reserve` is the additional fee reserve required for the Lightning payment. The mint expects the wallet to include `Proofs` of *at least* `total_amount = amount + fee_reserve + fee` where `fee` is calculated from the keyset's `input_fee_ppk` as described in NUT-02.

Melting Tokens

For the `bolt11` method, the wallet can include an optional `outputs` field in the melt request to receive change for overpaid Lightning fees (see NUT-08):

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]> // Optional
}
```

If the `outputs` field is included and there is excess from the `fee_reserve`, the mint will respond with a `change` field containing blind signatures for the overpaid amount:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt11",
  "fee_reserve": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "payment_preimage": <str>,
  "change": <Array[BlindSignature]> // Present if outputs were included and there's change
}
```

Example

Melt quote request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt11 -d \
'{"request": "lnbc100n1p3kdrv5sp5lpdxzghe5j67q...", "unit": "sat"}'
```

Melt quote response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed",
  "request": "lnbc100n1p3kdrv5sp5lpdxzghe5j67q...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt11",
  "fee_reserve": 2,
  "state": "UNPAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757
}
```

Check quote state:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt11/019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed
```

Melt request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/bolt11 -d \
'{"quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed", "inputs": [...]}'
```

Successful melt response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed",
  "request": "lnbc100n1p3kdrv5sp5lpdxzghe5j67q...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt11",
  "fee_reserve": 2,
  "state": "PAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "payment_preimage": "c5a1ae1f639e1f4a3872e81500fd028bece7bedc1152f740cba5c3417b748c1b"
}
```

Example `MeltMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "bolt11",
  "unit": "sat",
  "min_amount": 100,
  "max_amount": 10000,
  "options": {
    "amountless": true
  }
}
```

NUT-25: BOLT12

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-04, NUT-05, NUT-20`

This document describes minting and melting ecash with the `bolt12` payment method, which uses Lightning Network offers. It is an extension of NUT-04 and NUT-05 which cover the protocol steps of minting and melting ecash shared by any supported payment method.

Mint Quote

For the `bolt12` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMintQuoteBolt12Request` data:

```
{
  "amount": <int|null>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "description": <str|null>,
```

```
  "pubkey": <str>
}
```

> **Note:** While a pubkey is optional as per NUT-20 for NUT-04 it is required in this NUT and the mint **MUST NOT** issue a mint quote if one is not included.
>
> **Privacy:** To prevent linking multiple mint quotes together, wallets **SHOULD** generate a unique public key for each mint quote request.

The mint responds with a `PostMintQuoteBolt12Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int|null>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt12",
  "expiry": <int|null>,
  "pubkey": <str>,
  "amount_paid": <int>,
  "amount_issued": <int>,
  "updated_at": <int>
}
```

Where:

- `quote` is the quote ID
- `request` is the bolt12 offer
- `amount` echoes the requested amount, or `null` for an amountless offer
- `expiry` is the Unix timestamp until which the mint quote is valid
- `amount_paid` is the amount that has been paid to the mint via the bolt12 offer
- `amount_issued` is the amount of ecash that has been issued for the given mint quote
- `updated_at` is defined in NUT-04

Example

Request with curl:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt12 -d \
'{"amount": 10, "unit": "sat", "pubkey":
        "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac"}' \
-H "Content-Type: application/json"
```

Response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed",
  "request": "lno1qcp...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt12",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "pubkey": "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac",
  "amount_paid": 0,
```

```
  "amount_issued": 0,
  "updated_at": 1701704657
}
```

Check mint quote:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/bolt12/019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed
```

Minting tokens:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/bolt12 -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d \
'{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8449-370fefb42fed",
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 8,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "035015e6d7ade60ba8426cefaf1832bbd27257636e44a76b922d78e79b47cb689d"
    },
    {
      "amount": 2,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "0288d7649652d0a83fc9c966c969fb217f15904431e61a44b14999fabc1b5d9ac6"
    }
  ]
}'
```

Response:

```
{
  "signatures": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 2,
      "C_": "0224f1c4c564230ad3d96c5033efdc425582397a5a7691d600202732edc6d4b1ec"
    },
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 8,
      "C_": "0277d1de806ed177007e5b94a8139343b6382e472c752a74e99949d511f7194f6c"
    }
  ]
}
```

Multiple Issuances

Unlike BOLT11 invoices, BOLT12 offers can be paid multiple times, allowing the wallet to mint multiple times for one quote. The wallet can call the check bolt12 endpoint, where the mint will return the `PostMintQuoteBolt12Response` including `amount_paid` and `amount_issued`. The difference between these values represents how much the wallet can mint by calling the mint endpoint. Wallets MAY mint any amount up to this available difference; in particular, they can mint less than the amount mintable. Mints MUST accept mint requests whose total output amount is less than or equal to (`amount_paid` - `amount_issued`).

Mint Settings

A `description` option **SHOULD** be set to indicate whether the `bolt12` payment method backend supports providing an offer description.

Example `MintMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "bolt12",
  "unit": <str>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>,
  "options": {
    "description": true
  }
}
```

Melt Quote

For the `bolt12` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMeltQuoteBolt12Request` data:

```
{
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "options": { // Optional
    "amountless": {
      "amount_msat": <int>
    }
  }
}
```

Here, `request` is the bolt12 Offer to be paid and `unit` is the unit the wallet would like to pay with. For amountless offers, the `options.amountless.amount_msat` field can be used to specify the amount in millisatoshis to pay to the offer. If `options.amountless.amount_msat` is defined and the offer has an amount, they **MUST** be equal.

The mint responds with a `PostMeltQuoteBolt12Response`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt12",
  "fee_reserve": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "payment_preimage": <str|null>
}
```

Where `fee_reserve` is the additional fee reserve required for the Lightning payment. The mint expects the wallet to include `Proofs` of *at least* `total_amount = amount + fee_reserve + fee` where `fee` is calculated from the keyset's `input_fee_ppk` as described in NUT-02.

`state` is an enum string field with possible values `"UNPAID"`, `"PENDING"`, `"PAID"`:

- `"UNPAID"` means that the request has not been paid yet.
- `"PENDING"` means that the request is currently being paid.
- `"PAID"` means that the request has been paid successfully.

Melting Tokens

For the `bolt12` method, the wallet can include an optional `outputs` field in the melt request to receive change for overpaid Lightning fees (see NUT-08):

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]> // Optional
}
```

If the `outputs` field is included and there is excess from the `fee_reserve`, the mint will respond with a `change` field containing blind signatures for the overpaid amount:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "bolt12",
  "fee_reserve": <int>,
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "payment_preimage": <str>,
  "change": <Array[BlindSignature]> // Present if outputs were included and there's change
}
```

Example

Melt quote request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt12 -d \
'{"request": "lno1qcp4256ypqpq86q69t5wv5629arxqurn8cxg9p5qmmqy2e5xq...", "unit": "sat"}'
```

Melt quote response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-82b3-56e12c3fcdf2",
  "request": "lno1qcp4256ypqpq86q69t5wv5629arxqurn8cxg9p5qmmqy2e5xq...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt12",
  "fee_reserve": 2,
  "state": "UNPAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757
}
```

Check quote state:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/melt/quote/bolt12/019e6d5a-2347-7000-82b3-56e12c3fcdf2
```

Melt request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/bolt12 -d \
'{"quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-82b3-56e12c3fcdf2", "inputs": [...]}'
```

Successful melt response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-82b3-56e12c3fcdf2",
  "request": "lno1qcp4256ypqpq86q69t5wv5629arxqurn8cxg9p5qmmqy2e5xq...",
  "amount": 10,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "bolt12",
  "fee_reserve": 2,
  "state": "PAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "payment_preimage": "c5a1ae1f639e1f4a3872e81500fd028bece7bedc1152f740cba5c3417b748c1b"
}
```

Example `MeltMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "bolt12",
  "unit": <str>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>
}
```

NUT-24: HTTP 402 Payment Required

`optional`

`uses: NUT-12`

`depends on: NUT-18, NUT-26`

This NUT describes how Cashu tokens can be used with HTTP 402 Payment Required responses to enable payments for HTTP resources.

Server response

HTTP servers may respond with the HTTP status code 402 and an `X-Cashu` header containing a payment request, encoded in either NUT-18 `creqA` or NUT-26 `creqB` formats. Wallets **MUST** support both formats.

The decoded payment request has the following fields:

```
{
    "a": int,
    "u": str,
    "m": Array[str],
```

```
    "nut10": NUT10Option <optional>
}
```

- `a`: The amount required in the specified unit
- `u`: The currency unit (e.g., "sat", "usd", "api")
- `m`: Array of mint URLs that the server accepts tokens from
- `nut10`: The required NUT-10 locking condition

Note: there is no transport field since we expect an in-band payment.

Client payment

After receiving a 402 response with an `X-Cashu` header, the client may retry the request with a `cashuB` token in the `X-Cashu` header as payment.

The token MUST be from one of the mints listed in the `m` array, and MUST be of the same `u` unit and greater than or equal to the `a` amount.

Payment response

If the server receives tokens from a mint that is not in the `m` array, an incorrect `u` unit, an insufficient amount of tokens, or with insufficient locking conditions, it should respond with an HTTP `400` status code.

NUT-30: Payment Method: Onchain

```
optional

depends on: NUT-04, NUT-05, NUT-20
```

This document describes minting and melting ecash with the `onchain` payment method, which uses Bitcoin onchain payments. It is an extension of NUT-04 and NUT-05 which cover the protocol steps of minting and melting ecash shared by any supported payment method.

Mint Quote

For the `onchain` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMintQuoteOnchainRequest` data:

```
{
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "pubkey": <str>
}
```

> **Note:** A NUT-20 `pubkey` is required in this NUT and the mint **MUST NOT** issue a mint quote if one is not included.

The mint responds with a `PostMintQuoteOnchainResponse`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
```

```
  "method": "onchain",
  "expiry": <int|null>,
  "pubkey": <str>,
  "amount_paid": <int>,
  "amount_issued": <int>,
  "updated_at": <int>
}
```

Where:

- `quote` is the quote ID
- `request` is the Bitcoin address to send funds to
- `expiry` is the Unix timestamp until which the mint quote is valid
- `pubkey` is the public key from the request
- `amount_paid` is the total confirmed amount paid to the request in UTXOs that are eligible for minting
- `amount_issued` is the amount of ecash that has been issued for the given mint quote
- `updated_at` is defined in NUT-04

If `expiry` is not `null`, the wallet **SHOULD NOT** send payments to the request after `expiry`. Mints **MUST** keep monitoring transactions they detected before `expiry` until the transaction reaches the required number of confirmations or is evicted or replaced. Payments first detected by the mint after `expiry` **MUST NOT** increase `amount_paid`.

Example

Request with curl:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/onchain -d \
'{"unit": "sat", "pubkey":
        "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac"}' \
-H "Content-Type: application/json"
```

Response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8850-39c85ed1b5d3",
  "request": "bc1q...",
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "onchain",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "pubkey": "03d56ce4e446a85bbdaa547b4ec2b073d40ff802831352b8272b7dd7a4de5a7cac",
  "amount_paid": 0,
  "amount_issued": 0,
  "updated_at": 1701704657
}
```

Check mint quote:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/mint/quote/onchain/019e6d5a-2347-7000-8850-39c85ed1b5d3
```

Minting Tokens

The quote accounting will only update to show `amount_paid` once a Bitcoin transaction has reached the minimum number of confirmations specified in the mint's settings.

If the `onchain` mint method has a `min_amount` setting, each UTXO paid to the quote address is evaluated independently against `min_amount`. UTXOs with an amount less than `min_amount` **MUST NOT** increase `amount_paid` and **MUST NOT** count towards the mintable balance for the quote. Multiple UTXOs below `min_amount` **MUST NOT** be aggregated to reach `min_amount`.

For the `onchain` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMintOnchainRequest` data:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>,
  "signature": <str>
}
```

Since onchain mint quotes require a `pubkey`, the wallet **MUST** include a [NUT-20](#) `signature` in the mint request.

Minting tokens:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/mint/onchain -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d \
'{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8850-39c85ed1b5d3",
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 8,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "035015e6d7ade60ba8426cefaf1832bbd27257636e44a76b922d78e79b47cb689d"
    },
    {
      "amount": 2,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "0288d7649652d0a83fc9c966c969fb217f15904431e61a44b14999fabc1b5d9ac6"
    }
  ],
  "signature": "f2a1..."
}'
```

Response:

```
{
  "signatures": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 2,
      "C_": "0224f1c4c564230ad3d96c5033efdc425582397a5a7691d600202732edc6d4b1ec"
    },
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 8,
      "C_": "0277d1de806ed177007e5b94a8139343b6382e472c752a74e99949d511f7194f6c"
    }
```

```
  ]
}
```

Multiple Deposits

Onchain addresses can receive multiple payments, allowing the wallet to mint multiple times for one quote. The wallet can call the check onchain endpoint, where the mint will return the `PostMintQuoteOnchainResponse` including `amount_paid` and `amount_issued`. The difference between these values represents how much the wallet can mint by calling the mint endpoint. Wallets **MAY** mint any amount up to this available difference; in particular, they can mint less than the amount mintable. Mints **MUST** accept mint requests whose total output amount is less than or equal to (`amount_paid` - `amount_issued`).

Only eligible UTXOs increase `amount_paid`. If a quote receives both eligible and ineligible UTXOs, only the eligible UTXOs count towards `amount_paid` and mintable balance. UTXOs that do not increase `amount_paid` are not recoverable through the mint quote protocol.

Mint Settings

A `confirmations` option **SHOULD** be set to indicate the minimum depth in the blockchain for a transaction to be considered confirmed.

For the `onchain` mint method, `min_amount` indicates both the minimum mint operation amount and the minimum amount of an individual UTXO that the mint will credit to `amount_paid`. Wallets **SHOULD NOT** send onchain payments below `min_amount` to a quote address.

Example `MintMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "onchain",
  "unit": <str>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>,
  "options": {
    "confirmations": <int>
  }
}
```

Melt Quote

For the `onchain` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMeltQuoteOnchainRequest` data:

```
{
  "request": <str>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "amount": <int>
}
```

Where:

- `request` is the Bitcoin address that should receive the onchain payment
- `unit` is the unit the wallet would like to pay with

- `amount` is the amount to send in the specified unit

Unlike other melt methods, a single `onchain` melt quote can contain multiple fee options for the same payment. This allows the wallet to choose between different fee and confirmation estimates while preserving a single quote ID.

The mint responds with a `PostMeltQuoteOnchainResponse`:

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "onchain",
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "request": <str>,
  "fee_options": [
    {
      "fee_index": <int>,
      "fee_reserve": <int>,
      "estimated_blocks": <int>
    }
  ],
  "selected_fee_index": <int|null>,
  "outpoint": <str|null>
}
```

Each item in `fee_options` represents one available fee reserve and confirmation estimate for the same payment. The wallet selects one of these options when executing the melt quote by including the option's `fee_index` value in the melt request. The mint **MUST** return at least one `fee_options` item. The returned `fee_options` are fixed for the lifetime of the quote.

For each fee option with `fee_index`, `fee_reserve` is the maximum onchain transaction fee the mint may charge for that option, and `estimated_blocks` is the estimated number of blocks until confirmation. `selected_fee_index` is `null` before the quote is executed and is set by the mint to the selected fee option once the wallet executes the quote. The mint expects the wallet to include `Proofs` of *at least* `total_amount = amount + selected_fee_reserve + input_fee` where `selected_fee_reserve` is the `fee_reserve` from the selected `fee_index` item and `input_fee` is calculated from the keyset's `input_fee_ppk` as described in NUT-02. If the mint does not claim the full `selected_fee_reserve` as the actual fee, the mint returns the unclaimed amount as `change` to the wallet as described in NUT-08.

`state` is an enum string field with possible values `"UNPAID"`, `"PENDING"`, `"PAID"`:

- `"UNPAID"` means that the transaction has not been broadcast yet.
- `"PENDING"` means that the transaction is being processed by the mint but has not reached the required number of confirmations.
- `"PAID"` means that the transaction has been mined and confirmed.

`outpoint` is the transaction ID and output index of the payment in the format `txid:vout`, present once the transaction has been broadcast.

Melting Tokens

Onchain melt requests are always asynchronous. The mint **MUST** return a `"PENDING"` state after validating the melt request and then broadcast the Bitcoin transaction in the background. The wallet **MUST** monitor the quote state through the check quote endpoint until the transaction reaches the required number of confirmations.

For the `onchain` method, the wallet includes the following specific `PostMeltOnchainRequest` data. The wallet can include an optional `outputs` field in the melt request to receive change for overpaid onchain fees (see NUT-08):

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "fee_index": <int>,
  "inputs": <Array[Proof]>,
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]> // Optional
}
```

Where `fee_index` is the selected fee of the quote's `fee_options`. The mint **MUST** reject a melt request with a `fee_index` that was not returned in the quote. Once `selected_fee_index` is set, the mint **MUST NOT** execute the quote again with a different `fee_index` value.

If the `outputs` field is included and the mint does not claim the full `selected_fee_reserve` as the actual fee, the mint will respond with a `change` field containing blind signatures for the unclaimed amount (see NUT-08). The `change` field is omitted if there are no blind signatures to return. Note that because onchain transactions may be batched or have unpredictable costs, the mint is entitled to claim the full `selected_fee_reserve` as the actual fee.

```
{
  "quote": <str>,
  "amount": <int>,
  "unit": <str_enum[UNIT]>,
  "method": "onchain",
  "state": <str_enum[STATE]>,
  "expiry": <int>,
  "request": <str>,
  "fee_options": [
    {
      "fee_index": <int>,
      "fee_reserve": <int>,
      "estimated_blocks": <int>
    }
  ],
  "selected_fee_index": <int>,
  "outpoint": <str|null>,
  "change": <Array[BlindSignature]> // Optional; present if outputs were included and there's
        change
}
```

Example

Melt quote request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/quote/onchain -d \
'{"request": "bc1q...", "unit": "sat", "amount": 100000}'
```

Melt quote response:


```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-83ad-72a9a83f3105",
  "amount": 100000,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "onchain",
  "state": "UNPAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "request": "bc1q...",
  "fee_options": [
    {
      "fee_index": 0,
      "fee_reserve": 5000,
      "estimated_blocks": 1
    },
    {
      "fee_index": 1,
      "fee_reserve": 2000,
      "estimated_blocks": 6
    },
    {
      "fee_index": 2,
      "fee_reserve": 800,
      "estimated_blocks": 144
    }
  ],
  "selected_fee_index": null,
  "outpoint": null
}
```


Check quote state:

```
curl -X GET http://localhost:3338/v1/melt/quote/onchain/019e6d5a-2347-7000-83ad-72a9a83f3105
```

Melt request:

```
curl -X POST https://mint.host:3338/v1/melt/onchain -d \
'{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-83ad-72a9a83f3105",
  "fee_index": 1,
  "inputs": [...],
  "outputs": [
    {
      "amount": 1,
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "B_": "03327fc4fa333909b70f08759e217ce5c94e6bf1fc2382562f3c560c5580fa69f4"
    }
  ]
}'
```

Pending melt response:

```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-83ad-72a9a83f3105",
  "amount": 100000,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "onchain",
  "state": "PENDING",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "request": "bc1q...",
  "fee_options": [
    {
      "fee_index": 0,
      "fee_reserve": 5000,
      "estimated_blocks": 1
    },
    {
      "fee_index": 1,
      "fee_reserve": 2000,
      "estimated_blocks": 6
    },
    {
      "fee_index": 2,
      "fee_reserve": 800,
      "estimated_blocks": 144
    }
  ],
  "selected_fee_index": 1,
  "outpoint": null
}
```


The wallet selects one of the returned `fee_options` by including that option's `fee_index` value in the melt request. Once the quote is executed, quote state checks return the same response shape with `selected_fee_index` set to the selected value and `outpoint` set once the transaction has been broadcast.

Paid quote state response:


```
{
  "quote": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-83ad-72a9a83f3105",
  "amount": 100000,
  "unit": "sat",
  "method": "onchain",
  "state": "PAID",
  "expiry": 1701704757,
  "request": "bc1q...",
  "fee_options": [
    {
      "fee_index": 0,
      "fee_reserve": 5000,
      "estimated_blocks": 1
    },
    {
      "fee_index": 1,
      "fee_reserve": 2000,
      "estimated_blocks": 6
    },
    {
```

```
      "fee_index": 2,
      "fee_reserve": 800,
      "estimated_blocks": 144
    }
  ],
  "selected_fee_index": 1,
  "outpoint": "4d5e6f...:0",
  "change": [
    {
      "id": "009a1f293253e41e",
      "amount": 1000,
      "C_": "03c668f551855ddc792e22ea61d32ddfa6a45b1eb659ce66e915bf5127a8657be0"
    }
  ]
}
```

Example `MeltMethodSetting`

```
{
  "method": "onchain",
  "unit": <str>,
  "min_amount": <int|null>,
  "max_amount": <int|null>
}
```

Requests and user experience

Getting tokens from one wallet to another should feel like showing a QR code, not like pasting JSON.

NUT-18 defines payment requests. NUT-26 encodes those requests as Bech32m, which is nicer in invoices, URLs, and QR codes. NUT-16 animates a QR code so a large payload still scans.

In this chapter

- NUT-16 — Animated QR codes
- NUT-18 — Payment requests
- NUT-26 — Payment request Bech32m encoding

NUT-16: Animated QR codes

`optional`

This document outlines how tokens should be displayed as QR codes for sending them between two wallets.

Introduction

QR codes are a great way to send and receive Cashu tokens. Before a token can be shared as a QR code, it needs to be serialized (see NUT-00).

Static QR codes

If the serialized token is not too large (i.e. includes less than or equal to 2 proofs) it can usually be shared as a static QR code. This might not be the case if the secret includes long scripts or the token has a long memo or mint URL.

Animated QR codes

If a token is too large to be displayed as a single QR code, we use animated QR codes based on the UR protocol. The sender produces an animated QR code from a serialized Cashu token. The receiver scans the animated QR code until the UR decoder is able to decode the token.

Resources

- Blockchain commons UR
- Typescript library bc-ur

NUT-18: Payment Requests

`optional`

This NUT introduces a standardised format for payment requests, that supply a sending wallet with all information necessary to complete the transaction. This enables many use-cases where a transaction is better initiated by the receiver (e.g. point of sale).

Flow

1. Receiver creates a payment request, encodes it and displays it to the sender
2. Sender scans the request and constructs a matching token
3. Sender sends the token according to the transport specified in the payment request
4. Receiver receives the token and finalises the transaction

Payment Request

A Payment Request is defined as follows

```
{
  "i": str <optional>,
  "a": int <optional>,
  "u": str <optional>,
  "s": bool <optional>,
  "m": Array[str] <optional>,
  "mp": bool <optional>,
  "sm": Array[SupportedMethod] <optional>,
  "d": str <optional>,
  "t": Array[Transport] <optional>,
  "nut10": NUT10Option <optional>
}
```

Here, the fields are

- `i`: Payment id to be included in the payment payload
- `a`: The amount of the requested payment, net of input fees (see Input fees)
- `u`: The unit of the requested payment (MUST be set if `a` or `sm` is set)
- `s`: Whether the payment request is for single use
- `m`: The mint list from which payment will be accepted
- `mp`: Whether the mint list is advisory (`true`) or strict (`false` or omitted)
- `sm`: A list of `SupportedMethod` entries (e.g. `"bolt11"`, `"bolt12"`, `"onchain"`) that the payee will accept, each with an optional per-method fee
- `d`: A human readable description that the sending wallet will display after scanning the request
- `t`: The method of `Transport` chosen to transmit the payment (can be multiple, sorted by preference)
- `nut10`: The required NUT-10 locking condition

Mint list

A Payment Request containing a mint list `m` describes the mints the receiver accepts payments from or prefers.

If `m` is set and `mp` is not present, or is `false`, the mint list is strict: the sender MUST only send proofs from these mints, and the receiver SHOULD ignore payments sent from other mints.

If `m` is set and `mp` is `true`, the mint list is preferred: the receiver accepts payments from other mints, but the payer SHOULD use a mint in `m` when possible.

If `m` is not set, `mp` SHOULD be ignored.

Supported payment methods

If `sm` is set, the payer MUST send ecash from a mint that supports melting the request unit (see NUT-05) via at least one of the listed payment methods. Each `SupportedMethod` is defined as:

```
{
  "mn": str,
  "mf": int <optional> // omitted = 0
}
```

- `mn`: the method name (e.g. `"bolt11"`, `"bolt12"`, `"onchain"`)
- `mf`: additional fee, in the request unit, that compensates the receiver for melting out via this method

The per-method fee applies only to payments the receiver may need to melt out of: those from a mint outside `m`, or from any mint if `m` is not set. Payments from a mint in `m` carry no per-method fee.

When a fee applies, the payer owes the lowest `mf` among the listed methods their mint supports, and MUST add it to the requested amount. For example, if the request lists `bolt11` (no fee) and `onchain` (`mf` = 50), a mint supporting both owes nothing, while an onchain-only mint owes 50.

Input fees

Received proofs cost the receiver an input fee when they are later swapped or melted (see NUT-02). The requested amount is therefore net of input fees: the payer MUST select proofs such that

`sum(proofs) - input_fee(proofs) >= a + mf (where applicable)`

with `input_fee` computed from the sending mint's keyset `input_fee_ppk` values as described in NUT-02. This protects the receiver from dust proof sets that are expensive to redeem (e.g. 1000 x 1 sat proofs at 250 ppk would cost the receiver 250 sats to swap).

Locking conditions

The payment request can include *optional* locking conditions the payee requires from the payer. For example, the payee might require a P2PK-locked token so that they can receive payments offline.

The `nut10` field specifies the payee's requested locking condition as a `NUT10Option` object. Its elements are derived from NUT-10's well-known secret. The `NUT10Option` is defined as follows:

```
{
  "k": str,
  "d": str,
  "t": Array[Array[str, str]] <optional>
}
```

- `k`: NUT-10 secret kind,
- `d`: NUT-10 secret data,
- `t`: optional NUT-10 payment tags

> [!IMPORTANT] The payee must validate the incoming tokens themselves in order to decide whether they can accept the payment. This includes checking the DLEQ proof and whether the token includes a long-enough timelock to satisfy the payee.

Transport

`Transport` specifies methods for sending the ecash to the receiver. A transport consists of a type and a target.

> [!IMPORTANT] The transport can be empty! If the transport is empty, we implicitly assume that the payment will be in-band. An example is X-Cashu where the payment is expected in the HTTP header of a request. We can only hope that the protocol you're using has a well-defined transport.

```
{
  "t": str,
  "a": str,
  "g": Array[Array[str, str]] <optional>
}
```

- `t`: type of Transport
- `a`: target of Transport
- `g`: optional tags for the Transport

Tags

Tags are an optional array of `[tag, value, value, ...]` tuples that can be used to specify additional features about the transport. A single tag can have multiple values.

Transport types

The supported transport types are described below.

Nostr

- type: `nostr`
- target: `<nprofile>`
- tags: `[["n", "17"]]`

The `n` tag specifies the NIPs the receiver supports. At least one tag value MUST be specified. For NIP-17 direct messages, the sender sends a `PaymentRequestPayload` as the message content.

HTTP POST

- type: `post`
- target: `<endpoint url>`

To execute the payment, the sender makes a `POST` request to the specified endpoint URL with the `PaymentRequestPayload` as the body.

Payment payload

If not specified otherwise, the payload sent to the receiver is a `PaymentRequestPayload` JSON serialized object as follows:

```
{
  "id": str <optional>,
  "memo": str <optional>,
  "mint": str,
  "unit": <str_enum>,
  "proofs": Array<Proof>
}
```

Here, `id` is the payment id (corresponding to `i` in request), `memo` is an optional memo to be sent to the receiver with the payment, `mint` is the mint URL from which the ecash is from, `unit` is the unit of the payment, and `proofs` is an array of proofs (see NUT-00, can also include DLEQ proofs).

Encoded Request

The payment request is serialized using CBOR, encoded in `base64_urlsafe`, together with a prefix `creq` and a version `A`:

```
"creq" + "A" + base64_urlsafe(CBOR(PaymentRequest))
```

Example

This is an example payment request expressed as JSON:

```
{
  "i": "b7a90176",
```

```
  "a": 10,
  "u": "sat",
  "m": ["https://nofees.testnut.cashu.space"],
  "t": [
    {
      "t": "nostr",
      "a":
        "nprofile1qy28wumn8ghj7un9d3shjtnyv9kh2uewd9hsz9mhwden5te0wfjkccte9curxven9eehqctrv5hszrthwden5te0de

      "g": [["n", "17"]]
    }
  ]
}
```


This payment request serializes to:


```
creqApWF0gaNhdGVub3N0cmFheKlucHJvZmlsZTFxeTI4d3VtbjhnaGo3dW45ZDNzaGp0bnl2OWtoMnVld2Q5aHN6OW1od2RlbjV0ZTB3Zmp
```


NUT-26: Payment Request Bech32m Encoding

`optional` `depends on: NUT-18`

This specification defines an alternative encoding format for Payment Requests using Bech32m encoding with TLV (Tag-Length-Value) serialization. This format provides better QR code compatibility and typically 30-60% size reduction compared to the CBOR+base64 encoding defined in NUT-18.

Encoded Request Format

Payment requests are serialized using TLV encoding, then encoded with Bech32m:

```
"creqb" + "1" + bech32m(TLV(PaymentRequest))
```

The human-readable part (HRP) is `"creqb"` and the version separator is `"1"`. The data payload is TLV-encoded as described below, then encoded with Bech32m (not standard Bech32).

> [!NOTE] Implementations SHOULD output uppercase Bech32m strings for optimal QR code compatibility. Uppercase alphanumeric characters use QR "alphanumeric mode" which is more space-efficient than "byte mode" required for mixed-case. Decoders MUST accept both uppercase and lowercase input.

When parsing a `creq` parameter, implementations SHOULD support both formats:

1. If the parameter starts with `creqA` (case-insensitive), parse as NUT-18 CBOR+base64 format
2. If the parameter is valid Bech32m with HRP `creqb`, parse as NUT-26 format
3. Otherwise, return an error

TLV Structure

The payment request is encoded as a sequence of TLV fields. Each TLV entry consists of:

- **Type** (1 byte): Field identifier

- **Length** (2 bytes, big-endian): Length of value in bytes
- **Value** (variable): Field data

Fields of type `u64` are encoded as fixed 8-byte big-endian values.

Top-Level TLV Tags

Tag	Field	Type	Description
0x01	id	string	Payment identifier (corresponds to `i` in JSON)
0x02	amount	u64	Amount in base units (corresponds to `a` in JSON)
0x03	unit	u8/ string	Currency unit (corresponds to `u` in JSON)
0x04	single_use	u8	Single-use flag: 0=false, 1=true (corresponds to `s` in JSON)
0x05	mint	string	Mint URL (repeatable for multiple mints, corresponds to `m` in JSON)
0x06	description	string	Human-readable description (corresponds to `d` in JSON)
0x07	transport	sub-TLV	Transport configuration (repeatable, corresponds to `t` in JSON)
0x08	nut10	sub-TLV	NUT-10 spending conditions (corresponds to `nut10` in JSON)
0x09	mint_preferred	u8	Mint list strictness flag: 0=false, 1=true; defaults to 0 if absent (corresponds to `mp` in JSON)
0x0a	supported_method	sub-TLV	Supported payment method with optional fee (repeatable, corresponds to `sm` in JSON)

All fields are optional. Unknown tags MUST be ignored to maintain forward compatibility.

Unit Encoding (Tag 0x03)

The unit field uses a compact encoding:

- **Value 0x00**: Represents `sat` (Bitcoin satoshis)
- **String value**: Any other unit is encoded as a UTF-8 string (e.g., `"msat"`, `"usd"`, `"eur"`)

Transport Sub-TLV (Tag 0x07)

Transport configurations are encoded as nested TLV structures. Each transport has the following sub-tags:

Sub-Tag	Field	Type	Description
0x01	kind	u8	Transport type: 0=nostr, 1=http_post
0x02	target	bytes	Transport target (interpretation depends on kind)
0x03	tag_tuple	sub-sub-TLV	Generic tag tuple (repeatable)

Transport Type Mapping

The kind field (sub-tag 0x01) identifies the transport method. The following transport types are defined:

Kind Value	Transport Type	Description	Target Format
0x00	nostr	Nostr-based transport using NIP-04 DMs	32-byte X-only public key (raw bytes)
0x01	http_post	HTTP POST to specified URL	UTF-8 encoded URL string

> [!NOTE] If no transport is specified (tag 0x07 is absent), the payment is assumed to be in-band, consistent with NUT-18 semantics.

JSON Representation:

In the NUT-18 JSON format, transports are represented with a `type` field:

```
{
  "t": [
    { "type": "nostr", "target": "npub1...", "tags": [["n", "17"]] },
    { "type": "post", "target": "https://callback.example.com/pay" }
  ]
}
```

When encoding to TLV, the `type` string is converted to the corresponding numeric kind value.

Transport Target Encoding (Sub-Tag 0x02)

The target field is interpreted based on the transport kind:

- **kind=0 (nostr)**: 32-byte X-only public key (raw bytes, not bech32-encoded)
- **kind=1 (http_post)**: UTF-8 encoded URL string

Nostr Transport Details

For Nostr transports (`kind=0`), the target field contains the raw 32-byte X-only public key (not bech32-encoded). NIPs and relay URLs are encoded using generic tag tuples (sub-tag 0x03), consistent with NUT-18's tags array.

Encoding (JSON to TLV):

1. Parse the `nprofile` or `npub` from the JSON target field using NIP-19
2. Store the raw 32-byte X-only public key in target (sub-tag 0x02)
3. Store any relay URLs from the nprofile as tag tuples with key `"r"`
4. Store NIPs from the tags array as tag tuples with key `"n"`

Decoding (TLV to JSON):

- If no `"r"` tag tuples are present: encode public key as `npub`
- If `"r"` tag tuples are present: encode as `nprofile` using NIP-19 format

Tag Tuple Encoding (Sub-Tag 0x03)

Generic tag tuples are encoded as:

1. Key length (1 byte)
2. Key string (UTF-8)
3. For each value:
    - Value length (1 byte)
    - Value string (UTF-8)

This allows encoding arbitrary key-value pairs for extensibility.

NUT-10 Sub-TLV (Tag 0x08)

NUT-10 spending conditions are encoded as nested TLV structures:

Sub-Tag	Field	Type	Description
0x01	kind	u8	Secret kind (0=P2PK, 1=HTLC, etc.)
0x02	data	bytes	Kind-specific data (UTF-8 encoded)
0x03	tag_tuple	sub-sub-TLV	Tag tuple (repeatable, uses same encoding as transport tags)

NUT-10 Kind Enumeration

The following kind values are defined for NUT-10 spending conditions:

Kind Value	Name	Description
0x00	P2PK	Pay to Public Key - requires signature from specified public key
0x01	HTLC	Hash Time Locked Contract - requires preimage of hash

Additional kind values may be defined in future NUT specifications. Unknown kind values SHOULD be preserved when re-encoding but MAY be ignored during validation.

Supported Method Sub-TLV (Tag 0x0a)

Each supported method is encoded as a nested TLV structure. The tag is repeatable, one sub-TLV per method, decoding to the `sm` array in JSON:

Sub-Tag	Field	Type	Description
0x01	method	string	Method name, e.g. `"bolt11"` (corresponds to `mn` in JSON)
0x02	fee	u64	Optional per-method fee; absent = 0 (corresponds to `mf` in JSON)

When the per-method fee applies and how much the payer owes is defined in NUT-18.

Example

This is an example payment request expressed as JSON:

```
{
  "i": "demo123",
  "a": 1000,
  "u": "sat",
  "s": true,
  "m": ["https://mint.example.com"],
  "d": "Coffee payment"
}
```

This payment request encodes to the NUT-26 format as:

```
CREQB1QYQQWER9D4HNZV3NQGQQSQQQQQQQQQQRAQPSQQGQQSQQZQG9QQVXSAR5WPEN5TE0D45KUAPWV4UXZMTSD3JJUCM0D5
RQQRJRDANXVET9YPCXZ7TDV4H8GXHR3TQ
```

BIP-321 Integration

NUT-26 payment requests can be included in BIP-321 Bitcoin URIs using the `creq` query parameter. This enables unified QR codes that support multiple payment methods.

The full Bech32m-encoded string (including the `creqb1` prefix) is used as the parameter value.

> [!NOTE] Implementations SHOULD use uppercase for optimal QR code compatibility. Decoders MUST accept both uppercase and lowercase input.

Unified QR Codes

By including both Lightning payment data and Cashu payment requests in a single BIP-321 URI, a single QR code can serve as an entry point for multiple payment methods. Wallets that support a given payment method can use it, while others can fall back to supported methods.

Examples

Cashu Only

A Bitcoin URI containing only a Cashu payment request:

```
bitcoin:?
creq=CREQB1QYQQWER9D4HNZV3NQGQQSQQQQQQQQQQRAQPSQQGQQSQQZQG9QQVXSAR5WPEN5TE0D45KUAPWV4UXZMTSD3JJU
CM0D5RQQRJRDANXVET9YPCXZ7TDV4H8GXHR3TQ
```

BOLT11 + Cashu

A unified QR code supporting both Lightning (BOLT11) and Cashu:

```
bitcoin:?
lightning=lnbc210n1p56amv8sp5v5gvxh0swyje66pcxtqtqh3qmzxd74fkxhjmzgzw7nff9fuhcdgqpp566zkpvgxn832
cg06ghlk48tqntffkp6nsemw8g836pjfw4tdhdmsdqgde6hgv3kxqyjw5qcqpjrzjqwryaup9lh50kkranzgcdnn2fgvx390
wgj5jd07rwr3vxeje0glc7rf05uqqg8gqqqqqqqlgqqqqrucqjq9qxpqysgqrdvjgsemgtxs3wa38xf8qs3awqf5ksw0d3mp
m07t9yl7xkasyzgz8rw5qlas6r4ers68u7nmgvqsgar4t9lr47fwlaue302nrasdekgqnvfjmp&creq=CREQB1QYQQWER9D4
```

HNZV3NQGQQSQQQQQQQQQQRAQPSQQGQQSQQZQG9QQVXSAR5WPEN5TE0D45KUAPWV4UXZMTSD3JJUCM0D5RQQRJRDANXVET9YP
CXZ7TDV4H8GXHR3TQ

BOLT12 + Cashu

A unified QR code supporting both Lightning Offers (BOLT12) and Cashu:

bitcoin:?
lno=lno1pgzkcctzv4kpvggzu2th0tw73fx2ygyd7gyuul490zkhkmz75ncz6q9nkyp9m78932tq&creq=CREQB1QYQQWER9
D4HNZV3NQGQQSQQQQQQQQQQRAQPSQQGQQSQQZQG9QQVXSAR5WPEN5TE0D45KUAPWV4UXZMTSD3JJUCM0D5RQQRJRDANXVET9
YPCXZ7TDV4H8GXHR3TQ

Realtime and authentication

Not every mint is a wide-open public endpoint.

NUT-17 lets wallets subscribe over WebSockets, so they hear about paid quotes and spent proofs without polling. NUT-21 is clear (ordinary) authentication. NUT-22 is blind authentication, which keeps the mint from tying your identity to every mint and melt.

In this chapter

- NUT-17 — WebSocket subscriptions
- NUT-21 — Clear authentication
- NUT-22 — Blind authentication

NUT-17: WebSockets

`optional`

`depends on: NUT-07`

This NUT defines a websocket protocol that enables bidirectional communication between apps and mints using the JSON-RPC format.

Subscriptions

The websocket enables real-time subscriptions that wallets can use to receive notifications for a state change of a `MintQuoteResponse` (NUT-04), `MeltQuoteResponse` (NUT-05), `CheckStateResponse` (NUT-07).

A summary of the subscription flow is the following:

1. A wallet connects to the websocket endpoint and sends a `WsRequest` with the `subscribe` command.
2. The mint responds with a `WsResponse` containing an ok or an error.
3. If the subscription was accepted, the mint sends a `WsNotification` of the current state of the subscribed objects and whenever there is an update for the wallet's subscriptions.
4. To close a subscription, the wallet sends `WsRequest` with the `unsubscribe` command.

Specifications

The websocket is reachable via the mint's URL path `/v1/ws`:

```
https://mint.com/v1/ws
```

`NUT-17` uses the JSON-RPC format for all messages. There are three types of messages defined in this NUT.

Requests

All requests from the wallet to the mint are of the form of a `WsRequest`:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "method": <str_enum[WsRequestMethod]>,
  "params": <str_WsRequestParams>,
  "id": <int>
}
```

`WsRequestMethod` is an enum of strings with the supported commands `"subscribe"` and `"unsubscribe"`:

```
enum WsRequestMethod {
  sub = "subscribe",
  unsub = "unsubscribe",
}
```

`WsRequestParams` is a serialized JSON with the parameters of the corresponding command.

Command: Subscribe

To subscribe to updates, the wallet sends a `"subscribe"` command with the following `params` parameters:

```
{
  "kind": <str_enum[SubscriptionKind]>,
  "subId": <string>,
  "filters": <string[]>
}
```

Here, `subId` is a unique UUID v7 generated by the wallet and allows the client to map its requests to the mint's responses.

`SubscriptionKind` is an enum with the following possible values:

```
enum SubscriptionKind {
  bolt11_melt_quote = "bolt11_melt_quote",
  bolt11_mint_quote = "bolt11_mint_quote",

  bolt12_melt_quote = "bolt12_melt_quote",
  bolt12_mint_quote = "bolt12_mint_quote",

  proof_state = "proof_state",
}
```

The `filters` are an array of mint quote IDs (NUT-04), or melt quote IDs (NUT-05), or `Y`'s (NUT-07) of the corresponding object to receive updates from.

As an example, `filters` would be of the following form to subscribe for updates of three different mint quote IDs:

```
["20385fc7245...", "d06667cda9b...", "e14d8ca96f..."]
```

Note that `id` and `subId` are unrelated. The `subId` is the ID for each subscription, whereas `id` is part of the JSON-RPC spec and is an integer counter that must be incremented for every request sent over the websocket.

Important: If the subscription is accepted by the mint, the mint MUST first respond with the *current* state of the subscribed object and continue sending any further updates to it.

For example, if the wallet subscribes to a `Proof.Y` of a `Proof` that has not been spent yet, the mint will first respond with a `ProofState` with `state == "UNSPENT"`. If the wallet then spends this `Proof`, the mint would send a `ProofState` with `state == "PENDING"` and then one with `state == "SPENT"`. In total, the mint would send three notifications to the wallet.

Command: Unsubscribe

The wallet should always unsubscribe any subscriptions that it isn't interested in anymore. The parameters for the `"unsubscribe"` command are only the subscription ID:

```
{
  "subId": <string>
}
```

Responses

A `WsResponse` is returned by the mint to both the `"subscribe"` and `"unsubscribe"` commands and indicates whether the request was successful:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "result": {
    "status": "OK",
    "subId": <str>
  },
  "id": <int>
}
```

Here, the `id` corresponds to the `id` in the request (as part of the JSON-RPC spec) and `subId` corresponds to the subscription ID.

Notifications

`WsNotifications` are sent from the mint to the wallet and contain subscription data in the following format

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "method": "subscribe",
```

```
  "params": {
    "subId": <str>,
    "payload": NotificationPayload
  }
}
```

`subId` is the subscription ID (previously generated by the wallet) this notification corresponds to. `NotificationPayload` carries the subscription data which is a `MintQuoteResponse` (NUT-04), a `MeltQuoteResponse` (NUT-05), or a `CheckStateResponse` (NUT-07), depending on what the corresponding `SubscriptionKind` was.

Errors

`WsErrors` for a given `WsRequest` are returned in the following format

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "error": {
    "code": -32601,
    "message": "Human readable error message"
  },
  "id": 1
}
```

Example: `ProofState` subscription

To subscribe to the `ProofState` of a `Proof`, the wallet establishes a websocket connection to `https://mint.com/v1/ws` and sends a `WsRequest` with a `filters` chosen to be the `Proof.Y` value of the `Proof` (see NUT-00). Note that `filters` is an array meaning multiple subscriptions of the same `kind` can be made in the same request.

Wallet:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "id": 0,
  "method": "subscribe",
  "params": {
    "kind": "proof_state",
    "filters": [
      "02e208f9a78cd523444aadf854a4e91281d20f67a923d345239c37f14e137c7c3d"
    ],
    "subId": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334"
  }
}
```

The mint first responds with a `WsResponse` confirming that the subscription has been added.

Mint:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "result": {
    "status": "OK",
    "subId": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334"
```

```
  },
  "id": 0
}
```

The mint immediately sends the current `ProofState` of the subscription as a `WsNotification`.

Mint:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "method": "subscribe",
  "params": {
    "subId": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334",
    "payload": {
      "Y": "02e208f9a78cd523444aadf854a4e91281d20f67a923d345239c37f14e137c7c3d",
      "state": "UNSPENT",
      "witness": null
    }
  }
}
```

While leaving the websocket connection open, the wallet then spends the ecash. The mint sends `WsNotification` updating the wallet about state changes of the `ProofState` accordingly:

Mint:

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "method": "subscribe", "params": {"subId":
        "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334", "payload": {"Y":
        "02e208f9a78cd523444aadf854a4e91281d20f67a923d345239c37f14e137c7c3d", "state":
        "PENDING"}}}

{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "method": "subscribe", "params": {"subId":
        "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334", "payload": {"Y":
        "02e208f9a78cd523444aadf854a4e91281d20f67a923d345239c37f14e137c7c3d", "state":
        "SPENT"}}}
```

The wallet then unsubscribes.

Wallet:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "id": 1,
  "method": "unsubscribe",
  "params": { "subId": "019e6d5a-2347-7000-8afa-051ae571f334" }
}
```

Mint info setting

Mints signal websocket support via NUT-06 using the following setting:

```
"nuts": {
    "17": {
      "supported": [
        {
          "method": <str>,
```

```
          "unit": <str>,
          "commands": <str[]>
        },
        ...
      ]
    }
}
```

Here, `commands` is an array of the commands that the mint supports. A mint that supports all commands would return `["bolt11_mint_quote", "bolt11_melt_quote", "bolt12_mint_quote", "bolt12_melt_quote", "proof_state"]`. Supported commands are given for each method-unit pair.

Example:

```
"nuts": {
    "17": {
      "supported": [
        {
          "method": "bolt11",
          "unit": "sat",
          "commands": [
            "bolt11_mint_quote",
            "bolt11_melt_quote",
            "proof_state"
          ]
        }
      ]
    }
}
```

NUT-21: Clear Authentication

`optional`

`used in: NUT-22`

This NUT defines a clear authentication scheme that allows operators to limit the use of their mint to registered users using the OAuth 2.0 and OpenID Connect protocols. The mint operator can protect chosen endpoints from access by requiring user authentication. Only users that provide a clear authentication token (CAT) from the specified OpenID Connect (OIDC) service can use the protected endpoints. The CAT is an OAuth 2.0 access token (also known as the `access_token`) commonly in the form of a JWT that contains user information, a signature from the OIDC service, and an expiry time. To access protected endpoints, the wallet includes the CAT in the HTTP request header.

Note: The primary purpose of this NUT is to restrict access to a mint by allowing registered users to obtain Blind Authentication Tokens as specified in NUT-22.

Warning: This authentication scheme breaks the user's privacy as the CAT contains user information. Mint operators SHOULD require clear authentication **only on selected endpoints**, such as those for obtaining blind authentication tokens (BATs, see NUT-22).

OpenID Connect service configuration

The OpenID Connect (OIDC) service is typically run by the mint operator (but it does not have to be). The OIDC service must be configured to meet the following criteria:

- **No client secret:** The OIDC service MUST NOT use a client secret.
- **Authorization code flow:** The OIDC service MUST enable the *authorization code flow* with PKCE for public clients, so that an authorization code can be exchanged for an access token and a refresh token.
- **Signature algorithm:** The OIDC service MUST support at least one of the two asymmetric JWS signature algorithms for access token and ID token signatures: `ES256` and `RS256`.
- **Wallet redirect URLs:** To support the OpenID Connect Authorization Code flow, the OIDC service MUST allow redirect URLs that correspond to the wallets it wants to support. You can find a list of common redirect URLs for well-known Cashu wallets here.
- **Localhost redirect URL:** The OIDC service MUST also allow redirects to the URL `http://localhost:33388/callback`.
- **Authentication flows:** Although, strictly speaking, this NUT does not restrict the OpenID Connect grant types that can be used to obtain a CAT, it is recommended to enable at least the `authorization_code` (Authorization Code) flow and the `urn:ietf:params:oauth:grant-type:device_code` (Device Code) flow in the `grant_types_supported` field of the `openid_discovery` configuration. The `password` (Resource Owner Password Credentials, ROPC) flow SHOULD NOT be used as it requires handling the user's credentials in the wallet application.

Mint

Signalling protected endpoints

The mint lists each protected endpoint that requires a clear authentication token (CAT) in the `MintClearAuthSetting` in its NUT-06 info response:

```
"21" : {
  "openid_discovery": "https://mint.com:8080/realms/nutshell/.well-known/openid-configuration",
  "client_id": "cashu-client",
  "protected_endpoints": [
    {
        "method": "POST",
        "path": "/v1/auth/blind/mint"
    }
  ]
}
```

`openid_discovery` is the OpenID Connect Discovery endpoint which has all the information necessary for a client to authenticate with the service.

`client_id` is the OpenID Connect Client ID that the wallet needs to use to authenticate.

`protected_endpoints` is an array of objects that specify each endpoint that requires a CAT in the request headers. `method` is the HTTP method, and `path` is either:

1. **Exact match**: no trailing $*$ → request path MUST equal `path`
2. **Prefix match**: ends with $*$ → request path MUST start with the prefix ($*$ removed)

The * wildcard, if present, MUST be the final character only.

For example:

- `/v1/*` matches any path starting with `/v1/` (all endpoints)
- `/v1/auth/*` matches any path that starts with `/v1/auth/` (all auth endpoints)
- `/v1/mint/*` matches any path that starts with `/v1/mint/` (all minting endpoints)
- `/v1/mint/bolt*` matches any path starting with `/v1/mint/bolt` (bolt11/12 minting endpoints)

In the example above, the `/v1/auth/blind/mint` path is the **exact match** NUT-22 endpoint for obtaining blind authentication tokens (BATs).

> [!CAUTION] Wallets **MUST** treat mint provided `path` values as untrusted input and use exact or prefix matching only. Never use regex matching on untrusted input.

Clear authentication token verification

When receiving a request to a protected endpoint, the mint checks the included CAT (which is a JWT) in the HTTP request header (see below in section Wallet) and verifies the JWT. To verify the JWT, the mint checks the signature of the OIDC and the expiry of the JWT.

The JWT includes a `sub` field which identifies a specific user. The `sub` identifier can, for example, be used to rate limit the user.

Note: The JWT *MAY* include an *audience* field called `aud` that contains the mint's public key

More on OpenID Connect ID token validation here.

Wallet

To make a request to one of the `protected_endpoints` of the mint, the wallet needs to obtain a valid clear auth token (CAT) from the OIDC service. The wallet uses the `openid_discovery` URL in the `MintClearAuthSetting` from the info endpoint of the mint to authenticate with the OIDC service and obtain a CAT.

Obtaining a CAT

Depending on the wallet implementation and use case, an appropriate authorization flow should be used. For mobile wallets, the Authorization Code is recommended. For command-line wallets, the Device Code flow is recommended. For headless wallets, the ROPC flow may be used.

It is recommended to use language-specific libraries that can handle OpenID Connect authentication on behalf of the user. The wallet should be able to handle and store access tokens and refresh tokens for each mint that it authenticates with. If the wallet connects to a mint for the first time, or if the refresh token is about to expire, the wallet should allow the user to log in again to obtain a new access token (`access_token`) and a new refresh token (`refresh_token`).

The `access_token` is what is referred to as a clear authentication token (CAT) throughout this document.

CAT in request header

When making a request to the mint's endpoint, the wallet matches the requested URL with the `protected_endpoints` from the `MintClearAuthSetting` (either exact match or prefix pattern match). If the match is positive, the mint requires the wallet to provide a CAT with the request.

After obtaining a CAT from the OIDC service, the wallet includes a valid CAT in the HTTP request header when it makes requests to one of the mint's `protected_endpoints`:

```
Clear-auth: <CAT>
```

The `CAT` is a JWT (or `access_token`) encoded with base64 that is signed by and obtained from the OIDC authority. The mint verifies the JWT as described above.

Error codes

See Error Codes:

- `30001`: Endpoint requires clear auth
- `30002`: Clear authentication failed

NUT-22: Blind Authentication

```
optional
```

```
depends on: NUT-21, NUT-12
```

This NUT defines a blind authentication scheme that allows mint operators to limit the use of their mint to a set of authorized users while still providing privacy within that anonymity set.

We use two authentication schemes in conjunction: *clear authentication* using an external OpenID Connect / OAuth 2.0 service (described in NUT-21), and *blind authentication* with the mint to access its resources. A user's wallet first needs to obtain a clear authentication token (CAT) from an OpenID Connect authority that the mint selected, which is not the subject of this specification. Once the user has obtained the CAT from the OpenID Connect service, they can use it to obtain multiple blind authentication tokens (BAT) from the mint. We describe this process in this document.

Blind authentication tokens (BATs) are used to access the protected endpoints of the mint and make sure that only users that previously presented a valid CAT can access the mint's features such as minting, melting, or swapping ecash. Wallets provide a BAT in the request header when making a request to one of the mint's protected endpoints. The mint parses the header for a BAT, verifies the signature (like with normal ecash as described in NUT-00), checks if the token has previously been spent, and if not, adds it to its spent BAT token database.

Blind authentication tokens are ecash

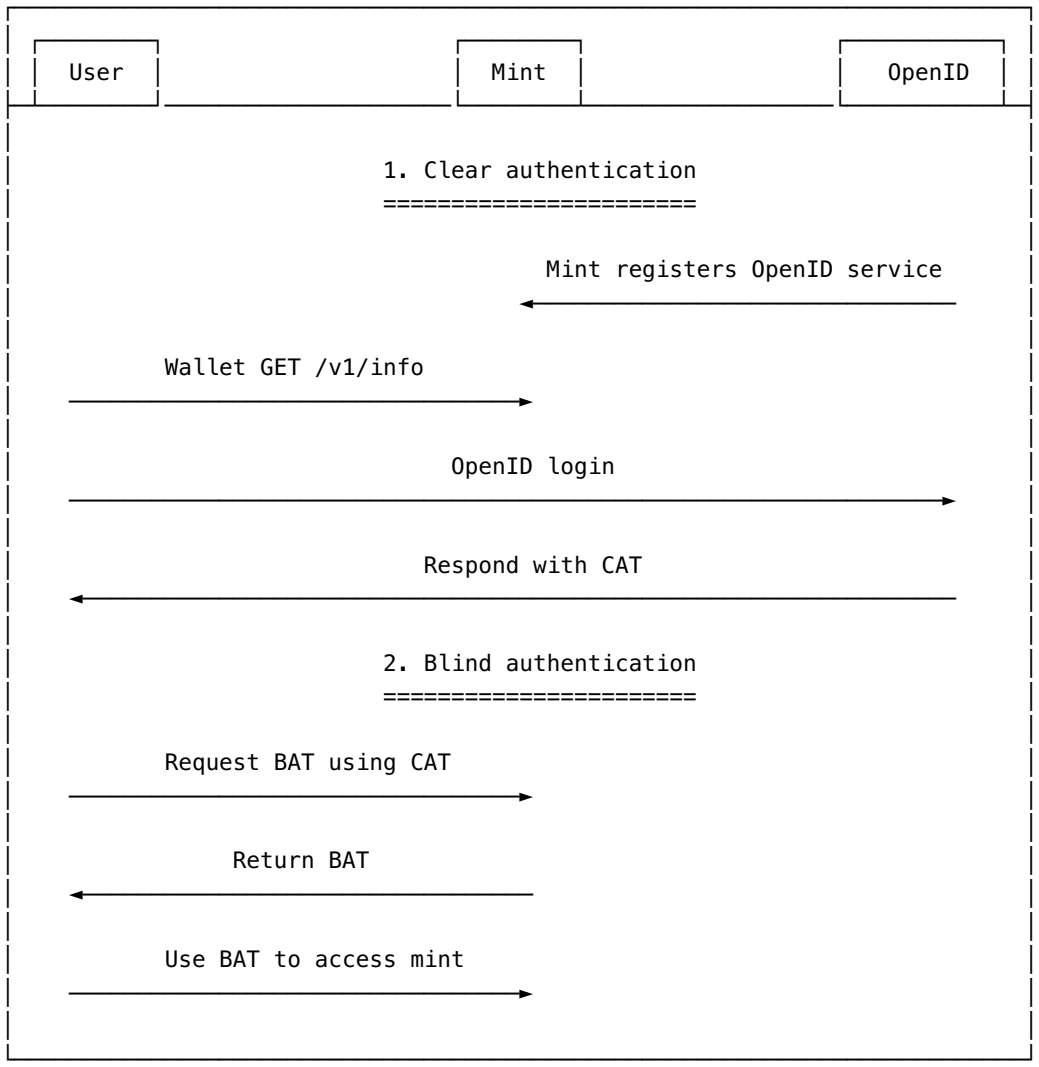
Blind authentication tokens (BATs) are essentially the same as normal ecash tokens and are minted in the same way. They are signed with a special keyset of the mint that has the unit `auth` and a single amount `1`.

BATs can only be used a single time for each request that the wallet makes to the mint's protected endpoints. For each successful request, the BAT is added to the mint's spent token list after which they are regarded as spent. The BAT is not marked as spent if the request results in an error.

To summarize:

- Wallet connects to mint and user is prompted to register or log in with an OAuth 2.0 service
- Upon login, wallet receives a clear authentication (CAT) token that identifies the user
- CAT is used to obtain blind authentication tokens (BAT) from the mint
- BATs are used to access the mint

The diagram below illustrates the protocol flow.



The steps for `1. Clear authentication` are described in NUT-21, whereas the steps in `2. Blind authentication` are subject of this document.

Endpoints

The mint offers new endpoints that behave similarly to the endpoints for getting the keys, keysets, and minting tokens with normal ecash (NUT-01, NUT-02, NUT-04). These endpoints start with a prefix `/v1/auth/` to differentiate them from the normal endpoints of the mint. Using these endpoints, wallets can mint blind authentication tokens (BATs) and use them later when accessing the protected endpoints of the mint. Note that BATs cannot be swapped against other BATs.

Keys

Like in NUT-01 and NUT-02, the mint responds with its BAT keyset for the following request:

```
GET /v1/auth/blind/keys
```

or

```
GET /v1/auth/blind/keys/{keyset_id}
```

where the mint returns a `GetKeysResponse`:

```
{
  "keysets": [
    {
      "id": "000e479673849bf6",
      "unit": "auth",
      "keys": {
        "1": "024ec000e31e230e4c59760def29601557c0b1650617dc8f38d3b2cfd21ad0351b"
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Notice that the unit is `auth` and only a single amount of `1` is supported.

Keysets

Like in NUT-02 the mint also offers the endpoints returning the keysets:

```
GET /v1/auth/blind/keysets
```

The mint returns the same `GetKeysetsResponse` response types as described in NUT-02.

Minting blind authentication tokens

To mint blind authentication tokens (BATs), the wallet makes a request to the following endpoint:

```
POST /v1/auth/blind/mint
```

To access this endpoint the wallet MUST provide a valid CAT (obtained via NUT-21) in its request header, IF this endpoint is marked as protected in the info response of the mint as per NUT-21.

```
Clear-auth: <CAT>
```

Like in NUT-04, the wallet includes a `PostAuthBlindMintRequest` in the request body:

```
{
  "outputs": <Array[BlindedMessage]>
}
```

where `outputs` are `BlindedMessages` (see NUT-00) from the blind auth keyset of the mint with a unit `amount`. The sum of all amounts of the outputs cannot exceed the maximum allowed amount of BATs as specified in `bat_max_mint` in the mint's `MintBlindAuthSetting`.

Notice that in contrast to NUT-04, we did not create a quote and did not include it in this request. Instead, we directly minted the maximum allowed amount of BATs.

The mint responds with a `PostAuthBlindMintResponse`:

```
{
  "signatures": <Array[BlindSignature]>
}
```

The wallet un-blinds the response to obtain the signatures `C` as described in NUT-00. It then stores the resulting `AuthProofs` in its database:

```
{
  "id": <hex_str>,
  "secret": <str>,
  "C": <hex_str>,
  "dleq": {
    "e": <str>,
    "s": <str>,
    "r": <str>
  }
}
```

To prevent pinning, wallets MUST validate the DLEQ proofs `dleq` as defined in NUT-12. Should `AuthProofs` be sent to another user of the mint, it MUST include the `dleq` proof so that the receiving user can validate it.

Using blind authentication tokens

The wallet checks the `MintBlindAuthSetting` of the mint to determine which endpoints require blind authentication. Similar to `NUT-21`, the wallet performs a match on the `protected_endpoints` in the `MintBlindAuthSetting` before attempting a request to one of the mint's endpoints. If the match is positive, the wallet needs to add a blind authentication token (BAT) to the request header.

Serialization

To add a blind authentication token (BAT) to the request header, we need to serialize a single `AuthProof` JSON as base64url with the prefix `authA`:

```
authA[base64url_authproof_json]
```

This string is a BAT.

Note that `base64url` strings may have padding characters (usually =) at the end, which can be omitted. Mints **MUST** accept and decode both padded and unpadded forms.

> [!CAUTION]
>
> To protect the privacy of the wallet, the BAT MUST NOT contain the `dleq` proof when it is sent to the mint in the request header.

Request header

We add this serialized BAT to the request header:

```
Blind-auth: <BAT>
```

and make the request as we usually would.

`AuthProofs` are single-use. The wallet MUST delete the `AuthProof` after a successful request, and SHOULD delete it even if the request results in an error. If the wallet runs out of `AuthProofs`, it can mint new ones using its clear authentication token (CAT).

Mint

DLEQs

The mint MUST return DLEQ proofs for every blind signature in `PostAuthBlindMintResponse` as defined in NUT-12

Signaling protected endpoints and settings

The mint lists each protected endpoint that requires a blind authentication token (BAT) in the `MintBlindAuthSetting` in its NUT-06 info response:

```
"22" : {
  "bat_max_mint": 50,
  "protected_endpoints": [
    {
      "method": "GET",
      "path": "/v1/mint/*"
    },
    {
      "method": "POST",
      "path": "/v1/mint/*"
    }
  ]
}
```

`bat_max_mint` is the number of blind authentication tokens (BATs) that can be minted in a single request using the `POST /v1/auth/blind/mint` endpoint.

`protected_endpoints` contains the endpoints that are protected by blind authentication. `method` denotes the HTTP method of the endpoint, and `path` is either:

1. **Exact match**: no trailing ∗ → request path MUST equal `path`
2. **Prefix match**: ends with ∗ → request path MUST start with the prefix (∗ removed)

The ∗ wildcard, if present, MUST be the final character only.

For example:

- `/v1/`∗ matches any path starting with `/v1/` (all endpoints)
- `/v1/mint/`∗ matches any path that starts with `/v1/mint/` (all minting endpoints)
- `/v1/mint/bolt`∗ matches any path starting with `/v1/mint/bolt` (bolt11/12 minting endpoints)

  [!CAUTION] Wallets **MUST** treat mint provided `path` values as untrusted input and use exact or prefix matching only. Never use regex matching on untrusted input.

Error codes

See Error Codes:

- `31001`: Endpoint requires blind auth
- `31002`: Blind authentication failed
- `31003`: Maximum BAT mint amount exceeded
- `31004`: BAT mint rate limit exceeded

Nostr integration

Cashu and Nostr overlap more than you might expect: both care about keys, relays, and not giving a server more than it needs.

NUT-27 is currently the Nostr-specific spec in this book. It describes backing up mint information over Nostr so a wallet can recover which mints it used, not only the proofs themselves.

In this chapter

- NUT-27 — Nostr mint backup

NUT-27: Nostr Mint Backup

`optional`

This document describes a method for wallets to backup their mint list as Nostr events on one or more relays. This allows users to restore their mint configuration across different devices or wallet instances using their mnemonic seed phrase.

Description

Wallet users can optionally enable backup of their mint list to Nostr relays. The mint list is encrypted using NIP-44 encryption and published as addressable (parameterized replaceable) Nostr events. The backup keys are deterministically derived from the wallet's mnemonic seed phrase, ensuring that the same seed can restore the mint list on any compatible wallet.

Key Derivation

The private key for Nostr mint backup is derived from the wallet's mnemonic seed phrase using the following method:

1. Generate a 64-byte seed from the mnemonic using BIP39 `mnemonicToSeedSync(mnemonic)`
2. Create a domain separator: `UTF-8("cashu-mint-backup")`
3. Concatenate the seed and domain separator: `combined_data = seed || domain_separator`
4. Hash the combined data: `private_key = SHA256(combined_data)`
5. Derive the public key: `public_key = secp256k1_generator * private_key`

Example Implementation

```
import { mnemonicToSeedSync } from "@scure/bip39";
import { sha256 } from "@noble/hashes/sha256";
import { bytesToHex } from "@noble/hashes/utils";
import { getPublicKey } from "nostr-tools";

function deriveMintBackupKeys(mnemonic: string): {
  privateKeyHex: string;
  publicKeyHex: string;
} {
  // Derive seed from mnemonic
  const seed: Uint8Array = mnemonicToSeedSync(mnemonic);
  const domainSeparator = new TextEncoder().encode("cashu-mint-backup");
  const combinedData = new Uint8Array(seed.length + domainSeparator.length);
  combinedData.set(seed);
  combinedData.set(domainSeparator, seed.length);

  // Use SHA256 of combined data as private key
  const privateKeyBytes = sha256(combinedData);
  const privateKeyHex = bytesToHex(privateKeyBytes);
  const publicKeyHex = getPublicKey(privateKeyBytes);

  return { privateKeyHex, publicKeyHex };
}
```

Nostr Event Specification

Event Kind

The mint backup uses Nostr event kind `30078` (addressable event) as specified in NIP-78.

Event Structure

```
{
  "kind": 30078,
  "content": "<encrypted_backup_data>",
  "tags": [
    ["d", "mint-list"],
    ["client", "cashu.me"]
  ],
  "created_at": <timestamp>,
  "pubkey": "<mint_backup_public_key>"
}
```

Event Fields

- `kind`: **MUST** be `30078` (addressable event)
- `content`: Encrypted mint backup data using NIP-44 encryption
- `tags`:
  - `d` tag with value `"mint-list"` (addressable event identifier)
  - `client` tag with the client name (optional but recommended)
- `created_at`: Unix timestamp of the backup creation
- `pubkey`: The derived public key for mint backup (x-only, 32-byte hex)

Backup Data Format

The plaintext data that gets encrypted in the `content` field has the following JSON structure:

```
{
  "mints": ["<mint_url_1>", "<mint_url_2>", ...],
  "timestamp": <unix_timestamp>
}
```

Encryption

The backup data is encrypted using NIP-44 v2 encryption:

1. Generate a conversation key using NIP-44: `conversation_key = nip44.v2.utils.getConversationKey(private_key, public_key)`
2. Encrypt the JSON string: `encrypted_content = nip44.v2.encrypt(JSON.stringify(backup_data), conversation_key)`
3. Use the encrypted content as the event's `content` field

Note: The same private and public key pair is used for both sides of the conversation key generation, creating a self-encrypted message.

Wallet Implementation

Backup Flow

1. **Enable Backup**: User enables Nostr mint backup in wallet settings

2. **Key Derivation**: Wallet derives backup keys from the mnemonic seed
3. **Data Preparation**: Wallet collects current mint URLs and creates backup data structure
4. **Encryption**: Backup data is encrypted using NIP-44 v2
5. **Event Creation**: Create Nostr event with encrypted content and appropriate tags
6. **Publishing**: Sign and publish the event to configured Nostr relays

Restore Flow

1. **Key Derivation**: Derive backup keys from the provided mnemonic seed
2. **Event Discovery**: Search for events with:
    - `kind`: `30078`
    - `authors`: `[<derived_public_key>]`
    - `#d`: `["mint-list"]`
3. **Decryption**: Decrypt event content using NIP-44 v2
4. **Mint Addition**: Present discovered mints to user for selective restoration

Example Backup Event

```
{
  "id": "...",
  "kind": 30078,
  "content": "AgAQJBIqWKEEBjGHfoozgDBgVQAAAAC5lQJtJQV_psHckN2KxWsUq7Q-B_twv4M2P3_vJrPMWg",
  "tags": [
    ["d", "mint-list"],
    ["client", "cashu.me"]
  ],
  "created_at": 1703721600,
  "pubkey": "bc9097997d81afb2cc7346b5e4345a9346bd2a506eb7958598a72f0cf85163ea",
  "sig": "..."
}
```

When decrypted, the content would reveal:

```
{
  "mints": ["https://mint.example.com", "https://another-mint.org"],
  "timestamp": 1703721600
}
```

Conclusion

Thank you for exploring the Cashu Book of NUTs. I hope grouping the specs by theme made Chaumian ecash a little easier to hold in your head.

Cashu is still moving. New NUTs will show up, old ones will get sharper, and wallets and mints will keep choosing which optional pieces to ship. If you want to help, the conversation and the spec text live in cashubtc/nuts.

Once again, all the credit for the protocol belongs to the original NUT authors and the people implementing them. This compilation is only a reading order.

Here’s to private, bearer bitcoin. Don’t spend it all in one place.